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Mixed fortunes.
Our analysis shows
how a flat Nifty
reveals sharp
divergence among
equity MF performers
BIG STORY P2



IPO Watch.
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RNI No. KARENG/2023/85271

‘7 streams of strength to drive Viksit Bharat’

DREAMING BIG. India aims to make five nuclear reactors operational in this decade and targets 100 GW capacity by 2047, says PM Narendra Modi

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday invoked “Shakti ki Saptdharas” or “Seven Streams of Strength” — manufacturing, agriculture and food processing, technology and innovation, Gati Shakti, defence, the green and blue economy, and soft power — as pillars to propel India towards greater heights. He also urged political parties to help implement 33 per cent reservation for women in Parliament and State Assemblies.

Addressing the nation from the ramparts of the Red Fort on the 80th Independence Day, he said, “Our dream is that when India celebrates 100 years of independence, it touches new heights.”

Explaining each of the seven streams of strength, the PM said, manufacturing

BIG ANNOUNCEMENTS

- One crore youth to be trained in AI over the next year via nationwide mission mode
- Free online coaching will be provided to youth preparing for various examinations
- Modernised training and enhanced capabilities to address evolving security needs
- Nationwide campaign targeting children aged 5-15 years for sports talent
- 7-8 new semiconductor production plants to be operational soon



Prime Minister Narendra Modi addresses the nation during the 80th Independence Day celebrations, at Red Fort in New Delhi

power meant building complete domestic, end-to-end value chains — from design to components — with a focus on zero-defect quality, cost competitiveness and global scale.

Under agriculture and food processing, efforts should be made to create integrated farm-to-export supply chains for millets, spices and fruits while transition-

ing to chemical-free farming, Modi said.

Technology and innovation, he said, must take India from being a technology market to a global innovation hub, with leadership in artificial intelligence, quantum technology, space, robotics, digital public infrastructure and Made-in-India 6G.

Gati Shakti would create

seamless, high-speed, multimodal logistics linking cities, highways, railways, airports and modern industrial ports. Defence “Shakti” would lead to complete strategic self-reliance by pioneering and exporting next-generation defence technologies such as drones, counter-drone systems and hypersonics.

The green and blue eco-

nomy would drive sustainable growth through green hydrogen, renewable energy and energy storage, while unlocking India’s ocean, coastal and marine potential. India’s soft power, meanwhile, would globalise Indian culture, yoga, ayurveda and tourism, while building leadership in gaming, visual effects, animation and the wider creative economy.

SELF-RELIANCE PUSH

The PM stressed the need for greater self-reliance and reiterated a series of ambitious targets. “The country will have up to eight more chip plants in the next one to two years,” Modi said.

Modi added that India aims to start five nuclear reactors as it steps up efforts to develop alternative energy sources and reduce reliance on imports. Last year, Modi’s government allowed private firms to build and operate atomic power projects as it pursues an ambitious goal of expanding nuclear power capacity 11-fold to 100 GW by 2047.

The PM said that India has a stable political mandate, a stable government, a vibrant democracy, a strong judicial system and “a Constitution that guides us all”. Every Indian, he said, is embracing the spirit of Make in India and Vocal for Local.

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INVESTMENT FOCUS.

Parag Parikh Flexi Cap Fund: Invest

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Existing investors can continue to hold Parag Parikh Flexi Cap Fund (PPFCF) and run their SIPs.

Fresh investors with a long horizon can also consider the fund which is the largest actively-managed flexi-cap offering, though expectations of past levels of outperformance should be moderated. PPFCF retains a 5-star rating under the *bl.portfolio* Star Track MF Ratings.

The recommendation rests on a strong long-term record and an ability to contain losses. Its seven-year return has ranked in the first quartile in all 75 monthly observations available, while its five-year return did so in 85 of 99 observations. Its three-year down-

side capture ratio of 42 is also the lowest among peers analysed.

There are, however, reasons to temper expectations.

PPFCF lost 0.6 per cent over the past year against a 5.9 per cent gain in the Nifty 500 TRI, while its five-year return ranking has recently slipped to the second quartile.

AUM has also surged to ₹1.48 lakh crore. At this scale, smaller stock positions struggle to move the needle, while overseas exposure has fallen to around 11 per cent amid regulatory restrictions.

Yet, the investment philosophy remains recognisable; the portfolio continues to take differentiated calls and the evidence does not yet suggest that size has broken the strategy.

Details p4

India set to remain one of the fastest growing economies: SBI

Our Bureau
Mumbai

With the economy in first track — real GDP growth expected at 8 per cent in Q1 FY27; continuing credit demand, growing by 19.3 per cent for the fortnight ended July 31; deposit growth picking up speed, growing by 15.4 per cent (with the huge inflows of FCNR-B deposits); and a visible reversal in FII flows — India “was”, “is”, and “will” be one of the fastest growing economies in the world, according to SBI’s economic department.

“Record capital inflows under RBI scheme at \$57 billion and counting; credit growth at a scorching 19 per cent; deposit growth at 15 per cent; forex reserves at \$707 billion, buoyant corporate results, monsoon recovery are all holding up,” said Soumya Kanti Ghosh, Group Chief Economic Adviser, SBI, in a report “Celebrating Resilience of Indian Economy on India’s 80th Independence Day.”

Read more p12

India Inc Q1 earnings spring a surprise despite cost pressures

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

Under the full glare of West Asia conflict, India Inc’s performance paints an optimistic picture despite relatively slow earnings growth. Of the 4,220 companies that had reported results till Friday, revenue and PAT grew 21 per cent and 14 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y), respectively.

This indicates strong revenue growth that has not fully translated into the bottom line owing to higher material costs. The divergence is more pronounced when the 593 BFSI companies are excluded, with revenue and adjusted PAT growth at 24 per cent and 8 per cent, respectively.

However, excluding another 48 companies from the refinery, power and gas distribution sectors that faced significant oil and gas marketing losses, revenue and PAT growth for the remaining companies improves to a more balanced 22 per cent each.

For this group, despite gross margins declining 333 basis points y-o-y, EBITDA margins declined by a lower 110 basis points, as higher business volumes absorbed

the impact of increased material costs.

Raw material cost inflation is expected to be transient, with many sectors indicating a normalisation during July-August. This should support higher earnings in the remainder of FY27, provided revenue growth sustains.

Among major sectors, IT and refineries have reported weak earnings growth. Banks, power generation and autos continue to report strong growth, while pharma, FMCG, steel and cement have presented a mixed outlook.

SECTORS FACING HEADWINDS

The refinery segment was expected to report massive losses during the quarter owing to marketing losses on retail fuel and LPG. However, the losses were contained as inventory gains and strong refining margins cushioned the impact.

The impact varied across companies depending on their presence in refining and marketing, LPG or oil, and exploration or sales.

For instance, Reliance reported 7 per cent y-o-y profit growth owing to its negligible exposure to marketing losses. In contrast, BPCL and HPCL,

where marketing losses were not offset by refining or other activities, reported significant PAT declines.

Retail fuel losses were higher at the beginning of the quarter but softened towards the end, aided by cooling crude prices, price hikes and a reduction in excise duty. Similarly, IOCL said LPG under-recovery declined from ₹665 per cylinder in early April to ₹250 currently, aided by alternative LPG supplies.

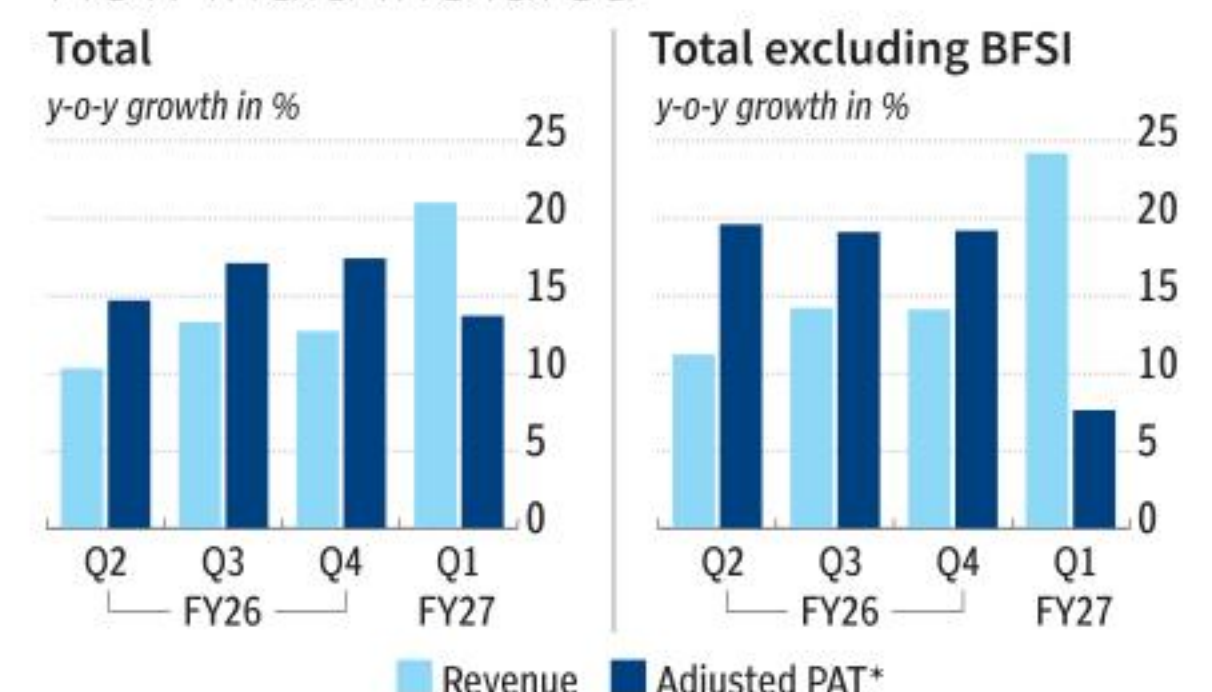
IT continues to report weak revenue growth, with constant-currency growth at less than 1-2 per cent y-o-y. Expectations of a modest recovery have now been pushed to H2 FY27. Geopolitical uncertainty affecting client decisions has extended into Q1FY27 as well.

AI-based revenues now account for 5-10 per cent of revenue across companies. However, despite the emergence of this new revenue stream, overall growth remains muted. A recovery in the second half of the year will depend on geopolitical conditions normalising.

STRONG MOMENTUM

Credit growth remains strong among banks, with business loans and the MSME segment leading the expan-

How India Inc fared



Revenue and Adjusted PAT YoY growth in Q1FY27 in percentage. Adj. PAT* is PAT adjusted for extraordinary income net of taxes. Source: Capitaline

sion. However, deposit growth continues to lag credit growth, and higher deposit rates may be needed to sustain lending growth. This could weigh on net interest margins and emerge as a differentiating factor among banks.

For instance, ICICI Bank reported NIM expansion, in contrast to a sector-wide contraction of 10-14 bps y-o-y. Banks with strong deposit franchises and no overhang of pending issues are better placed to deliver strong growth.

Overall earnings growth should remain supported by robust credit expansion and healthy asset quality.

NBFCs, led by Bajaj Fin-

ance and Shriram Finance, have also reported a similar performance, with strong AUM growth and lower credit costs, aided by healthy asset quality, driving higher profit growth.

Auto volume growth remains robust, with the GST impact continuing to support demand.

Commodity cost inflation in steel, rubber and aluminium had a significant impact during the quarter. Companies have raised prices to pass on higher costs, but margins have nevertheless been affected.

Despite commodity costs normalising, industry margins are expected to be lower in FY27. Industry leader

Maruti has operationalised a new plant and expects to launch five-six new models in the short term, indicating strong momentum in the sector.

Power demand resumed strong growth in May 2026. The sector benefited from volume growth and operating leverage as plant load factors improved during the quarter, resulting in stronger profit growth. Sector leaders Adani Power and NTPC continue to pursue large capacity addition plans, including nuclear power, with projects targeted for the 2031-32 period.

MIXED OUTLOOK

The pharmaceutical sector reported 16 per cent y-o-y revenue growth but earnings growth of only 3.8 per cent during the quarter. The transition from the earlier high-value opportunity, gRevlimid, to the new one, semaglutide, has been volatile for most companies in the sector.

For instance, Cipla and Dr Reddy’s reported earnings declines of 39 per cent and 69 per cent y-o-y, respectively, owing to the loss of gRevlimid and API issues related to semaglutide. India and emerging-market segments have delivered strong growth, while US generics continues

to face pricing pressure. Divi’s reported 66 per cent y-o-y earnings growth, indicating continued momentum in the CDMO space.

FMCG companies reported healthy volume and price growth across categories, indicating resilient demand. Cost inflation has remained manageable, while further price hikes may help counter-act inflation. The impact of El Nino on rural demand will need to be monitored, although early data suggest that it remains manageable.

Steel companies benefited from higher steel prices and volumes, which supported operating leverage and margin expansion. Steel prices are expected to decline marginally, but so are input costs such as iron ore and coking coal as the West Asia crisis normalises.

Cement companies, on the other hand, have seen a significant increase in operating costs and are likely to benefit more from cost normalisation than steel producers. Strong infrastructure-led demand remains a tailwind for both sectors.

Overall, Q1 has delivered a pleasant surprise, particularly given the gloom surrounding high oil prices at the start of the quarter.

AIIMS debars 2 suppliers after defective syringes, suction sets posed patient safety risks

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

Insects in syringes. Broken or dislodged needles. Blood-stained needle hubs, fungal contamination and cracked plungers causing leaks.

The All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), Delhi, recently debarred two medical suppliers for two years after such defects persisted across multiple batches despite repeated complaints from doctors and staff.

AIIMS said complaints came from several user departments, including the National Centre for Ageing block lab, trauma ICU, orthopaedic operation theatre, IVF operation theatre, Mother and Child Block and emergency medicine department. The institute said the de-



fects were not isolated and continued even after defective stocks were replaced.

DEFECTIVE SUPPLIES

Two debarment orders reviewed by *businessline* show that AIIMS acted against suppliers of disposable syringes and Yankauer suction sets, used to clear secretions, blood and other body fluids. The institute concluded that repeated supplies of defective material posed

patient-safety risks and that contractual obligations had not been satisfactorily discharged.

In the case of Tirupati Medilines Pvt Ltd, the L-1 bidder and contractual supplier of disposable 5 ml syringes with needles, AIIMS noted that the company supplied syringes manufactured by Cardiomac India Pvt Ltd under the Dispo brand. The contract was awarded through GeM in December 2024.

The first complaint was received on March 3, 2025, following which AIIMS ordered replacement within 48 hours. “But even after replacement, complaints continued over defects including insects inside syringes, broken needles, blood-stained needle hubs and fungal contamination. Further complaints included needle dislocation, internal breakage and

cracked plungers that caused leakage,” the AIIMS notice said.

Despite a second warning on March 22, complaints continued and a show-cause notice followed on June 4, 2025, and a debarment notice was issued in August. Tirupati said it was only an authorised distributor and had no role in manufacturing, adding that the supplies carried the OEM’s quality certificates. AIIMS rejected the defence, saying Tirupati remained responsible as the contractual entity.

YANKAUER SUCTION SETS

Taarini Medicare Inc., distributor of Yankauer suction sets manufactured by Life-O-Line Technologist, was also debarred for two years following repeated complaints of poor suction performance and material-quality issues.

Small taxpayers can now disclose foreign assets under new I-T scheme

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The Income Tax Department has rolled out the foreign assets of small taxpayers disclosure scheme, effective Sunday, August 16. The scheme will facilitate the disclosure of foreign assets valued at up to ₹5 crore. Declarations can be filed until December 31, 2026.

The scheme follows a Budget announcement. “To address practical issues of small taxpayers like students, young professionals, tech employees and relocated NRIs, I propose to introduce a one-time 6-month foreign asset disclosure scheme for these taxpayers to disclose income or assets below a certain size,” Finance Minister

Nirmala Sitharaman had said in her Budget speech for FY27.

THE FINE PRINT

In a set of frequently asked questions (FAQs), the department said an undisclosed asset located outside India means “an asset (including a financial interest in any entity) located outside India, held by the assessee in his own name or in respect of which he is the beneficial owner, where he has no explanation about the source of investment, or the explanation given is, in the opinion of the assessing officer, unsatisfactory.”

Undisclosed foreign income refers to the total income of an assessee from a source located outside India that was chargeable to tax in

India but was not offered to tax. The aggregate value of the undisclosed foreign asset as on March 31, 2026, and the undisclosed foreign income must not exceed ₹1 crore. The aggregate value of assets located outside India must not exceed ₹5 crore, the department said.

PAYMENT TIMELINE

The total amount payable would comprise 30 per cent tax on the value of the undisclosed foreign asset or undisclosed foreign income declared, along with an amount equal to the tax payable. For example, if an undisclosed foreign bank account is valued at ₹60 lakh and undisclosed foreign income is ₹20 lakh, the total amount payable would be ₹48 lakh — ₹36 lakh on the foreign bank ac-

count and ₹12 lakh on the foreign income. After the declaration is filed, the department will issue an order within a month. The assessee will then have two months to make the payment. This period can be extended by another two months, subject to simple interest at 1 per cent for every month or part thereof of delay.

The scheme provides immunity from any further tax or penalty, and from prosecution, under the Black Money Act, 2015, in respect of the income or assets declared. Further, the income or amount of investment in the asset declared under the scheme will not be included in the taxpayer’s total income under the Income-tax Act, 1961, or the Black Money Act, 2015, the department said.

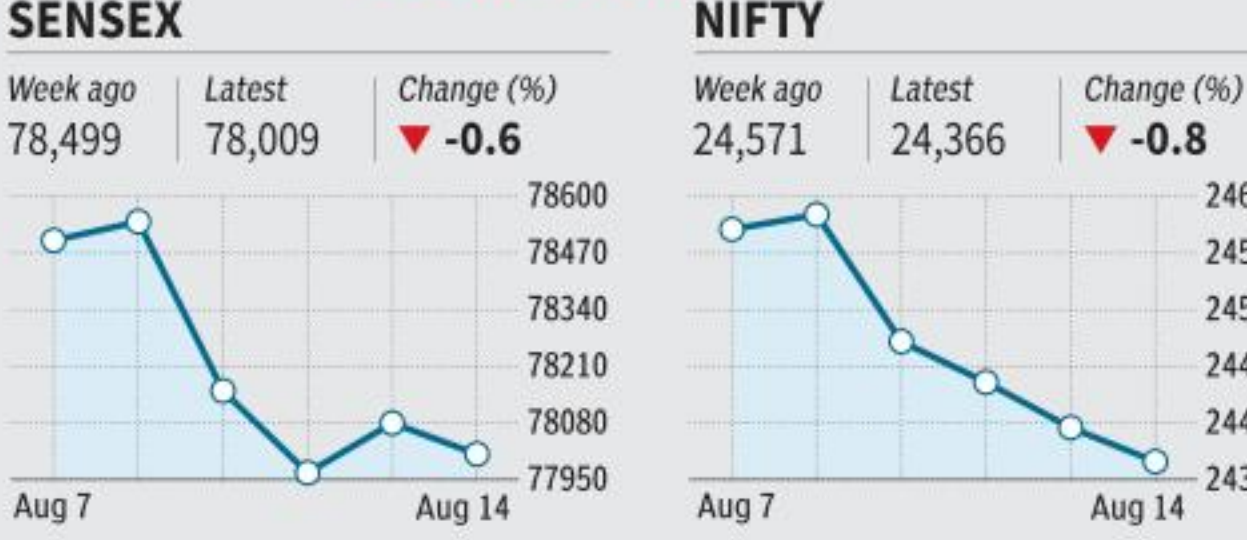
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WISE WORDS.

“The investment management business creates no value, but it costs, in round numbers, 1% a year to play the game. In total, we are the market, and given the costs, we collectively must underperform.”

JEREMY GRANTHAM
Market veteran

MARKET ACTION.



Flat Nifty reveals a wide fund divide

MIXED FORTUNES. Two-year performance shows how market rotations, drawdown protection and stock selection sharply separated equity fund winners from laggards



GETTYIMAGES/STOCKPHOTO

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl, research bureau

A near-flat Nifty concealed anything but a flat market over the past two years. While the Nifty 50 delivered an annualised price return of just 0.4 per cent and 1.7 per cent on a total-return basis, individual equity mutual fund returns ranged from a 10 per cent loss to a 20 per cent gain.

The two years ended August 10, 2026, were marked by sharp corrections, rapid shifts in market leadership and wide divergences across segments. Mid- and small-caps outpaced large-caps, with the Nifty Midcap 150 TRI and Nifty Smallcap 250 TRI delivering annualised returns of 6 per cent and 3.5 per cent, respectively. Sector leadership changed hands repeatedly as risk appetite ebbed and flowed.

For equity fund managers, this made portfolio positioning and stock selection critical. Some schemes protected capital better during corrections and captured subsequent opportunities, while others suffered deeper drawdowns and weaker recoveries.

A bl.portfolio analysis of 449 actively-managed equity mutual fund schemes shows just how divided the field was: 232 funds, or 52 per cent, beat their respective benchmarks during the period. The wide dispersion in returns shows how dramatically investor outcomes differed despite the market's subdued headline performance.

The detailed category-wise analysis later in the article focuses on large-cap,

mid-cap, large & mid-cap, flexi-cap, small-cap and multi-cap funds.

It looks beyond returns to drawdowns, risk-adjusted performance and investor experience through both lump-sum and SIP investments, highlighting which strategies dealt with this deceptively-flat market most effectively.

At bl.portfolio, we generally refrain from issuing recommendations on funds with less than seven years of performance history for equity and hybrid funds and five years for debt funds. Therefore, this two-year analysis is not intended as a recommendation or a definitive assessment of these funds. Instead, it offers a perspective on how active equity funds behaved in the market environment, positioned their portfolios and performed against peers and benchmarks.

Returns are compounded annualised growth rates (CAGR) for the two years ended August 10, 2026.

KEY TRENDS

Mixed bag

Just over half of active equity funds outperformed their respective benchmarks during the two-year period. But category-wise performance reveals a wide divergence in the ability of active funds to generate alpha.

Among diversified categories, multi-cap funds led, with 73 per cent of schemes outperforming, followed by flexi-cap at 67 per cent and small-cap at 64 per cent. Focused funds also recorded a strong 61 per cent outperformance rate. At the other end, large-cap funds had a more modest 45 per cent.

Investor takeaway: Active manage-

ment worked best where fund managers had greater flexibility to exploit sectoral and stock-level opportunities. Outperformance rates varied sharply across categories, showing that fund selection and portfolio positioning mattered far more than the headline index return.

Larger funds glitter

Larger funds showed a clear edge in benchmark outperformance during the period. Among schemes with assets of more than ₹50,000 crore, 10 of 13, or 77 per cent, beat their respective benchmarks. Parag Parikh Flexi Cap, HDFC Flexi Cap, HDFC Mid Cap, ICICI Prudential Large Cap and Kotak Midcap were among the notable outperformers. However, even this group had laggards, including Nippon India Small Cap, ICICI Prudential Value and Nippon India Multi Cap.

Among schemes with less than ₹10,000 crore in assets, only 49 per cent outperformed their benchmarks. Yet, several smaller funds delivered a striking alpha. Motilal Oswal Small Cap returned 15 per cent against 3.5 per cent for its benchmark, while Motilal Oswal Multi Cap and Union Small Cap also outperformed.

Investor takeaway: Many large funds managed to navigate their scale effectively and outperform. However, the wide dispersion within both large and small funds makes one point clear: Size can influence execution, but it cannot replace stock selection, portfolio construction and fund management discipline.

SIP scores over lump-sum

Two-year SIP XIRRs were higher than lump-sum CAGRs across almost all equity fund categories. However, the two measures are not strictly comparable: SIP XIRR reflects staggered investments, while lump-sum CAGR assumes the entire amount was invested at the start.

The advantage was particularly striking in categories including Small Cap. Motilal Oswal Focused, Bank of India Small Cap and Quant Large & Mid Cap delivered SIP returns that were 10-15 percentage points higher than their respective lump-sum returns.

However, the benefit was not uniform. Motilal Oswal Large Cap and Parag Parikh Flexi Cap saw a much narrower gap between the two approaches, reflecting relatively lower volatility or a less favourable sequence of market movements for systematic investors.

The data highlight an important lesson: In volatile, range-bound markets, the journey matters as much as the destination. Regular investing allows investors to buy more units when prices fall, allowing SIPs to benefit from market volatility.

Winning by losing less

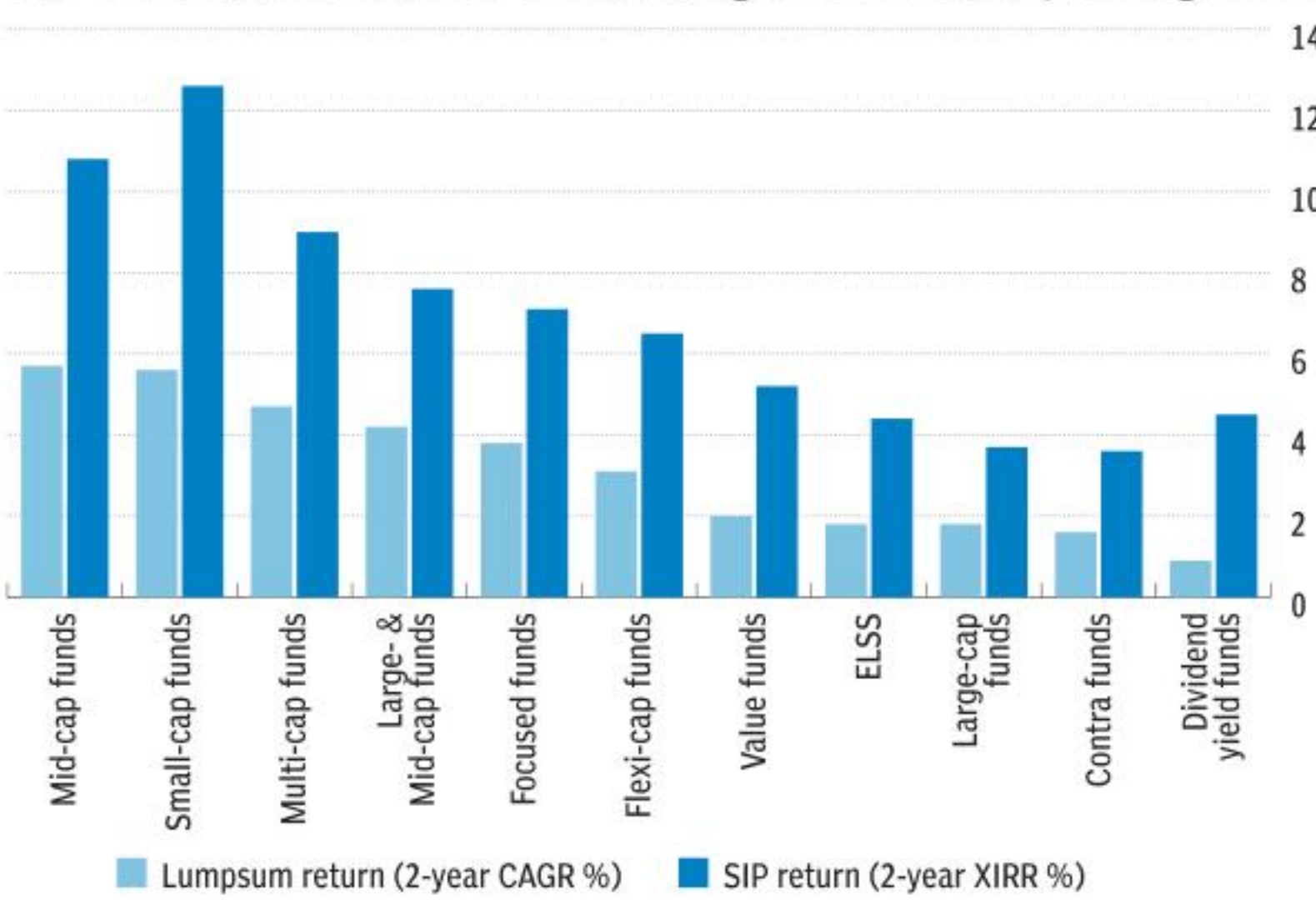
The two-year period shows that outperformance was not always about chasing market rallies. Some funds added value by participating adequately in rising markets while protecting capital better during declines. This is where upside and downside capture ratios become useful.

The upside capture ratio measures how much of the benchmark's gains a fund captured during rising markets. A ratio above 100 means the fund gained more than its benchmark, while a ratio below 100 indicates lower participation.

The downside capture ratio measures how much of the benchmark's losses a fund suffered during falling markets. Here, lower is better. A downside capture of 70 means the fund suffered only 70 per cent of the benchmark's decline. Ideally, investors would want a fund with upside capture above 100 and downside capture below 100.

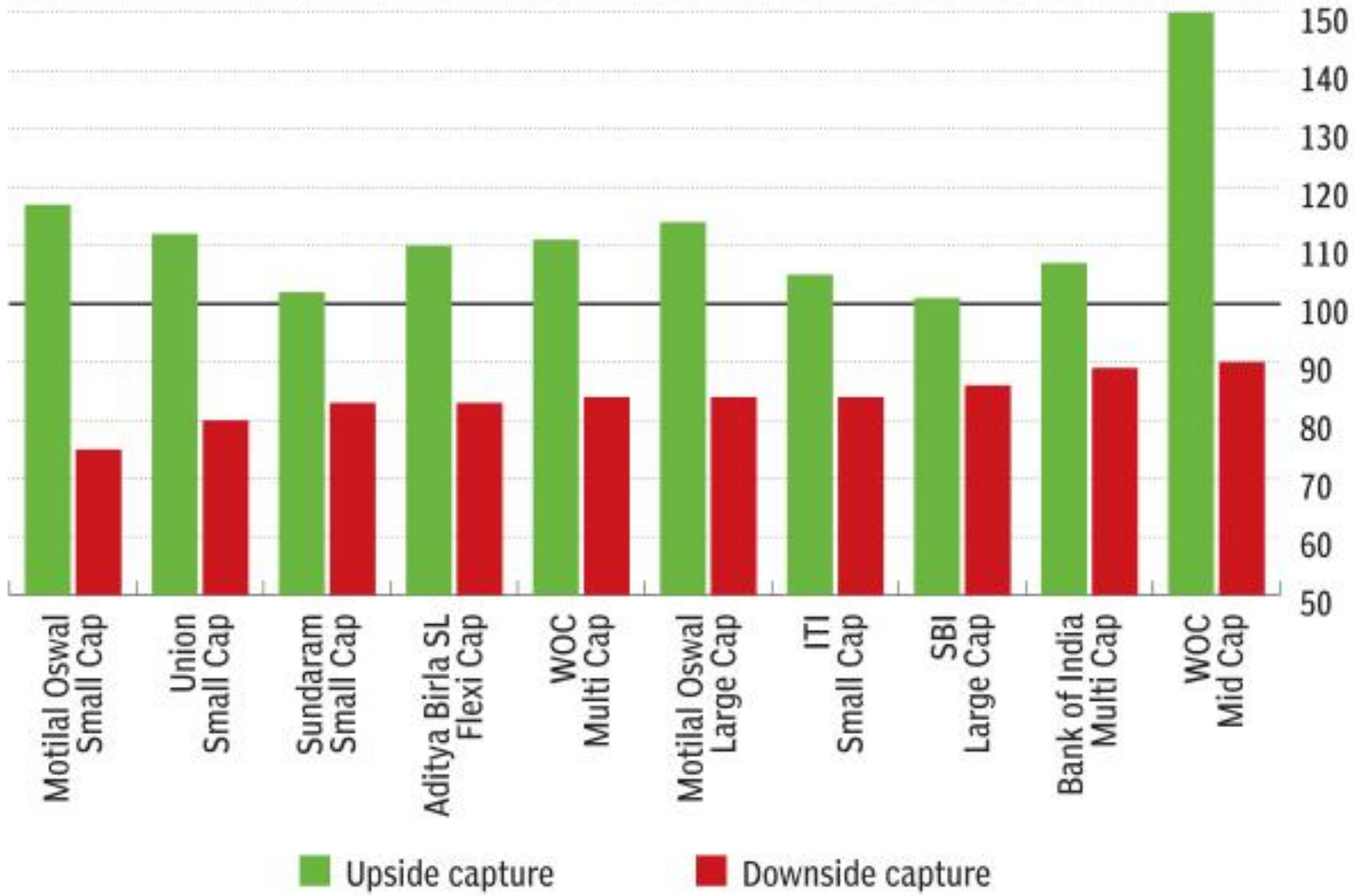
Motilal Oswal Small Cap Fund illus-

SIP route proves more rewarding across equity categories



Source: ACEMF Returns value as of Aug 10, 2026

Top funds that captured the upside and contained the downside



Period: Aug 10, 2024 to Aug 10, 2026 Source: ACEMF
Upside capture shows participation in market gains, while downside capture shows participation in market declines. A fund with upside capture above 100% and downside capture below 100% are preferable

trates this well. Its 117 per cent upside capture shows that it participated strongly during market rallies, while its 75 per cent downside capture indicates that it absorbed only about three-fourths of the benchmark's decline during weak periods.

The fund consequently delivered 15 per cent, well ahead of the benchmark's 3.5 per cent.

Union Small Cap, Sundaram Small Cap and WOC Multi Cap also showed a favourable balance between upside participation and downside protection.

Investor takeaway: Active management does not have to win by taking bigger bets. Sometimes, losing significantly less during market declines can be a more effective route to sustained outperformance.

Prudent stock selection

An analysis of the top-performing diversified funds over the last two years suggests that stock selection played an important role, with no single sector or market-cap bias explaining the winners. Financials, industrials, healthcare, manufacturing and consumer-facing businesses featured prominently, while several funds benefited from meaningful exposure to mid- and small-cap stocks that delivered outsized gains.

The portfolios of laggards, in contrast, reveal the cost of owning the wrong stocks, irrespective of sector positioning. Higher exposure to mature large-caps, consumer staples, chemicals, retail, agrochemicals and select IT stocks weighed on returns amid earnings moderation and valuation compression.

High portfolio churn and extensive diversification were also visible among some of the laggards.

Uninterrupted inflows

The last two years were marked by elevated global interest rates, sticky inflation and geopolitical tensions, including the US-Israel-Iran conflict. Persistent foreign portfolio investor (FPI) outflows weighed on large-caps, while steady domestic institutional inflows cushioned the downside.

Despite the volatility, actively-managed equity funds attracted ₹7.5 lakh crore in net inflows over the two-year period. Flexi-cap funds led with ₹1.5 lakh crore, followed by small-cap funds at ₹1.1 lakh crore.

Their combined AUM rose to ₹38.4 lakh crore from ₹30.1 lakh crore during the period.

Retail participation also remained resilient. Monthly SIP collections rose from ₹23,545 crore to ₹31,961 crore over the 24 months, highlighting the growing stickiness of systematic investing and the resilience of domestic investor flows despite market volatility.

HOW THE MAJOR CATEGORIES FARED

Large-cap

Large-cap funds operated in a subdued return environment, with most schemes, barring the top three, delivering returns within a narrow range. Motilal Oswal Large Cap topped the category with a 7.1 per cent CAGR against 1.8 per cent for the benchmark. Its edge came from adding turnaround bets such as Samvardhana Motherson International, Bajaj Finance and Titan, while cutting exposure to bruised IT stocks.

JM Large Cap was the laggard, delivering a -1.5 per cent CAGR. It retained meaningful exposure to laggards such as HDFC Bank, Reliance, Infosys and NTPC, as well as several mature large-

cap franchises that generated modest or negative returns. The contrasting outcomes show that even in a low-alpha category, the edge in large-cap investing lies in conviction and the speed at which portfolios adapt to changing opportunities.

Mid-cap

Mid-cap funds saw a sharp divergence in performance, with returns ranging from 13.6 per cent to -3.6 per cent, against 6 per cent for the benchmark. Invesco India Midcap topped the category with 13.6 per cent, helped by early positions in L&T Finance and Max Healthcare.

At the other end, Quant Mid Cap lagged, hurt by elevated exposure to stocks such as IRB and Tata Communications and its PSU bets. Its concentrated portfolio of just 23 stocks, against a category average of 69, combined with an aggressive 261 per cent portfolio turnover, proved counterproductive.

Large- & mid-cap

The category's ability to invest across two market-cap segments offers flexibility, but flexibility alone does not create alpha. Invesco India Large & Mid Cap stood out partly because nearly one-fourth of its portfolio was tilted towards small-caps. Its outperformance was further supported by aggressive bets on healthcare, financials, aviation and digital consumption.

At the other end, Tata Large & Mid Cap lagged, hurt by heavy positions in HDFC Bank, Reliance, PI Industries, Varun Beverages and Tata group stocks.

Small-cap

The defining skill in small-caps is not merely spotting potential multibaggers, but knowing when to cut exposure as the investment thesis weakens. The period offered little evidence that a larger portfolio necessarily delivered better outcomes. Nippon India Small Cap, with 251 stocks, and ICICI Prudential Smallcap, with 130, underperformed the benchmark's 3.5 per cent CAGR, while the equally diversified Bandhan Small Cap, with 260 stocks, outpaced it.

Motilal Oswal Small Cap led with a 15.3 per cent return, favouring a concentrated portfolio of 61 stocks and high-conviction bets across infrastructure, diagnostics and banking. At the other end, Tata Small Cap was the only fund to post a negative return, weighed down by exposure to lagging chemicals, retail and logistics stocks.

Flexi-cap

Flexi-cap funds are often positioned as 'go anywhere' strategies, but their real edge lies not in the breadth of the stock universe, but in making and sustaining decisive market-cap allocation calls. The past two years rewarded funds that rotated across market-cap segments ahead of the cycle, rather than simply relying on stock selection.

Aditya Birla Sun Life Flexicap topped the category. It cut large-cap exposure from 70 per cent to 55 per cent and shifted decisively towards BFSI/NBFCs and industrials, while reducing IT exposure. At the other end, Samco Flexicap lagged despite high portfolio churn, with turnover of about 190 per cent over two years.

Multi-cap

Multi-cap mandates require funds to maintain meaningful exposure across all three market-cap segments. Motilal Oswal Multi Cap topped the category, striking a favourable balance between upside participation of 142 per cent and downside capture of 92 per cent. Its performance was aided by strong mid- and small-cappicks.

At the other end, Quant Multi Cap lagged as several high-conviction small-cap bets suffered steep declines.

Toppers and laggards across major active equity MF categories

TOPPERS			LAGGARDS	
Scheme	2-year CAGR (%)		Scheme	2-year CAGR (%)
Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	8.3	« Flexi-cap funds » BM: 2.8%	Samco Flexi Cap	-9.5
Helios Flexi Cap	7.2		NJ Flexi Cap	-5.9
ICICI Pru Flexicap	7.1		Shriram Flexi Cap	-5.4
HDFC Flexi Cap	6.8		JM Flexicap	-1.6
Invesco India Flexi Cap	6.8		Mahindra Man Flexi Cap	0.5
Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	11.8	« Large- & Mid-cap funds » BM: 3.9%	Tata Large & Mid Cap	-1.8
Motilal Oswal Large & Midcap	9.5		Quant Large & Mid Cap	-0.2
WOC Large & Mid Cap	7.1		LIC MF Large & Midcap	1.4
SBI Large & Midcap	6.2		DSP Large & Mid Cap	1.8
HSBC Large & Mid Cap	6.2		BOI Large & Mid Cap	2.0
Motilal Oswal Large Cap	7.1	« Large-cap funds » BM: 1.8%	JM Large Cap	-1.5
Invesco India Largecap	4.5		ITI Large Cap	-0.8
WOC Large Cap	4.1		LIC MF Large Cap	-0.7
Bandhan Large Cap	3.8		Mahindra Man Large Cap	-0.6
SBI Large Cap	3.6		UTI Large Cap	0.3
Invesco India Midcap	13.6	« Mid-cap funds » BM: 6%	Quant Mid Cap	-3.6
WOC Mid Cap	11.4		Taurus Mid Cap	1.0
HSBC Midcap	11.3		UTI Mid Cap	1.9
ICICI Pru Midcap	10.2		SBI Midcap	2.5
Edelweiss Mid Cap	8.0		Motilal Oswal Midcap	2.6
Motilal Oswal Multi Cap	15.0	« Multi-cap funds » BM: 3.4%	Quant Multi Cap	-3.0
WOC Multi Cap	9.0		HDFC Multi Cap	0.7
Axis Multicap	7.8		DSP Multicap	1.0
Union Multicap	6.4		Bandhan Multi Cap	2.5
Mahindra Man Multi Cap	6.3		Invesco India Multicap	2.5
Motilal Oswal Small Cap	15.3	« Small-cap funds » BM: 3.5%	Tata Small Cap	-1.7
Invesco India Smallcap	11.2		Franklin India Small Cap	0.6
Union Small Cap	10.6		Kotak Small Cap	1.2
Bank of India Small Cap	10.4		Baroda BNPP Small Cap	1.7
ITI Small Cap	10.3		SBI Small Cap	1.9

Source: ACEMF Returns value as of Aug 10, 2026 BM - Benchmark

Balance sheet is India Inc’s new source of freedom

CHARGED UP. With profitability at a high, the next phase of investment will not only help corporates sustain it but also achieve long-term earnings growth

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

Each quarter, India Inc’s profit numbers hog the limelight, while another set of numbers — crucial for sustaining profits for the long term — get lesser attention than they deserve: Balance-sheet strength. Stronger balance sheets allow for more aggressive investments which can drive growth in future.

In this analysis, we do a status check on balance-sheet strength of India Inc.

Over the past five years, India Inc has had to navigate an unusually turbulent economic landscape.

The pandemic, geopolitical upheaval, sharp swings in commodity prices, disinflationary pressures and rapid technology-led disruption have all tested the resilience of companies in both the global and domestic economy.

Yet, despite the scale of these shocks, corporate India has emerged with its balance sheet largely intact, helped by stronger financial discipline and sustained earnings growth.

That resilience matters because the next five years are likely to present a different set of structural challenges.

Artificial intelligence could bring disruptions of its own, energy markets may remain volatile and trade protectionism is expected to become a persistent headwind to growth. With a stronger financial buffer now in place, India Inc has an opportunity to invest for the next phase of expansion rather than merely defend against uncertainty.

This analysis is based on 760 companies for which all relevant financial data (Source Capitaline) is available across each of the last five years, including 94 from the banking, financial services and insurance (BFSI) sector, across the past five years.

The data highlight not only the overall improvement in corporate performance but also the



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sharp differences in sectoral trends.

CORPORATE RESILIENCE

The strongest evidence of corporate resilience is visible in debt metrics. Excluding BFSI companies, the remaining 654 firms show a marked improvement across interest coverage, net debt-to-EBITDA and debt-to-equity ratios. Interest coverage ratio (EBIT/interest cost) measuring companies’ ability to pay interest cost is at its highest point now at 5.7 times compared to an average of 4.9 times in last four years. Simultaneously, Debt to equity (0.46 Vs 0.54 average) and Net debt to EBITDA (1.4 Vs 1.6 average) which measure the debt levels of a company are at their lowest as well.

This improvement has been led mainly by automobiles, and also by steel and cement in the last two years, although each sector’s progress has been driven by different factors. But Refineries and Power generation sectors continue to invest in capacity with not much of a change in debt metrics.

ROBUST OUTLOOK

Looking ahead, India Inc appears well placed to launch the next phase of investment

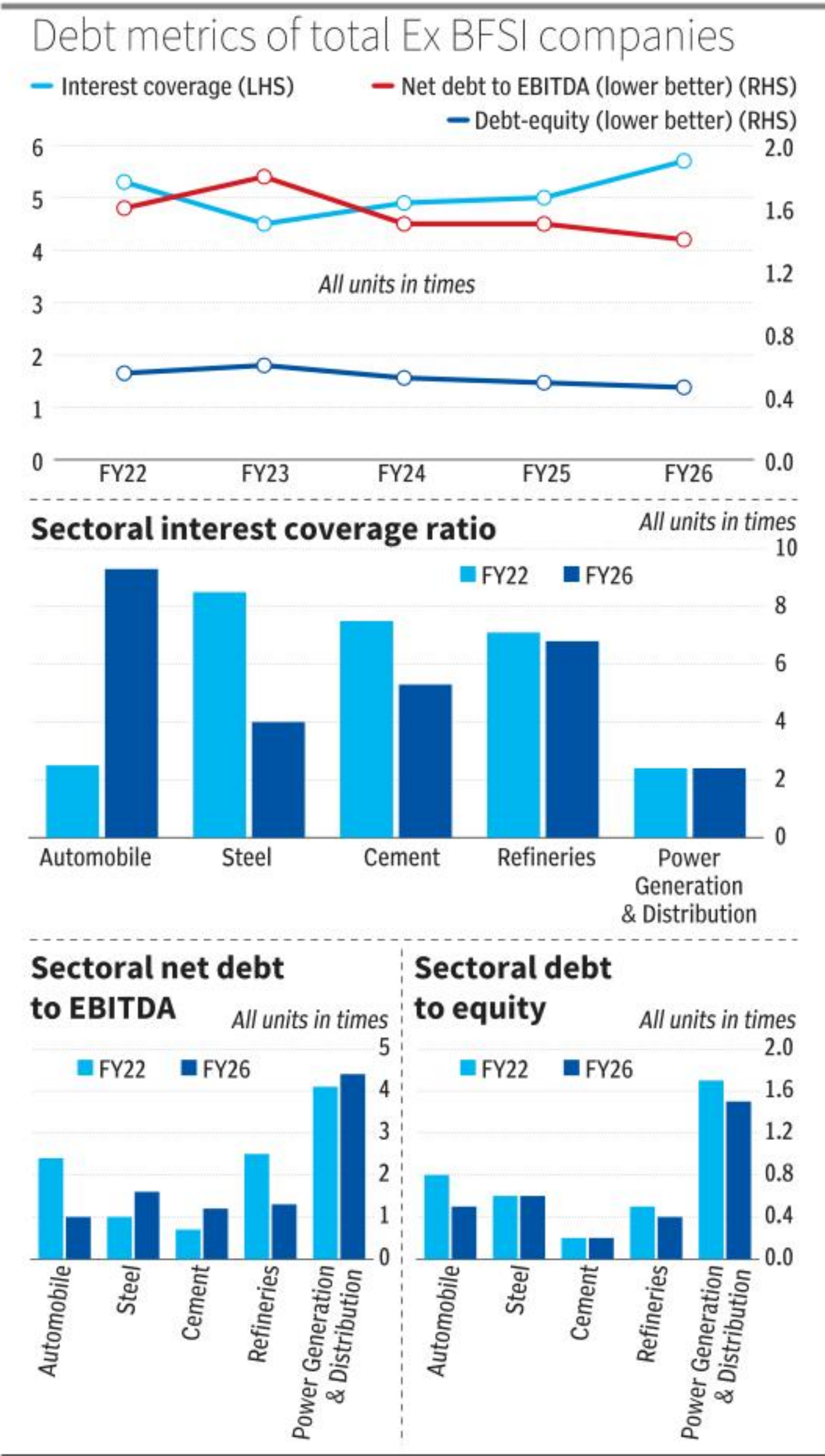
The automobile industry is in the midst of a strong upcycle. Demand for four-wheelers, higher feature content, sport utility vehicles and electric vehicles, along with the impact of the BS-VI transition and tighter safety regulations, has supported both realisations and volume growth. Modest price increases have not derailed demand, and the GST rate cut enacted late last year continues to have a positive effect, according to leading companies in the sector. Strong earnings have, in turn, helped automakers strengthen their balance sheets and improve debt indicators.

Steel and cement have followed a different route. These sectors have not benefited from the same pace of sales growth, but they have maintained strict control over financial leverage even while undertaking aggressive as-

set expansion. During FY22-26, steel reported revenue and gross block growth of 3 per cent and 10 per cent CAGR respectively, while cement recorded 10 per cent and 15 per cent CAGR growth on the same measures. Sales growth has lagged asset growth because both sectors have been building capacity ahead of future demand but have retained financial leverage targets.

The caution shown by steel and cement companies reflects lessons from the over-leveraging cycle of 2008-15. In the current phase, they have reduced debt even as they expanded capacity. Although leverage is now rising again, buoyant steel and cement prices, along with expectations of lower raw material costs such as coal and energy, should help support the additional debt if the operating environment remains favourable.

Other sectors present a more mixed picture. Refineries and power generation have not seen the same steady improvement in debt metrics. Power generation and transmission have faced strong demand, with revenue



growing at 13 per cent CAGR in FY22-26, matched by asset growth of 11 per cent CAGR. With the sector expected to nearly double current capacity by 2031-32, major players such as NTPC and the Adani Group are pursuing conventional, renewable and even nuclear generation, alongside energy storage solutions. Transmission capacity is also expanding, which is likely to

keep debt metrics elevated.

Refineries face a different challenge. Companies, including Reliance, were on an expansion path before the recent crude price shock.

If supply disruptions do not normalise, the sector’s financials could remain under pressure, forcing companies to reassess extensions. Transmission capacity is also expanding, which is likely to

OUTLOOK

Looking ahead, India Inc appears well placed to launch the next phase of investment. The need for fresh capital expenditure is becoming clearer as fixed asset turnover, has risen closer to peak at 1.65 times in FY26. Further sales growth is, therefore, likely to require asset addition. At the same time, EBITDA and PAT margins are also near peak levels, offering companies both the incentive and the capacity to invest.

With balance sheets at their strongest in years, a new capital addition cycle looks increasingly likely. Recent commentary from banks also points to credit growth being driven by MSMEs and the corporate sector. This suggests that the investment cycle may be supported by stronger access to credit as well.

The nature of capital expenditure is also changing. Investment momentum is shifting from traditional heavy industries toward alternative and emerging sectors such as renewables, energy storage, AI infrastructure, data centres, indigenous defence, electric mobility and hybrid technologies. These areas are gaining priority as companies respond to energy-transition goals, digitalisation, supply-chain localisation and evolving mobility standards. Conventional energy and refining players are also redirecting spending toward net-zero pathways, including renewable power, charging networks and cleaner fuel infrastructure.

Additional demand pools are emerging in hospitals and hotels, where expansion is being supported by stronger cash flows, wider geographic reach and healthier balance sheets. Overall, the capex narrative is becoming less dependent on traditional sectors and more anchored in alternative energy, digital infrastructure, defence indigenisation, healthcare and organised services. If India Inc can use its strengthened balance sheet wisely, the next five years could mark a shift from resilience to renewed growth.

ITR filing done! Here is your post-filing checklist

DE-TAX. Verification, revised returns, the Section 143(1) intimation and the refund cycle — a guide to the post-filing journey.

Desikan Govindarajan

Assessee - A hit submit on his ITR-1 at 10.42 pm on July 20. He closed his laptop and went to bed satisfied. What he did not do — for the next 38 days — was verify the return. On August 27, the portal marked it invalid. He had to file again.

His story is not unusual. Clicking submit closes only the first door. The second, third and fourth open in the weeks that follow — verification, the Section 143(1) intimation and the refund. Each has its own rules, its own deadlines, and its own consequences for the taxpayer who ignores them.

VERIFY FIRST

The Income-Tax department gives the taxpayer 30 days from the date of e-filing to verify the return. Miss the window, and the return is treated as never filed. Interest, penalty and the refund clock all reset. The department has held this line consistently across the last three assessment years.

Five verification routes stand open. Aadhaar OTP is the fastest — the portal sends a one-time password to the Aadhaar-linked mobile and closes the loop in under two minutes. Net-banking-based Electronic Verification Code (EVC), pre-validated bank account EVC, demat account EVC and Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) round out the digital options. A filer without any of these can print the ITR-V, sign it and post the physical copy to the Centralised Processing Centre in Bengaluru — a route the department will retire when it can, but which still counts for the paperless-averse.

Verification triggers processing. Once the return moves into the processing queue, three things become possible: The Section 143(1) intimation, the refund and — if the taxpayer spots errors or realises a loss was missed — the ability to file a



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revised return under Section 139(5).

The revised-return route matters more than most filers realise. A taxpayer who discovers after submission that a Section 80D receipt (health insurance) did not go in, or that a capital loss was not carried forward, can file a revised return through the same portal. For AY2026-27, the revised-return due date is December 31, 2026 — three months before the assessment year closes. It is important to note that to ensure the continuity of carry forward of losses for future set off, it is preferable to file the original return within due date.

Where the revision throws up additional tax, the taxpayer pays the shortfall and interest under Section 234A/B/C through the same self-assessment tax window under Section 140A (Challan 280, code 300) — the receipt number of the challan goes straight into the revised return under ‘details of tax paid’.

THE 143(1) INTIMATION

The Section 143(1) intimation is the first formal response the department sends to a return. In earlier

THE POST-FILING CHECKLIST

- Verify the return within 30 days of e-filing — Aadhaar OTP is the fastest route
- Track the Section 143(1) intimation for at least six to eight weeks post-verification
- Reconcile the intimation line by line against the return; act on any demand within 30 days
- File a revised return under Section 139(5) for genuine errors or missed loss carry-forward, on or before December 31 of the AY
- Ensure the bank account is pre-validated and Aadhaar-PAN linked before waiting on the refund
- Report any interest on refund received during the year as ‘income from other sources’ in next year’s return

seasons, it arrived after months. For AY2025-26, most ITR-1 filers received the intimation within four-six weeks of e-verification. The department must issue it within nine months from the end of the FY in which the return was filed — a statutory ceiling it now beats comfortably.

The intimation reads as a two-column reconciliation. The left column — ‘as provided by taxpayer’ — reprints the return. The right column — ‘as computed under Section 143(1)’ — shows what the department’s automated processing arrives at. If the two columns match,

the intimation closes with ‘no demand, no refund’ or ‘refund due’. If they differ, the intimation carries a demand (to pay additional tax) and the taxpayer must act.

For ITR-1 and ITR-2 filers, discrepancies cluster around a few predictable heads. TDS mismatch — where the amount claimed in the return does not match Form 26AS — leads the list. Interest income mismatch, where the AIS reports a savings-account interest higher than what the return declared, follows close behind. Section 87A rebate disallowance sits third: A filer who claimed the rebate, but

whose total income crossed the ₹12-lakh mark under new-regime or ₹5-lakh mark under old-regime sees the rebate reversed. HRA exemption denied because of a missing landlord PAN, Section 80D limits breached and Section 80C receipts unsubstantiated on random check round out the ITR-1 shortlist.

ITR-2 carries its own list. For AY 2025-26, the Finance Act, 2024 changed capital gains tax rates from July 23, 2024, so taxpayers are required to calculate capital gains separately for transactions before and after that date in Schedule CG. Filing return with only one calculation often triggers a demand. Foreign asset entries in Schedule FA, missing dividend income that AIS caught and mutual fund redemption gains not accounted for - top the ITR-2 mismatches.

The response path depends on who is right. If the department is right and the taxpayer accepts the demand, the taxpayer settles it within 30 days through Challan 280, code 400. If the taxpayer disagrees, the rectification route under Section 154 stays open for roughly four years. The taxpayer files the rectification application through the portal; the department must dispose of it within six months. Where the taxpayer finds a genuine error — of the sort that changes the substance of the return — filing a revised return under Section 139(5) is often the cleaner path, provided the December deadline has not passed. A revised return can be filed anytime before the completion of assessment; however, post the December deadline, only an ‘updated return’ can be filed, which has its additional tax and interest implications.

THE REFUND

For a return with a refund claim, the wait begins at e-verification. Generally, ITR-1 refunds triggered by

virtue of Section 87A rebate cluster around a two-three-week cycle. Straight salary-with-TDS refunds arrived in a fortnight in the AY2025-26 season. ITR-2 refunds — with capital gains, Schedule FA or Section 89 relief (salary arrears cases) — take longer, typically four-eight weeks, and where a full Section 143(1) intimation runs before the refund, longer still. Refunds arising from advance tax paid or TDS credit tend to move faster than refunds arising from self-assessment tax.

Prerequisites matter. A taxpayer whose bank account is not pre-validated on the e-filing portal will not see the refund credit. The same applies to accounts where Aadhaar and PAN have not been linked. Failed refunds sit in the ‘refund reissue’

queue; the taxpayer must trigger re-issuance from the portal after fixing the underlying account issue.

Section 244A provides interest on delayed refund. The rate is 0.5 per cent per month, or 6 per cent per annum, simple interest. For refunds arising from advance tax or TDS, interest runs from April 1 of the assessment year to the date the refund is granted, provided the refund exceeds 10 per cent of tax determined on assessment for the year. For refunds arising from self-assessment tax, interest runs from the date the return was filed. Where the delay is attributable to the taxpayer — a bank-account validation issue, an unresolved rectification request — the interest clock stops. The interest, when paid, is taxable in the

year of receipt under the head ‘income from other sources’.

THE TAKEAWAY

For the diligent filer, the post-filing journey rarely runs longer than a month between verification and refund credit. For the taxpayer with a mismatch, the journey stretches across quarters. The single common thread is the discipline of tracking. A simple checklist tracking the e-verification date, intimation date, refund credit date and a note against any Section 143(1) reconciliation ticks every box the season demands — and leaves the taxpayer with a clean record for the year that follows.

The author is a Partner at Venkatesh and Co. Chartered Accountants. With inputs from Hrishikesh D.

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Particulars	₹ in Crores	Consolidated			
		Quarter ended		Year ended	
		30.06.2026	31.03.2026	30.03.2025	31.03.2026
		Unaudited	Unaudited	Audited	Audited
1. Total Income from Operations	426.76	430.28	366.03	1605.49	
2. Net Profit / (Loss) from ordinary activities before tax, Exceptional and or Extraordinary items	35.07	35.40	27.73	114.27	
3. Net Profit / (Loss) from ordinary activities before tax, after Exceptional and or Extraordinary items	91.32	35.35	27.73	114.82	
4. Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax, (after extraordinary activities)	90.42	44.74	19.23	98.67	
5. Equity share capital	48.28	48.28	48.28	48.28	
6. Earnings Per Share					
(a) Basic	18.73	9.27	3.98	20.44	
(b) Diluted	18.73	9.27	3.98	20.44	

Notes:

1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Consolidated unaudited financial results for the quarter ended 30 Jun 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (LODR) Regulations 2015. The full format of the Financial Results are available at www.nseindia.com, www.bseindia.com and www.mmforgings.com.

2. The Company is engaged in only one segment.

3. Figures have been regrouped wherever necessary.

4. Pursuant to the order dated 29 June 2026 by the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal (Chennai bench), D V S Industries Private Limited, wholly-owned subsidiary (the "transferor company") was merged with the Company with an appointed date of 01 April 2024. The merger is a common control transaction and accordingly the financial information in the financial results in respect of the current and prior periods have been restated as per the requirements of Appendix C to Ind AS 103. The impact of amalgamation on the standalone financial results is immaterial.

Date: 14 Aug 2026

Place: Chennai



For and on behalf of the Board

Vidyashankar Krishnan

Chairman and Managing Director

Giant size tests a proven strategy

FUND CALL. Recent weakness masks a strong long-term record but scale is reshaping Parag Parikh Flexi Cap’s opportunity set

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl, research bureau

Over 13-year-old Parag Parikh Flexi Cap Fund (PPFCF), the largest actively-managed flexi-cap fund, has hit a relatively-weak patch. Its shorter-term performance has slipped, as the fund lost 0.6 per cent over the past year, while the Nifty 500 TRI gained 5.9 per cent, as per ACEMF. This has happened even as assets under management (AUM) have surged to about ₹1.48 lakh crore, reviving an old question: Has the fund become too large to sustain its past performance?

The concern deserves attention, but the evidence does not yet suggest that PPFCF’s investment process has broken. Its longer-term performance remains strong, while its ability to contain losses during falling markets stands out. What has clearly changed is the portfolio. But at nearly ₹1.5 lakh crore, smaller stock positions have to be very large before they can make a meaningful difference to fund returns. Restrictions have also progressively diluted its overseas allocation.

PPFCF is rated 5 stars under the bl.portfolio Star Track MF Ratings, along with HDFC Flexi Cap and JM Flexicap. Existing investors can continue to hold PPFCF and run their SIPs. Fresh investors with a long horizon can also consider it, but should moderate expectations of past outperformance.

RECORD STILL STRONG

Recent numbers explain some of the concern. Based on quartile rankings, PPFCF is currently in the fourth quartile over one year and the second quartile over three and five years. But it remains in the first quartile over seven years.

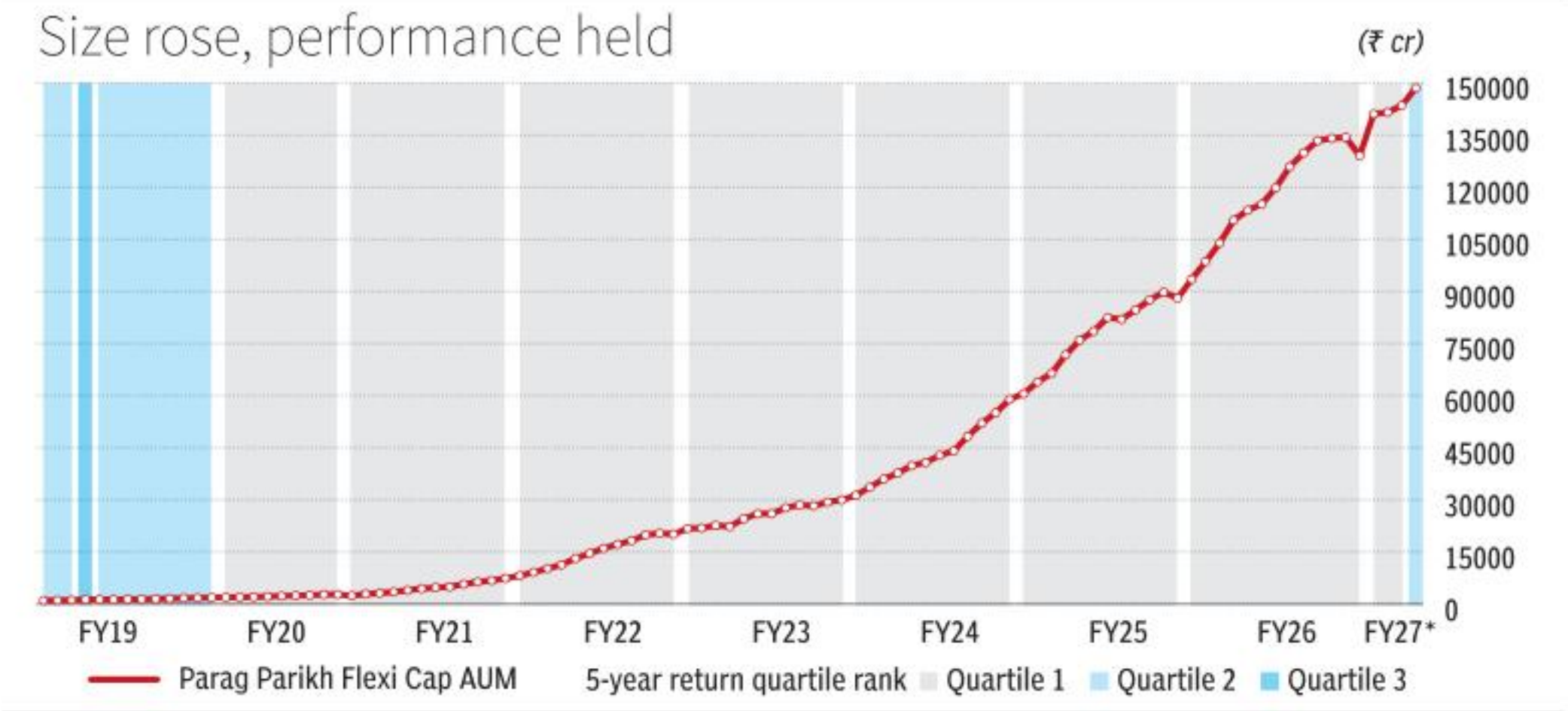
The longer history provides useful perspective. Across the 75 monthly seven-year observations available, PPFCF has ranked in the first quartile (top 25 per cent of comparable funds) every single time. Over five years, it has been in the first quartile in 85 of 99 observations.

Rolling returns (measure performance across multiple overlapping periods) tell a similar story. Its average three-year rolling return has been 20.6 per cent, against 16.1 per cent for the flexi-cap category and 16.7 per cent for the Nifty 500 TRI. More importantly, the fund’s minimum three-year rolling return was 12.8 per cent, higher than its category.

The way PPFCF has generated returns is equally important. Over the latest three-year period, its beta is just 0.61, the lowest among the flexi-cap peers analysed. Its upside capture ratio is about 74, meaning it has captured substantially less of the benchmark’s gains during rising periods. But its downside capture is just 42, the lowest among peers. Put simply, the fund has historically given up some gains in strong markets



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO



bl.portfolio calculations Data source: ACEMF *up to July-26

but has participated far less in declines. Its upside-to-downside capture ratio is the best among peers. It also ranks at the top on Sharpe and Sortino ratios, which measure risk-adjusted returns.

This helps explain why judging PPFCF solely by recent returns can be misleading. It has never needed to top every rising market to compound well over long periods.

Still, the return weakness should not be brushed aside. The fund’s five-year return ranking slipping into the second quartile is notable, as it had remained in the first quartile for nearly seven years. This is a metric investors should watch.

SIZE CHANGES THINGS

The more difficult question concerns size. When we reviewed PPFCF in May 2023 (https://tinyurl.com/ppfcf2023bl), its AUM was around ₹35,000 crore. It has more than quadrupled in a little over three years. At today’s ₹1.48-lakh crore AUM, even a 1 per cent portfolio position requires nearly ₹1,500 crore.

Suppose the fund identifies an attractive smaller company and invests ₹500 crore. That would account for only about 0.34 per cent of PPFCF’s portfolio. Even if the stock doubles, its contribution to the fund’s return would be only about 34 basis points.

The portfolio shows the con-

sequences of operating at this scale, although size is not necessarily the sole reason. PPFCF currently has only about 3.2 per cent in mid-cap stocks, the lowest among the 45 flexi-cap funds we analysed. Its 4.2 per cent small-cap allocation is the second-lowest. The corresponding peer averages are around 19.7 per cent and 20.5 per cent.

Yet, describing PPFCF as a closet large-cap or index-like fund would be wrong. It takes substantial active positions within the universe of large companies. Its holdings in ITC, Power Grid, Coal India, Bajaj Holdings and HCL Technologies, for instance, are substantially higher than their corresponding weights in the flexi-cap category. IT software accounts for over 10 per cent of PPFCF today, against about 6 per cent for the category.

The fund has also substantially altered sectors over time. Capital-market stocks, once a major allocation, have been cut sharply, for instance.

Thus, size has not stopped PPFCF from taking active calls. Instead, it appears to have changed where those calls can be large enough to matter.

There is also a counterpoint to the size argument. HDFC Flexi Cap itself manages over ₹1 lakh crore but maintains substantially more mid-cap exposure (nearly 14 per cent). Hence, large AUM alone cannot explain PPFCF’s portfolio construction.

More importantly, PPFCF continued to produce strong longer-term relative performance even after its AUM became very large. Its five-year return ranking stayed in the first quartile for most monthly observations after AUM crossed ₹50,000 crore, and initially remained there even after AUM crossed ₹1 lakh crore. Its seven-year return ranking has remained in the first quartile in all 75 monthly observations available. Scale has changed its playing field, but there is not enough evidence yet to conclude that it has broken the strategy.

DIFFERENT ENGINE

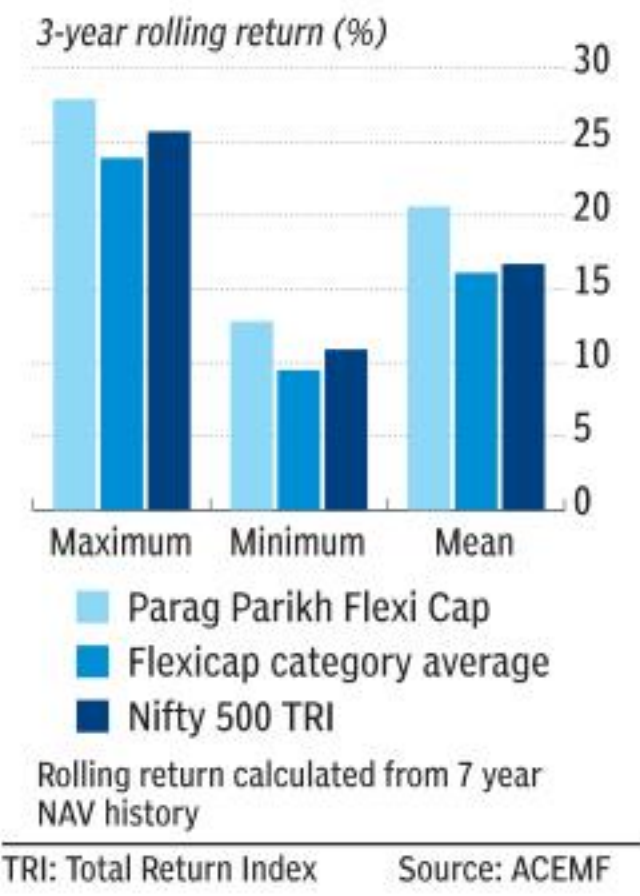
Today’s PPFCF is quite different from the typical flexi-cap fund. Its equity exposure is around 83 per cent, compared with roughly 95 per cent on average for peers. Its portfolio is also far cheaper. At about 20 times earnings, its portfolio P/E is the lowest among peers and roughly half the category average. Its price-to-book valuation (3.5x) is also the lowest, while its dividend yield (2.44 per cent) is the highest. This reflects PPFCF’s longstanding preference for buying businesses at valuations it considers reasonable rather than following popular parts of the market.

Liquidity has also played an important role. Cash and other liquid/debt-type holdings rose substantially as the managers found fewer attractive oppor-

A different construct

Selected parameter	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	Category average
Total equity allocation (%)	83.3	95.5
Mid cap allocation (%)	3.2	19.7
Small cap allocation (%)	4.2	20.5
Others' allocation (%)	27.8	10.5
Portfolio P/E (times)	20.4	39.6
Portfolio P/B (times)	3.5	7.6
Dividend yield (%)	2.44	0.9

Rolling returns performance



tunities. These have since been deployed as valuations became more favourable. The management recently said cash was down to around 14-15 per cent and could move lower if opportunities continue to emerge.

Another structural change has been overseas equities. International stocks were once one of PPFCF’s biggest differentiators. Overseas exposure crossed 30 per cent in 2021, but is now around 11 per cent. This should not be interpreted as the fund turning bearish on overseas stocks. Mutual funds have faced regulatory limits on fresh overseas investments since the industry reached the permitted limit. PPFCF’s rapidly-growing domestic inflows have consequently diluted its existing overseas holdings as a proportion of the portfolio.

Thus, investors buying PPFCF today aren’t buying exactly the portfolio architecture that generated its early track record. That is the main risk alongside size. The fund increasingly has to generate excess returns through large-cap stock selection, sector positioning, valuation discipline and asset allocation rather than meaningful bets on smaller companies or a large overseas portfolio.

The investment philosophy remains recognisable, the portfolio continues to take differentiated calls, and its recent three-year downside-capture record remains exceptional. The test from here is not whether PPFCF tops every return table. It is whether it can continue to lose less in difficult markets while earning enough in good ones to compound ahead of peers over a full market cycle.

Jane Street’s first slump in a decade

GLOBAL VIEW. The company’s downturn amid volatile stock markets in July forces it to locally be more selective about risk

Bloomberg

Jane Street posted roughly \$15 billion of losses in July — its first monthly slump in about a decade — as AI-focused hedge fund Situational Awareness swooned and dragged down asset prices across equity markets, according to a person familiar with the matter.

Jane Street, which invests in Situational Awareness and directly invests in AI ventures, suffered a rare and severe downturn amid volatile stock markets. The company’s investment in the hedge fund, as well as wrong-way bets in Asian equity markets, drove part of the losses, said the person, who asked not to be identified citing private details.

“July was a bad month,” Turner Batty, a Jane Street partner, said in an internal note.

Still, the firm has generated more than \$40 billion of net trading revenue so far this year, more than it did in all of 2025 when it set a Wall Street record, the person said.

“Despite the large year-to-date increase in trading capital,

REFINANCING DEAL

Jane Street was rattled by Situational Awareness and the equity market turmoil as it was preparing to issue \$14.6 billion of bonds this week to overhaul its debt load



the recency of these losses has caused us to locally be more selective about risk,” Batty said. “We’ve closed a significant portion of our risk in the specific areas we lost on in July, and have also reduced risk-taking in other strategies.”

SITUATIONAL AWARENESS

The market maker described the impact of the debacle at Situational Awareness while seeking to refinance billions of dollars of debt, according to the Financial Times, which earlier reported the loss.

Jane Street was rattled by Situational Awareness and the equity market turmoil as it was preparing to issue \$14.6 billion

of bonds this week to overhaul its debt load. It’s a stumble for the market maker that invested early in some of AI’s biggest players, including Anthropic PBC and CoreWeave Inc., adding to profits from its business handling thousands of trades within milliseconds.

In July, Situational Awareness faced margin calls after AI bets soured, leading the hedge fund to strike a deal with Ken Griffin’s Citadel to offload a big chunk of its public equity book. While the last-minute transac-

tion helped the fund recover, the initial stumble led to a dwindling of assets.

Jane Street said Situational Awareness’ drawdown left its stake flat on the year, but noted that the investment is still up over the life of the bet.

Jane Street has been setting record after record in recent years, including \$39.6 billion of trading revenue for 2025.

While the figure includes gains on long-term investments as well as the work handling trades, it surpassed Wall Street

peers including Goldman Sachs Group Inc. and JPMorgan Chase & Co.

DEBT DEAL

In Jane Street’s latest debt deal, investors including Pacific Investment Management Co., Capital Group and Fidelity bought in, which was issued across three bonds, filings show. The refinancing allowed the market maker to fund technology infrastructure and expand its trading strategies, Bloomberg previously reported.

The new fixed-rate deal, led by JPMorgan Chase & Co., is part of Jane Street’s plan to repay its floating-rate loans and revamp its \$11-billion capital stack.

Batty said in the internal note that the desks have reduced exposures in strategies that contributed to volatility.

“Our positions currently seem appropriate for our present risk tolerance,” he said. “Market volumes have been strong, and we’ve continued to make improvements to our short time horizon strategies, that trading seems more profitable than ever.”

WHO AM I?

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here’s a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- 1 I was founded less than two decades ago. One of the founders exited my board last year without any change in the shareholding pattern.
- 2 One of my early backers, a well-renowned private equity fund, exited a part of its stake at a 5-times gain through an IPO within five years and several times more through market sales.
- 3 I resisted the temptation to have a celebrity brand ambassador all these years, but recently signed up a Bollywood star for endorsement.
- 4 I did a buyback recently, and the promoters’ stake increased since they chose not to tender. In fact, they have been making creeping acquisitions as well.
- 5 I have disappointed shareholders with negative returns in recent years despite rising revenues and a strong, debt-free balance sheet.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by
UNIFI CAPITAL
Investing With Conviction

Last week’s stock:
Shyam Metals & Energy
Last week’s winner:
Kavitha Sekar

ETF movers

Top ETFs (Exchange Traded Funds) traded on NSE based on weekly change in price

	NAV (₹) as on Aug 14	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
ETF				
Motilal Oswal Nasdaq Q50	126.0	150.2	4.1	135
Groww Nifty India Internet	10.6	10.6	3.3	3,001
Mir Asset Nifty Ind Internet	14.3	14.3	3.0	1,045
Nippon Ind Nifty Ind Manufacturing	166.3	169.3	2.9	21
Groww Nifty Midcap 150 ETF	234.9	236.1	2.7	13
UTI Nifty 10 Yr G-Sec ETF	26.8	27.0	2.1	3
Groww Nifty Capital Markets	11.2	11.2	2.1	2,179
GOLD ETFs				
LIC MF Gold ETF	136.1	136.4	1.6	487
Mirae Asset Gold ETF	146.8	147.2	1.5	6,541
ABSL Gold ETF	132.8	133.2	1.5	6,234

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on August 14, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR

Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on Aug 14	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)
		3-year	5-year	10-year	
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	55.1	11.7	10.9	13.0	83,530
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	75.5	12.6	11.8	12.8	31,712
Kotak Pension Fund	68.9	12.0	11.6	12.7	4,858
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
LIC Pension Fund	31.9	7.5	6.7	7.9	9,264
SBI Pension Fund	42.7	7.5	6.7	7.4	31,312
HDFC Pension Fund	29.2	7.1	6.4	7.3	56,674
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	31.0	8.1	7.1	8.0	36,261
SBI Pension Fund	46.8	8.0	6.8	7.8	16,480
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	46.6	7.9	6.8	7.8	14,635
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	47.8	11.8	11.0	13.0	1,921
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	59.6	12.3	11.8	12.8	852
Kotak Pension Fund	60.6	12.0	11.6	12.6	233

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on August 14, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns

AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)		
			1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP					
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	364	14.9	20.6	24.1
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE Bluechip	5	8.7	17.9	16.8
ICICI Pru	Largecap	905	7.5	17.6	15.5
Ksema Wealth	Alpha	16	6.3	12.5	13.8
MULTI CAP					
New Berry Capitals	Seeking Alpha	9	14.9	17.5	32.9
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	8,686	15.3	33.8	24.0
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	121	10.2	24.3	23.4
Samvitti Capital	PMS Active Alpha Multicap	483	8.3	20.6	22.2
Systematix Shares And Stock (I)	Dynamic Investment	NA	18.2	23.6	20.4
ICICI Pru	Value Strategy	1,180	10.6	18.2	20.1
MID-CAP					
Right Horizons	Super Value	NA	12.2	14.0	17.1
Sundaram Alternate Assets	Self Portfolio	NA	35.6	21.9	15.5
Nippon Life India	Emerging India	NA	9.8	16.3	15.1
NAFA Asset Managers	Emerging Bluechip	NA	-4.4	11.3	14.9
SMALL CAP					
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	2,319	30.1	28.5	29.6
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	1,026	4.0	20.0	28.2
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,533	-4.5	22.0	21.1
Green Portfolio	Super 30 Dynamic Fund	248	16.8	19.0	20.1

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on July 31, 2026

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

The IPO of Horizon Industrial Parks (HIPL), the owner and operator of industrial and logistics infrastructure, opens for subscription on Monday. The Blackstone-backed company aims to raise ₹2,600 crore through a fresh issue of shares, primarily to pay down ₹2,250 crore of borrowings. There is no offer for sale component. Blackstone's (through its affiliate entities) pre-IPO stake of 88.7 per cent stands diluted to 75.4 per cent post the issue.

As an owner and operator of Grade-A warehouses and manufacturing facilities that generate lease income, HIPL gives investors exposure to India's broader manufacturing and consumption-led GVA (gross value added) growth. However, considering the risk factors laid out here, the asking price at 31.3x post-issue enterprise value (EV) to EBITDA (FY26) appears expensive. Investors may therefore give the IPO a pass for now and look for more attractive entry points in the future.

WHAT IT DOES

HIPL owns and operates three kinds of Grade-A logistics and industrial assets — fulfilment centres, industrial facilities and in-city centres.

Fulfilment centres are basically large warehouses ranging from 50,000 sq ft to 0.5 million sq ft, let out to customers belonging to e-commerce, third-party logistics, FMCG and retail sectors. At 16.3 million sq ft, fulfilment centres account for 57 per cent of HIPL's operational assets by area.

Industrial facilities are similar large sites ranging from 50,000 sq ft to 0.8 million sq ft designed to support assembly lines, light engineering, manufacturing activities and let out to companies belonging to sectors such as automotive, renewable energy, electronics, aerospace and telecom. These facilities span 11.4 million sq ft and account for 40 per cent of operational assets by area. HIPL also executes turnkey fit-outs (like structures, storage racks) on the lessee's request and thus, industrial facilities typically have slightly higher rental yield relative to fulfilment centres.

As the name suggests, in-city centres are facilities located within the city, designed for purposes such as quick-commerce dark stores, online pharma, D2C businesses, large-format retail and cloud kitchens. Unlike the fulfilment centres and industrial facilities, which are located at about one-two hours from city centres, in-city centres are located around urban residential areas, at 10-30 minutes from the end-consumer. At 0.8 million sq ft, these account for the rest of HIPL's operational portfolio. In-city assets command premium rental prices, equivalent to sub-urban commercial real estate and earn substantially higher than fulfilment and industrial assets.

WHAT WORKS

HIPL has strong promoter backing in Blackstone, the American alternative asset management firm. Globally, Blackstone manages assets worth over \$1.3 trillion and about 1,200 million sq ft of logistics assets.

Horizon stands to directly

A warehouse bet with little room

IPO WATCH. Considering execution risks including high debt, Horizon Industrial Parks' asking price of 31.3x post-issue EV to EBITDA appears expensive



How the numbers stack up

Proforma figures	FY24	FY25	FY26
Total area of network assets (msf)*	47.1	52.9	61.1
Area of operational assets (msf)*	20.7	23.3	28.6
Area of assets under development (msf)*	26.4	29.6	32.6
Total income (₹ cr)	476	645	765
EBITDA (₹ cr)	326	502	605
EBITDA margin (%)	68	78	79
Depreciation & amortisation (₹ cr)	238	202	259
Finance cost (₹ cr)	398	484	527
Net profit after tax (₹ cr)	-271	-227	-184

Proforma financials represent the group's figures as if acquisitions, mergers done during FY24-26 had been completed as of March 31, 2023. msf - million square feet
*Latest figures as of May 31, 2026 given instead of as of FY26-end Source: RHP

cent of which is on freehold basis with the rest on long-term leasehold basis (typically for over 90 years). Typically spanning 50-100 acres,

these land parcels are located in India's top 10 industrial and consumption hubs which include metros and tier-1 cities such as Hydera-

Private value into public light

IPO WATCH. Gaja offers strong fund credentials but earnings mix limits valuation comfort

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Gaja Alternative Asset Management's ₹550-crore IPO, the first by a pure-play home-grown alternatives asset manager, opens August 19-21. The issue comprises a 2.81-crore-share fresh issue worth ₹450 crore and a 0.63-crore-share OFS worth ₹100 crore. Promoter-group stake falls from 71 per cent to 54 per cent post issue.

At ₹160/share, the alternatives asset manager's market cap will be about ₹2,256 crore (small-cap). Of the fresh proceeds, ₹372 crore will go towards sponsor commitments across Fund IV, Fund V and the Secondaries Fund, including repayment of a bridge loan.

Gaja offers investors exposure to a two-decade-old alternative asset manager with a credible investment record, especially in mid-market segment, sizeable carried-interest economics and substantial sponsor investments in its own funds.

While the business has attractive long-term optionality, the composition of current earnings (explained later) makes the headline valuation of around 28 times FY26 profit less attractive than it first appears. Its 52 per cent FY26 PAT margin appears robust, but top AMCs (selling mutual funds) on a sustained basis clock 55-60 per cent margins.

Thus, investors can wait and watch for now, and revisit it once there is greater visibility on fundraising and growth in recurring management-fee income.

BUSINESS BASICS

Alternatives are not entirely new to public market investors in India, with listed firms such as 360 ONE, Nuvama and Motilal Oswal, as well as AMCs including HDFC AMC, Nippon AMC, UTI AMC and ICICI Pru AMC, already offering some exposure to the segment.

Gaja acts as investment manager to India-focussed funds, including Category I and Category II alternative investment funds (AIFs), and also advises offshore funds, which provide capital to companies in India.

Key performance indicators

	FY24	FY25	FY26
Management fee (₹ cr)	75.8	57.5	60
Carried interest (₹ cr)	18.4	64.4	75.4
Income from sponsor commitment/ investments in funds (₹ cr)	6.9	0	16.7
Consolidated PAT (₹ cr)	44.7	61.9	82
Cost-to-income (%)	47.1	52.3	44.6
PAT margin (%)	43	50.2	51.9
Return on net worth (%)	13.4	15.3	13.1

Source: RHP

logy platforms.

A typical private-equity fund has a lifecycle of eight to 10 years. The funds managed and advised by Gaja raise capital from investors and invest it in portfolio companies. Gaja oversees these investments and eventually seeks exits through IPOs, strategic sales or secondary transactions.

Its revenue comes principally from three sources. First is management fee, charged on capital committed or invested by external investors. This is the most predictable component of earnings.

Second is carried interest, or Gaja's performance-linked share of profits generated by funds.

Third is income from sponsor commitments, arising because Gaja itself commits capital to the funds it manages and participates in the investment returns generated by those funds.

Sponsor income reflects fair-value gains, while carried interest is recognised once Gaja's right to payment is established, though cash receipt can lag.

Gaja's funds have invested in companies including People Home Finance, Fractal Analytics, Eggoz Nutrition, Signzy, Amber, LeadSquared, Xpressbees, RBL Bank, Educational Initiatives, Avendus, Kinara, Suryoday, SportzVillage, Bakers Circle, EuroKids, Carnation, John Distilleries, TeamLease and CL Educate.

Gaja's investment record, across market cycles, is one of the stronger parts of the proposition. Early investments realised 5.61x multiple on invested capital (MOIC); Fund II 3.81x/18.61 per cent IRR (internal rate of return); Fund III 1.88x/9.4 per cent; Fund IV 1.74x/27.91 per cent. Returns are gross. Fund III is partially realised and Fund IV is still under deployment.

IPO rating

Gaja Alternative Asset Management	
Business	★★★★★
Financials	★★★★★
Management	★★★★★
Valuation	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Rankings 1 to 5, 1 denoting lowest and 5 highest

Offer period	Aug 19-21, 2026
Price band (per share)	₹152-160
Implied market cap (at upper band)	₹2,256 cr

INSIDE FINANCIALS

The key consideration lies not in Gaja's reported growth, but in the composition of that growth.

Total income rose from ₹103.96 crore in FY24 to ₹157.80 crore in FY26, while PAT increased from ₹44.74 crore to ₹81.96 crore. Yet management fees, the recurring component, fell from ₹75.85 crore to ₹60.08 crore, reducing their income share from 73 per cent to 38 per cent. Carried interest rose from ₹18.40 crore to ₹75.41 crore, or 48 per cent of FY26 income; income from sponsor commitments dropped ₹16.74 crore, or 11 per cent.

In other words, close to three-fifths of FY26 income came from carried interest and sponsor investments rather than recurring management fees. Sponsor-investment gains are volatile: ₹16.74 crore in FY26 came from fair-value gains, while income was nil in FY25.

Note, effective tax rates stayed low — 19 per cent in FY24, a tax credit in FY25 and 6 per cent in FY26 — making reported PAT less representative.

Gaja's cost-to-income ratio fell from 52 per cent in FY25 to 45 per cent in FY26, but is still much higher than top traditional AMCs (20-33 per cent). Cash flows also warrant some attention. Despite reporting PAT of

₹61.95 crore in FY25 and ₹81.96 crore in FY26, Gaja reported negative operating cash flow of ₹8.75 crore and ₹14.98 crore, respectively.

Two consecutive years in which substantial accounting profits have not translated into operating cash flows are worth monitoring.

Gaja's investment-management operations are inherently scalable and require limited physical capital. But it cannot be regarded in quite the same manner as a conventional capital-light AMC.

Gaja has committed about ₹274 crore as sponsor capital across its funds, or 6.41 per cent of their aggregate size; Fund IV's sponsor commitment is higher at 8.45 per cent. This aligns Gaja with its limited partners and gives earnings exposure to fund performance, but also locks up capital and exposes shareholders to illiquid private-market assets.

DECODING VALUATION

At ₹160 a share, Gaja is valued at around ₹2,256 crore (m-cap), or roughly 28 times FY26 PAT. At first glance, this appears reasonable. Listed Indian wealth managers (trailing 30-46x multiple), mutual fund companies (30-49x) and global alternative managers (32-40x) can appear a tad more expensive. That comparison, however, requires caution. Traditional AMCs derive the overwhelming share of their earnings from recurring management fees. For instance, management fees accounted for 85 per cent of FY26 total income for recently-listed SBI Funds. Gaja's FY26 profitability is far more dependent on carried interest and gains on sponsor investments, which can vary significantly.

Also, due to its sizeable capital base and sponsor investments, Gaja's pre-IPO FY26 Return on Net Worth (RoNW) of 13.13 per cent trails most listed peers, which range from 24.13 per cent to 79.07 per cent; only UTI AMC and 360 ONE rank lower. Given all of the above, applying similar headline P/E multiples risks overstating Gaja's cheapness. Successful fundraising can improve the investment case by expanding recurring fees without proportionate cost increases. But at the IPO price, investors are paying ahead of that execution, leaving limited valuation comfort.

Wait for a better shine

IPO WATCH. Investors can look for clarity on Lalithaa Jewellery's profitability trend

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Lalithaa Jewellery Mart, a South India-focused jewellery retailer, will open its ₹1,700-crore IPO from August 17 to 19. It comprises a fresh issue of ₹1,200 crore and an offer for sale of ₹500 crore. Of the fresh issue, ₹1,033 crore will fund 10 new stores.

The price band is ₹190-201. At the upper end, the company will have a market capitalisation of around ₹11,500 crore and is valued at 11.3 times FY26 earnings on post-issue shares. Promoter holding will be around 82.85 per cent after the offer.

Here's our analysis on the company and our take on whether you should subscribe to this IPO.

BUSINESS, GROWTH

The Indian gems and jewellery retail industry was estimated at ₹12.89 lakh crore in FY26 and may reach ₹15.1-15.5 lakh crore by FY30. Retail chains' share increased from 30-35 per cent in FY20 to 37-42 per cent in FY26 and is expected to reach 45-50 per cent by FY30.

South India accounts for around 40 per cent of the market and this is the primary focus of Lalithaa Jewellery Mart. The company caters to the price-conscious mass market in southern India, offering gold, silver and diamond jewellery through competitive value-addition charges, large showrooms and a wide assortment.

It operates 61 company-operated stores across 51 cities in Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Karnataka and Puducherry, covering 6.51 lakh sq ft. Of these, 58 operate from leased premises. Notably, eight of the 10 proposed stores are in Tamil Nadu, which already contributes 54 per cent of revenue.

Gold jewellery contributed 92.33 per cent of FY26 revenue and silver jewellery and articles 6.63 per cent. Separately, studded gold generated only 1.04 per cent revenue, down from 2.16 per cent in FY24. Studded revenue declined 28 per cent during this period despite total revenue growing 48 per cent. Studded jewellery are the ones that is embedded with stones like diamond and thus carries relatively higher



Financial performance

	FY24	FY25	FY26
Revenue (₹ cr)	16,788	16,897	25,024
EBITDA (₹ cr)	680	740	1,674
PAT (₹ cr)	360	365	1,010
EBITDA margins (%)	4.1	4.4	6.7
PAT margins (%)	2.1	2.1	4.0

Source: Company RHP

margin over plain gold jewellery.

FY26 revenue per store was around ₹410 crore and revenue per sq ft was ₹3.84 lakh, among the best in the organised jewellery space.

Jewellery schemes encourage repeat purchases and fund working capital, but comes at a cost through discounts in value-addition charges. In FY26, the company wrote down inventory by ₹273 crore because realisable value under scheme commitments was below its carrying value.

FINANCIALS

Revenue grew at a 22.1 per cent CAGR between FY24 and FY26 to ₹25,024 crore. Operating EBITDA increased from ₹680 crore to ₹1,674 crore and margin expanded from 4.05 per cent to 6.69 per cent. PAT rose from ₹360 crore to ₹1,010 crore, with margin improving from 2.14 per cent to 4.04 per cent.

But revenue was almost flat in FY25 before rising 48 per cent in FY26, aided substantially by surge in gold prices in FY26. Average gold realisation increased from ₹59.6 lakh per kg in FY24 to ₹1.06 crore in FY26, while gold sold declined 16.6 per cent to 21,691 kg. With stores increasing from 53 to 61, average volume per store fell about 28 per cent. Hence, given that price increase in gold played a significant role in revenue, FY26 margins and return ratios may not be sustainable, particularly in

IPO rating

Horizon Industrial Parks	
Business	★★★★★
Financials	★★★★★
Management	★★★★★
Valuation	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Rankings 1 to 5, 1 denoting lowest and 5 highest

Offer period	Aug 17-19, 2026
Price band	₹57-60
Market cap approx.	₹17,300 cr

are negotiated for typical terms of 5-10 years. The agreements also carry a rent escalation clause of 4.5-5 per cent per annum. Besides leasing, HIPL also offers ancillary services such as turnkey solutions (as said above), rooftop solar, cold storage and on-site staff accommodation. Overall, rent charged per sq ft per month has grown at a CAGR of 7.7 per cent between FY23 and May 31, 2026 (3.2 years).

WHAT DOES NOT WORK

HIPL is still in its infancy. It became operational only in May 2021 when Blackstone acquired the business from the Embassy group and Jazz Leaf Investment. While it has commissioned 28.6 million sq ft of assets quickly in over five years, it has left the company deeply in debt. As of FY26, gross debt stands at about ₹6,900 crore or 11.4x FY26 EBITDA. Readers can refer to the table to infer how despite robust EBITDA margins, the company still ends up in losses due to interest cost. Depreciation is largely non-cash in HIPL's line of business as the assets do not cost a lot to upkeep.

The fresh issue proceeds do bring debt down. Post-is-

sue, net-debt to EBITDA improves to 2.75x. However, the asking multiple of 31.3x EV/EBITDA (post-IPO) is still expensive due to the following reasons.

As said above, assets are almost fully occupied. Hence, growth must come from operationalising and leasing out incremental assets. Per the RHP, HIPL expects to develop the said 32.6 million sq ft in four-five years and it would need a ballpark ₹8,000 crore to build (per inputs from the management). Currently, the company's internally-accrued cash flows do not have the bandwidth to support such capex. After repaying ₹2,250 crore of debt, the company would be left with roughly ₹2,000 crore in cash for development, implying that the remaining ₹6,000 crore of capex would need to be funded through fresh debt, to the extent of the shortfall that internal cash flows cannot bridge. For perspective, in FY26, HIPL generated ₹481 crore of pre-tax operating cash flows.

Per our model (which itself is based on optimistic assumptions including ignoring the time gap between commissioning and letting out), by FY28, we estimate HIPL to have cumulatively operationalised about 40 million sq ft and generating EBITDA such that the EV/EBITDA multiple works out to 17x. Considering the execution risks around this business, even that valuation leaves little room for slippages and still appears expensive. This especially holds for risk-averse investors who can look at REITs as alternatives which already generate good dividend yield and have a portfolio of mature assets.

also come at a cost since those schemes carry discount in value-addition charges.

Borrowings increased 69 per cent to ₹1,604 crore in FY26. However, outstanding borrowings dropped nearly 23 per cent to ₹1,238 crore as of June 2026.

Other concerns include the absence of e-commerce revenue and a decline in studded jewellery's revenue share from 2.16 per cent in FY24 to 1.04 per cent in FY26. Supplier concentration is also high as the largest supplier accounted for 50.44 per cent of FY26 purchases.

SHOULD YOU SUBSCRIBE?

The company has achieved considerable scale and high store productivity. The continuing shift from unorganised jewellers to retail chains also provides a structural growth opportunity.

However, unhedged gold inventory, weak cash conversion and an inventory-intensive expansion plan limit the margin of safety. Higher gold prices can suppress demand and increase working capital requirements, while unexpected volatility can expose inventory to markdown risk.

Lalithaa Jewellery Mart is valued at about 11.3 times reported FY26 earnings. This appears inexpensive, but FY26 profitability coincided with a sharp rise in gold prices and a substantial margin expansion. Also, considering the average profits through FY24 to FY26, the P/E ratio stands around 20. Hence, we would prefer a wait and watch approach for now and investors can wait for more clarity to assess sustainable and long-term profit margins.

Amongst listed peers, Senco Gold is trading cheaper at a trailing PE of 10 times, while PN Gadgil Jewellers is at 20 times and others like Kalyan Jewellers and Thanga Mayil Jewellery are at around 40 times, which is quite expensive. While Lalithaa, Senco and PN Gadgil had negative operating cash flow in FY26, Kalyan and Thanga Mayil had positive operating cash flow.

businessline's editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — Editor

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (24,366) and Nifty Bank (57,491) slipped 0.8 per cent and 0.4 per cent, respectively, last week. While the derivatives data show mixed signs, the chart of Nifty futures and Nifty Bank futures show that some key support levels are valid, leaving room for a rally. Below is an analysis.

NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (Aug) (24,450), after opening flat last Monday, saw a decline in the following sessions and posted a weekly loss of 0.8 per cent. As the contract fell, the outstanding open interest rose from 120.5 lakh contracts to 127.3 lakh contracts over the last week. This indicates short build-up.

The Put Call Ratio (PCR) of Nifty weekly options stood at 0.9 on Friday, showing a bearish inclination, whereas the ratio of monthly options stood at 1.

Overall, the futures and options data gives a bearish bias to Nifty futures.

Coming to the chart, while the contract made an intra-week low of 24,363.20 on Wednesday, it managed to close above an important support at 24,400. The 21-day moving average coincides at this level, making it a good base.

The price action over the last few days shows that there is buying interest between 24,380 and 24,450. There is a good chance for Nifty futures to see a fresh leg of rally from the current level.

On the upside, Nifty futures have the potential to retest the resistance at 24,750. A breakout of 24,750 can open the door for a rally to 25,000.

On the other hand, if the contract breaches the support at 24,400, the near-term outlook can turn weak.

Notable support levels below 24,400 can be spotted at 24,200 and 24,000. A trendline is likely



to provide support between 24,200 and 24,000.

Strategy: Buy Nifty futures (Aug) now at 24,450 and place a stop-loss at 24,300. When the contract rises to 24,600, raise the stop-loss to 24,480. Book profits at 24,750.

Option traders can consider buying 24,500-call option of August monthly expiry (₹136.55). Buy at the current level and we suggest holding it till expiry. In case the premium rises to ₹300, exit this trade.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank futures (Aug) (57,696) lost 0.6 per cent last week. That said, the price action during this period shows that it remained within a range.

The outstanding open interest of August futures saw a marginal increase from 20.8 lakh contracts to 21 lakh contracts.

This implies that shorts were

ROOM FOR RALLY

- Index futures witness short build-up
- Yet, key support levels remain valid
- Traders can consider long positions

added albeit at a small scale. Also, The PCR of August options stood at 0.80 on Friday, showing bearish inclination.

Therefore, derivatives data of Nifty Bank denotes that a decline is likely.

Thar said, the chart shows that the August futures has largely been consolidating between 57,400 and 58,200. Technically, the direction of the breach of this price band will decide the path of the next trend.

A breakout of 58,200 can trig-

ger a rally to 60,000. Instead, if Nifty Bank futures breaches the support at 57,400, it can drop to 57,000 and subsequently to 56,500.

Nevertheless, the support at 57,400 is a strong base and we put the probability of Nifty Bank futures breaking out of 58,200 higher than that of it breaking below 57,400.

Strategy: Retain the long position that we suggested to initiate on the breakout of 58,000 before a couple of weeks. Maintain the stop-loss 57,000.

When the contract rallies to 59,000 and 59,500, raise the stop-loss to 58,250 and 59,000, respectively. Book profits at 60,000.

For option traders, we suggest buying August 57,800-call option (₹399.20). Go long at the current level. We suggest holding it till expiry. Book profits if the premium rises to ₹750.

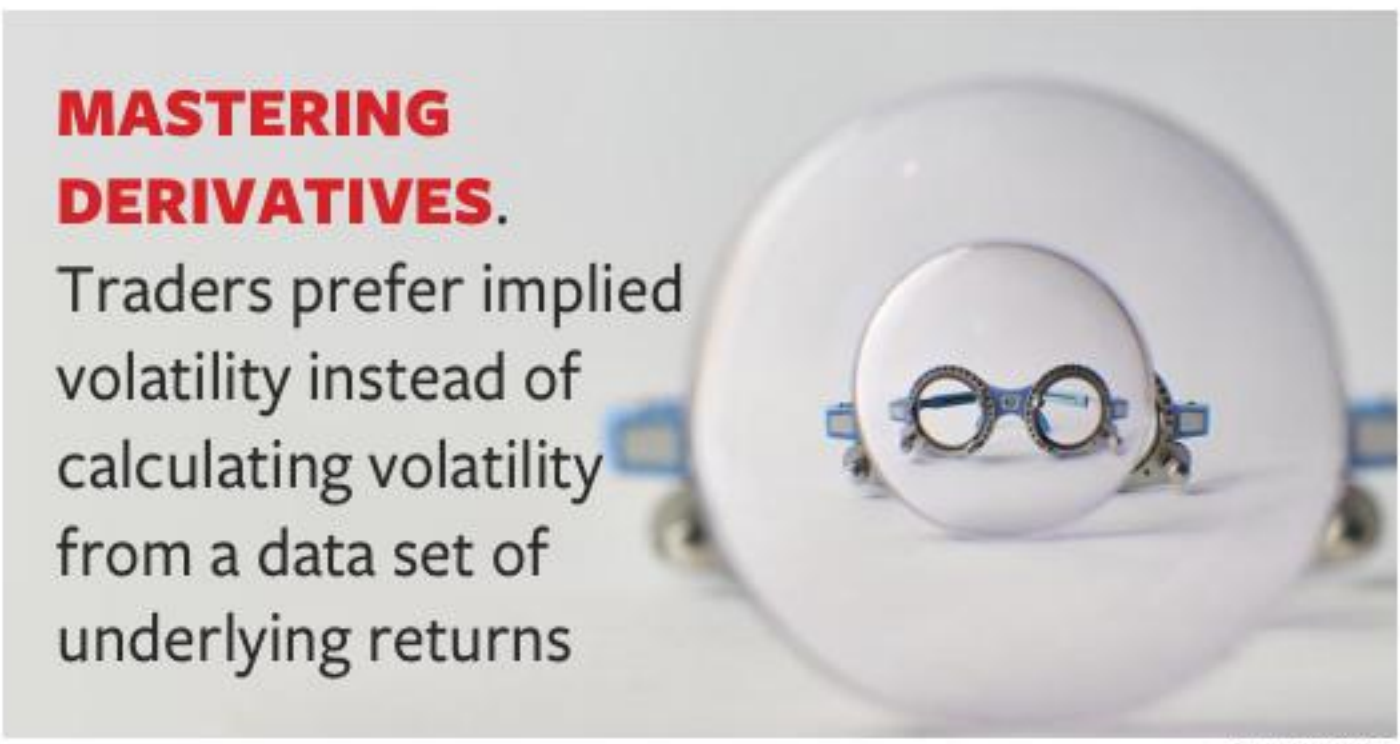
Model Vs Actual volatility

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

The Black-Scholes-Merton (BSM) model makes a volatility assumption that is a far cry from how the real-world volatility behaves. This week, we compare the characteristics of the model's volatility with that of actual volatility to understand how to use volatility in options trading.

CONSTANT VOLATILITY
The BSM model assumes volatility is a constant. Suffice it to know that this assumption helps in arriving at closed form solution- calculating option value from an equation. Note that the volatility is that of the underlying returns, not that of the option. That is, if you are valuing options on the Nifty Index, the volatility that you must input into the BSM model should be that of the Nifty Spot Index returns.

Suppose you want to go long on a call that has 10 days to expiry. You must input five factors into the BSM model to value an option-underlying price, the strike price, time to expiry, risk-free rate and volatility. The volatility you input must be determined from the underlying price returns. So, you need to build a



● CONSTANT VS CLUSTERS

The volatility you input must be determined from the underlying price returns.

data set to first determine the one-day volatility. Should you take the last one-year data, six months or three months data to calculate the one-day volatility?

SIMPLE CALCULATION
The constant volatility assumption tells you that it should not matter. You should theoretically arrive at the similar number, though statisticians would tell you that larger the data set the

better. Then, calculating the volatility for the remaining days to expiry is simple. You simply scale the one-day volatility. That is, you multiply the one-day volatility by the square root of numbers of the days to expiry to arrive at the volatility to input into the model. The scaling property of volatility arises from the constant volatility assumption. Note that variance is proportional to time. That is, the two-year variance is double that of the one-year variance. Standard deviation, captured by volatility, is the square root of variance.

Therefore, volatility is proportional to the square root of time. Real-world volatility is, however, not a constant. It clusters. That is, if today's volatility suddenly

jumps, compared to yesterday's, tomorrow's volatility is likely to stay higher, in line with today's. This behaviour continues until volatility suddenly decreases. This characteristic of volatility is captured by more sophisticated models. Suffice it to know that these models are not helpful for short-term trading.

OPTIONAL READING
Traders prefer implied volatility instead of calculating volatility from a data set of underlying returns. Implied volatility is derived from the traded option price. As discussed previously in this column, implied volatility indicates the annualised returns volatility of the underlying expected by option traders, which must be converted into relevant period volatility. Note that implied volatility need not be equal to the actual (realised) volatility. This is because implied volatility will change whenever option prices change. It is best to apply implied volatility as a relative (not absolute) factor to determine whether an option is rich or cheap.

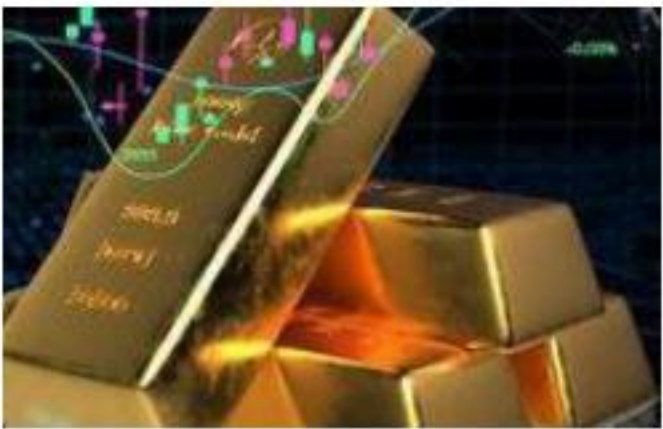
The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

Prices could soften

BULLION CUES. Initiate fresh shorts

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Precious metals extended the upside last week but at a smaller scale. Gold (\$4,376.80/ounce) and silver (\$64.70/ounce) were up 0.8 and 1.8 per cent, respectively. Similarly, in the domestic market, gold futures (₹1,54,506/10 gm) rose 1.8 per cent and silver futures (₹2,35,924/kg) gained 1.9 per cent. Below is an analysis.



MCX-GOLD (₹1,54,506)
Gold futures (Oct) rose during the first half of last week but failed to decisively break out of the barrier at ₹1,55,000.

The price band of ₹1,55,000-1,55,720 will be a strong roadblock for the bulls. We expect a decline on the back of this.

A fall from here can drag gold futures to ₹1,49,000 or even to ₹1,47,000. But in case the contract breaks out of ₹1,55,720, it can rally to ₹1,60,000.

But as it stands, the likelihood of a minor price decline is high.

Trade strategy: Sell gold futures (Oct) now at ₹1,54,506 and

place a stop-loss at ₹1,56,000. Book profits at ₹1,49,000. Risk-averse participants can avoid this counter-trend position.

MCX-SILVER (₹2,35,924)
Silver futures (Sep), too, rallied in the first half of last week and marked a high of ₹2,41,999 before moderating to ₹2,35,924. Resistance is between ₹2,40,000 and ₹2,42,000.

We are likely to witness a price drop, possibly to ₹2,27,000 or even to ₹2,25,000. That said, if the contract breaks out of ₹2,42,000, it can rally to ₹2,58,500.

Trade strategy: Go short if the price rises to ₹2,37,500. Target and stop-loss can be ₹2,27,000 and ₹2,42,000, respectively.

Set to consolidate

CRUDE CHECK. Key levels are ₹7,400 and ₹8,000

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Oil prices rallied last week. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$88.50/barrel) and crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹7,810/barrel) gained 5.9 per cent and 6.1 per cent, respectively.



BRENT FUTURES (\$88.50)
Brent crude futures surpassed a hurdle at \$86 early last week. However, it could not extend the upswing as it faced resistance at \$91. This barrier appears well positioned and is likely to block the bulls in the short-term.

At the same time, Brent crude futures has support at \$86 and \$83. Hence, there is a good chance for the contract to consolidate between \$83 and \$91 in the near-term and the direction of the breach of this band will determine the next trend.

A breakout of \$91 can lift the contract to \$98 and \$100. Whereas a breach of \$83 can drag the contract to \$78 and \$75.

MCX CRUDE OIL (₹7,810)
Crude oil futures (Sep) broke the resistance at ₹7,500 early last week and marked a high of ₹7,975 on Tuesday. However, the resistance at ₹8,000 did not allow the bulls to extend the uptick.

The likelihood of a breakout of ₹8,000 is low this week. Also, we might not see a decline since crude oil futures has support band between ₹7,500 and ₹7,400.

Given the prevailing price action, we expect crude oil futures to oscillate between ₹7,400 and ₹8,000 in the near-term.

A breakout of ₹8,000 can lead to a rally to ₹8,600 whereas if the support at ₹7,400 is invalidated, the price can fall to ₹7,000.

Trade strategy: Stay out since the contract can stay sideways.

F & O QUERY



AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

I've a long position on Tata Steel futures bought for ₹216. What is the outlook for the stock? Should I exit or hold?

Pradeep Kabra



Tata Steel (₹183.50): The stock has been on a decline for the last two weeks. It fell off the resistance at ₹193. But on Friday, after making a low of ₹180, it recovered well.

Note that there is a support between ₹180 and ₹182, on the back of which, the stock can rebound. So long as this support band holds, bulls will have a chance to regain ground. That said, a breakout of ₹193 will make the set up more favourable for the bulls.

With respect to futures, the August contract, too, now trading around ₹183, has a support band between ₹180 and ₹182. But it ought to surpass the hurdle at ₹195 in order to establish a sustainable rally. A breakout of ₹195 can trigger a rally to ₹210. Given the above factors, you can hold the trade but place a stop-loss at ₹178. Because, a breach of the support at ₹180 can lead to a deeper fall, potentially increasing the loss. That said, once the contract rises to ₹193, we suggest exiting, though at a loss. You can go long again once the futures decisively breaks out of ₹195.

Shall I buy Godrej CP September futures at the current market price?

Palani Shanmugam



Godrej CP (₹934.30): The stock has dropped 11 per cent last week. Consequently, it breached the support at ₹980, potentially opening the door for further decline. However, from the current level, there is a chance for a temporary rise. The scrip can appreciate to retest at ₹980. Therefore, Godrej CP September futures (currently at ₹937.90) can see an upswing to ₹990. So, you can consider going long. But initiate trade at ₹925 so that you can achieve a better risk-reward ratio. Place stop-loss at ₹905. When the contract moves up to ₹970, tighten the stop-loss to ₹945. Exit at ₹990. But note that this is a counter-trend trade and carries higher risk.

✉ Send your queries to derivatives@thehindu.co.in.

Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Aug 14	Weekly change %	As on Aug 14	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	25537	-2	211638	11
Future Index Short	202235	15	55956	-6
Net Futures	-176698	18	155682	19
Index Call options Long	537355	-8	3205535	5
Index Call options Short	814000	2	3072956	-1
Net Call options	-276645	30	132579	-486
Index Put options Long	975053	16	2649873	8
Index Put options Short	477877	12	3257565	8
Net Put Options	497176	20	-607692	7

FII have increased net short on index futures and index calls. They've also added net long on index puts. These factors point to bearish expectations.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Aug 14)				
PAGEIND	36,750.00	-7.9	8.2	151.0
GODREJCP	934.30	-11.0	407.1	111.8
PIIND	2,490.10	-10.3	91.2	107.8
SOLARINDS	19,969.00	7.1	26.5	107.3
BHARATFORG	2,065.00	-8.8	277.0	105.2
FALL (as on Aug 14)				
BRITANNIA	5,558.00	0.9	40.7	-15.5
PIDILITIND	1,693.00	2.0	112.5	-13.0
MARICO	865.20	0.4	326.7	-10.8
POLICYBZR	1,741.00	8.5	130.6	-9.2
GAIL	174.90	0.7	1962.3	-7.6

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Aug 17)

BANDHANBNK	LICI	MANAPPURAM	SAIL
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Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI	Indication
(Weekly change %)				
COMMODITIES (as on Aug 14)				
ALUMINIUM	31-Aug	348.6 (-0.6)	3,666 (-31)	Long unwinding
COPPER	31-Aug	1,378.3 (0.9)	9,556 (-8)	Short covering
CRUDEOIL	21-Sep	7,810.0 (6.1)	8,171 (30)	Long build-up
CRUDEOILM	21-Sep	7,808.0 (6.1)	18,996 (96)	Long build-up
GOLD	5-Oct	154,506.0 (1.8)	9,798 (-6)	Short covering
GOLDGUINEA	31-Aug	123,126.0 (1.8)	11,006 (-23)	Short covering
GOLDM	4-Sep	153,188.0 (1.8)	29,363 (-7)	Short covering
GOLDPETAL	31-Aug	15,394.0 (1.8)	161,392 (-14)	Short covering
GOLDTEN	31-Aug	153,298.0 (1.8)	21,031 (-10)	Short covering
LEAD	31-Aug	198.1 (0.4)	659 (-6)	Short covering
NATURALGAS	26-Aug	263.7 (3.2)	41,289 (-32)	Short covering
SILVER	4-Sep	235,924.0 (1.9)	10,752 (-4)	Short covering
SILVERM	31-Aug	237,197.0 (1.9)	26,374 (-6)	Short covering
SILVERMIC	31-Aug	237,186.0 (1.9)	75,135 (-8)	Short covering
ZINC	31-Aug	399.6 (2.7)	2,995 (9)	Long build-up
CURRENCIES (as on Aug 14)				
USDINR	27-Aug	95.45 (0.2)	27,65,111 (67)	Long build-up
EURINR	27-Aug	110.39 (0.3)	5,250 (12)	Long build-up
GBPINR	27-Aug	129.23 (0.4)	27,156 (2)	Long build-up
JPYINR	27-Aug	59.90 (-0.6)	358 (-6)	Long unwinding

F&O Strategy

Buy ITC put option

KS Badri Narayanan

The outlook remains negative ITC (₹278.20). Supports are at ₹261 and ₹218. A close below the latter will trigger a fresh sell-off. The short-term outlook will turn positive only on a close above ₹308.

Only a close above ₹400 will reconfirm long-term bullish outlook. But in the short-term, we expect the stock to move in a narrow band with negative bias.

F&O pointers: ITC August futures closed at



₹278.25 and against the spot price of ₹278.20. After the introduction of closing price auction, it is difficult to gauge the final movement of futures price with respect to the spot price.

Open interest also fluctuated along with a fall in stock price. Option trading indicates a range of ₹260-290.

Strategy: Buy August 277.50-strike put that closed with a premium of ₹2.70 on Friday. As the market lot is 1,725 shares, this strategy would cost traders ₹4,657.50. This would be the maximum loss. But profit potentials are high, if the stock falls sharply.

We advise traders to exit the position if loss mounts to ₹1,500 or hit a profit of ₹2,000. We suggest exiting the position before Friday.

Follow-up: We had advised a bull call spread on Adani Energy Solutions. The position may be in negative now, as the stock fell contrary to our expectations. Traders can hold the position for one more week.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading

Short Take

Exercising derivative contracts

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Derivatives contracts are physically settled in India. This means Meaning, if you are long in futures contract of a stock on expiry, you must take delivery of the underlying stock and vice versa.

For example, you have bought futures contract of stock A at ₹100 which expires at ₹120 (settlement price). Assuming that the lost size is 1,000 shares, you



will be debited ₹1.2 lakh and 1,000 shares of stock A will be credited in your demat account. While you may have initiated the futures contract with say 15 per cent margin i.e., ₹15,000 (buy price ₹100 multiplied by lot size 1000), you should make sure to maintain a margin of ₹1.2 lakh if you plan to take delivery.

Opposite is true for futures short. That is, seller of the futures should deliver the stocks to the futures buyer. Shortage or unavailability of shares will attract penalty.

The same applies to in-the-money (ITM) options contract. At-the-money (ATM) and out-of-the-money (OTM) options will become worthless, and the physical settlement does not apply to them. For options, settlement price will be the strike price.

Buyer of the call option will take delivery of the stock whereas the seller of that option will have to deliver the stock. In case of put options, the buyer delivers the stock whereas the seller should buy the stock.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research.bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and the Nifty Bank index came down slightly last week. The benchmark indices were down in the range of 0.4-0.85 per cent for the week. However, this has not altered the broader structure on the charts. The bias continues to remain positive. Supports are there to limit the downside for all three indices. We expect the benchmark indices to sustain above their support and rise back going forward.

PPIS BUY
The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) bought Indian equities for the fourth consecutive week. The equity segment saw a net inflow of about \$388.63 million. The FPI action in the coming weeks will need a close watch. If they continue to buy, then that could be a very good positive sign for the Indian markets from a long-term perspective.

NIFTY 50 (24,366)
Short-term view: Nifty has found support around 24,250 last week. Near-term resistance is around 24,500. If Nifty manages to sustain above 24,250 and breaks above 24,500, then that would ease the downside pressure. Such a break can take the index higher to 24,750-24,800 in the coming weeks. An eventual break above 24,800 will then clear the way for a rise to 25,200-25,400.

In case the index declines below 24,250 from here, a fall to 24,000-23,950 can be seen, but not beyond that. After this fall, Nifty can rise back towards 24,500 and higher again.

Medium-term view: The broader 22,000-26,500 range remains intact. The expected break above 24,800 can take the index up towards the upper end of this range. The bias continues to remain positive to see a bullish breakout above 26,500. Such a break can take the Nifty up to 28,000 and 30,000 in the long term.

To negate this bullish view, Nifty must break 22,000. But that looks less likely now. It will need some strong and new negative trigger.

NIFTY BANK (57,491.10)
Short-term view: The index remained lower but stable all through the week. Key support



SUPPORT TO WATCH

- Nifty 50: 24,250, 24,000
- Sensex: 77,500, 76,000
- Nifty Bank: 57,000, 56,700

open to see 80,000 and 82,000 in the short term.

In case the index breaks below 77,500, then a fall to 76,000-75,800 can happen first. Thereafter, a fresh rise can take the Sensex higher to 78,000-79,000 and higher eventually.

Medium-term view: Sensex is now oscillating in the middle of its broad 71,000-86,000 range. We expect the index to go up towards 86,000, the upper end of the range in the coming months. The above-mentioned rise to 81,000-82,000 can clear the way for the rise to 86,000.

The broader bias remains positive. We expect the Sensex to breach 86,000 eventually and rally to 90,000 and even 94,000 in the long term.

For this bullish view to go wrong, Sensex has to decline below 71,000. But that looks unlikely at the moment.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (23,420)
The index is oscillating inside the 23,300-23,500 resistance

MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

Bharti Airtel (₹1,992)
Bulls gain traction



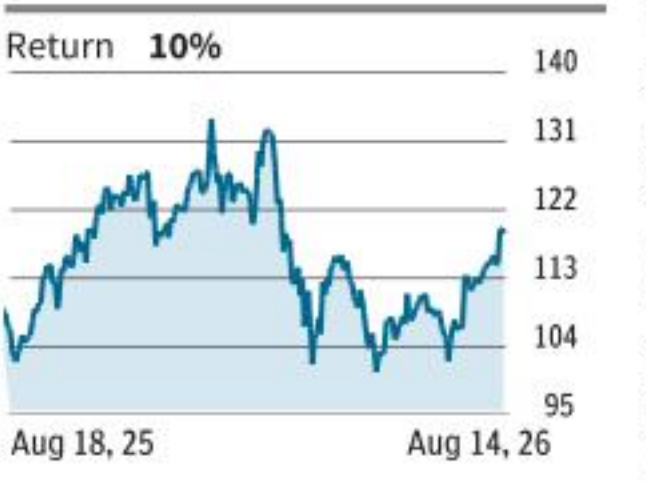
The stock of Bharti Airtel, between November 2025 and March 2026, experienced a downtrend. However, this was within the broader uptrend. Between March and June, the scrip formed a good base at ₹1,770 and started to rally on the back of this. The price action shows that the stock potential saw good accumulation. Overall, the bulls seem to be gaining traction and we expect the price to go up further, possibly to ₹2,160. So, one can buy the stock now at ₹1,992 and accumulate at ₹1,920. Place stop-loss at ₹1,860. When the price hits ₹2,080, revise the stop-loss to ₹2,000. On a rally to ₹2,120, revise the stop-loss at ₹2,090. Exit at ₹2,160.

Hindalco Industries (₹1,034.30)
Uptrend resumes



The stock of Hindalco Industries has been in a long-term uptrend. But in June, it witnessed a notable decline in price i.e., by 15 per cent. Nevertheless, the broader uptrend remained intact and in July, the stock stabilised and formed a good base at ₹940. Recently it bounced off this and the chart now shows that the uptrend has resumed. We expect the scrip to touch ₹1,200. Therefore, participants can buy now at ₹1,034 and accumulate more shares if the price dips to ₹1,000. Place stop-loss at ₹920. When the stock moves up to ₹1,100 and ₹1,150, revise the stop-loss up to ₹1,050 and ₹1,100 respectively. Exit the positions at ₹1,200.

Punjab National Bank (₹117.50)
Trend turns positive



The stock Punjab National Bank (PNB) posted its sixth straight weekly gain, showing strong upward momentum. Last week, it broke out of a key resistance at ₹115, which probably is the strong indication of a bullish trend reversal. So, while the price can see some correction from the current level, possibly to ₹113-115 price band, eventually it can resume the rally and appreciate to ₹135 in the near-term. So, traders can go long now at ₹117 and buy more shares if the price dips to ₹113. Place initial stop-loss at ₹105. When the stock rallies to ₹126 and ₹130, tighten the stop-loss to ₹120 and ₹125 respectively. Book profits at ₹135.

Bourses hold higher

Gurumurthy K
bl. research.bureau

The Dow Jones Industrial Average, S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite index managed to stay afloat. The Dow Jones dipped slightly and was down 0.56 per cent for the week. The S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite indices closed the week marginally higher by 0.36 per cent and 0.14 per cent respectively. The short-term picture remains positive. As mentioned last week, the US benchmark indices have room to rise further from here.

DOW JONES (53,737.38)
The near-term picture is slightly weak. The Dow Jones has resistance in the 54,200-54,400 region. A fall to 53,300 or even 53,000 looks possible in a week or two. However, a fall below 53,000 is unlikely. A bounce from the 53,300-53,000 support zone can take the Dow Jones higher to 54,000 again. An eventual break above 54,400 will then clear the way for the rise to 56,000 and even 58,000.

As mentioned last week, a decisive break below 53,000 is needed to negate the bullish view and drag the Dow Jones down to 50,000.

S&P 500 (7,785.76)
The index is inching up. Immediate support is at 7,700. That keeps intact our bullish view of seeing 8,000 on the upside. The price action thereafter is going to be crucial. A decisive break above 8,000 is needed to get an extended rise to 8,400-8,450. On the contrary, if the index reverses lower from 8,000, a fall to 7,600-7,500. The short-term picture will turn negative only if the index declines below 7,500.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (26,729.16)
The index is holding higher and there is no major change in the view. We see limited upside from here. A test of 27,000 is possible in the near-term. An extended rise to 28,000 is also a possibility that cannot be ruled out. We expect the NASDAQ Composite index to reverse lower from around 28,000 and fall back to

US MARKET OUTLOOK. The short-term picture remains positive, likely to rise further



RANGE BOUND
The US dollar index is stuck between 99.40 and 100.10 over the last two weeks.

26,000 or even lower. We reiterate that more caution is needed as the index goes up from here rather than being overly bullish.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK
The dollar index (99.65) was stuck between 99.40 and 100.10 for the second consecutive week. So, there is no change in the view and we are repeating what was said last week.

Support is in the 99.20-99 region. We expect the downside to be limited to 99. A decisive break above 100.10 can give a breather. It can then take the dollar index higher to 100.50-101.

The index will come under more selling pressure if it breaks

zone. The struggle to get a decisive break above 23,500 continues.

But at the same time, the Nifty Midcap 150 index has not come down significantly. That indicates lack of strong sellers in the market, which is a positive sign. It also keeps the chances alive of getting a decisive breakout above 23,500. Such a break can take that Nifty Midcap 150 index higher to 26,000-26,500 in the medium term. That will also strengthen the bullish case to see 28,000-28,500 on the upside over the long term.

Immediate support is in the 23,300-23,200 region. A break below 23,200 will turn the short-term outlook negative. In that case, a fall to 22,800 can be seen. However, such a fall will not disrupt the long-term bullish outlook. It will only delay the rally to 26,500 and 28,500, as mentioned above.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (18,278.80)
The Nifty Smallcap 250 index has come down below 18,300 after failing in its several attempts to rise above 18,400. A fall to 18,200 or even 18,000 looks possible in the near term. But a fall below 18,000 is less likely.

A bounce anywhere from the 18,200-18,000 region can take the index higher to 18,300-18,400 again.

The bias continues to remain bullish. As such, we expect the index to breach 18,400 eventually. Such a break can take the Nifty Smallcap 250 index higher to 22,500-23,000 in the medium term and 24,000-25,000 in the long term.

The short-term picture will turn negative if the index declines below 18,000. If that happens, then an extended fall to 17,500-17,400 can be seen. Such a fall will delay the rise to 23,000 and 25,000 mentioned above.

bl.portfolio video

Watch bl. Guru share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

English Tamil

TECH QUERY



GURUMURTHY K,
bl. research bureau

What is the outlook for Muthoot Finance?

Debesh, Bhopal



Muthoot Finance (₹2,845): The trend is down since the beginning of this year. A crucial trendline support at ₹2,750 is holding well. At the same time, important resistance is in the ₹3,100-₹3,200 region. A strong rise above ₹3,200 is needed to become bullish for a rise to ₹4,900-₹5,000 over the next one year. But if the stock breaks below ₹2,750, then there is a danger of seeing ₹2,300 on the downside. It is better to stay out of the stock now. Buy Muthoot Finance only after the share price goes above ₹3,200. Keep a stop-loss at ₹2,680 and play for the target of ₹4,960. Trail the stop-loss higher to ₹3,450 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹3,820. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹3,960, ₹4,340 and ₹4,730 when the price touches ₹4,280, 4,570 and ₹4,880, respectively.

I have bought Bajaj Housing Finance shares at ₹115. Can I hold it for long term?

Krishna



Bajaj Housing Finance (₹84.32): The trend is down since September 2024. There is no sign of a bullish trend reversal. The recent price movement indicates a range of ₹80-₹95. Strong resistance is around ₹98. So, even if the stock goes up from here, the upside may be capped. The stock has to get a sustained rise above ₹98 in order to indicate a bullish trend reversal. Only then the upside will open up for a fresh rise to ₹120-₹130. But that looks less likely. Even if that happens, it may take a lot of time. On the other hand, if the price declines below ₹80, there is a danger of seeing ₹70 or even much lower levels of ₹60-₹55. So, it is better to exit the stock and accept the loss.

What is the outlook of Utkarsh Small Finance Bank (SFB)?

Viswanathan



Utkarsh SFB (₹14): The stock is in a strong downtrend since early 2024. The share price has tumbled from around ₹58 to ₹14. The recent bounce from the low ₹10.15 made in March is just a correction. Resistances are at ₹15.50, ₹16.50 and ₹19. The stock has to breach and sustain above ₹19 to indicate a bullish trend reversal and give way for a rise to ₹30. On the other hand, supports are at ₹14 and ₹13. A fall below ₹13 will indicate the resumption of the broader downtrend and drag the share price down to ₹10 or even lower. For now, the stock does not look convincing to buy. You may have to wait for a rise above ₹19 to enter this stock.

I have bought Vikram Solar shares at ₹198. Should I continue to hold or sell?

Raghuram



Vikram Solar (₹160): The stock has come down sharply after rising to ₹408 in September 2025. Key resistance is in the ₹175-₹180 range. As long as the stock trades below ₹180, the downtrend will remain intact. Some support is around ₹150. A break below it can drag the price down to ₹130 and lower. Ideally, the stock has to breach ₹180 decisively to go up to ₹210-₹220. An eventual break above ₹220 will only confirm the bullish trend reversal. Only in that case, the upside will open up for a fresh rally to ₹320 and higher levels over the long term. It is better to stay out of this stock now. You may have to wait for a break above ₹220 if you intend to purchase this stock.

✉ Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week

1 Vodafone Idea

2 BLS International

3 Bharat Dynamics

4 Devyani International

5 APL Apollo Tubes

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.



Scan to know the winner selection process

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were down 0.6 and 0.8 per cent respectively last week. BSE Realty gained the most by 1.2 per cent, followed by BSE Consumer Durables and BSE Capital Goods 1.1 per cent each. BSE Metal and BSE FMCG declined by 1.4 and 1 per cent respectively last week.

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr-High	Yr-Low	
360 One [1]	1166.0	31.0	37.6	4.8	202606	34.5	16.1	36.8	19.5	0.0	14.3	2.0	1235.7	906.2	
3M India [1]	35283.2	542.7	65.0	18.5	202406	-0.3	21.6	3.0	23.3	-2.0	39.8	0.0	3830.0	0.287437	
A B B [2]	7645.0	72.7	105.1	17.4	202606	21.0	8.0	10.0	-130.4	0.6	9.8	0.1	7923.4	4640.5	
A B Lifestyle [2]	88.8	1.7	50.8	7.7	202606	11.1	20.6	9.1	31.5	-5.3	12.5	2.2	151.2	87.7	
A B Real Estate [2]	1401.3	-29.2	4.2	2.0	202606	3.0	-255.2	-55.2	-267.7	1.4	-4.1	1.4	1974.5	1080.1	
Aadhar Hsg. Fin. [2]	499.4	26.4	18.9	2.9	202606	17.1	19.0	17.7	21.5	-1.6	11.3	2.5	563.0	425.1	
AAI [2]	533.7	14.1	37.7	1.8	202606	25.1	25.6	27.0	12.8	0.1	11.3	0.0	542.0	25.1	
AAVAS Financials [2]	1395.9	61.9	22.6	2.9	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	1.9	9.9	3.2	1773.0	1050.3	
Abbott India [2]	27076.9	759.9	35.6	12.1	202606	4.3	17.1	61.3	11.2	-2.5	43.8	0.0	33850.0251640	ACC	
ACC [2]	1320.8	101.2	13.1	1.2	202606	-4.6	-56.3	11.5	-18.6	-3.1	11.2	0.0	1986.9	1250.6	
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	417.5	8.2	44.4	3.4	202606	48.9	64.8	47.5	45.4	1.7	7.4	2.8	398.5	195.7	
Action Const.Eng. [2]	1085.8	36.7	29.6	3.4	202606	20.5	22.3	5.2	3.3	-0.9	40.2	0.0	116.9	764.1	
Acuteas Chemical [2]	3233.5	47.2	68.5	16.0	202606	59.1	67.7	40.9	104.3	-1.9	20.1	0.1	3735.0	1287.0	
Adani Energy Sol. [2]	1617.0	23.9	67.7	6.8	202606	42.4	124.2	20.9	21.8	-0.7	5.6	1.5	1789.0	745.5	
Adani Interop. [2]	3040.0	15.0	157.3	4.3	202606	49.9	14.9	18.1	-28.8	1.7	5.6	1.5	2425.0	1735.3	
Adani Ports [2]	11345.0	119.2	95.0	20.2	202606	16.0	16.0	16.0	16.0	0.0	16.0	0.0	16.0	16.0	
Adani Power [2]	1695.0	57.7	29.4	4.1	202606	18.6	9.2	23.8	16.8	0.5	13.8	0.7	1891.8	1291.0	
Adani Total Gas [1]	653.5	5.7	113.7	14.8	202606	27.2	-14.2	19.8	-2.4	-0.5	14.8	0.5	859.7	453.5	
Aditya AMC [5]	1011.4	34.9	29.0	1.2	202606	3.5	11.7	6.6	1.4	-1.2	32.2	0.0	1224.4	708.0	
Aditya Birl. Finc. [2]	56.0	-6.1	1.2	202606	10.6	-20.15	11.4	-1.4	-11.6	0.0	0.9	9.0	95.0	53.6	
Aditya Birla Cap. [2]	401.4	14.7	27.3	2.9	202606	28.2	40.1	16.3	18.2	-3.2	8.8	4.9	430.6	268.2	
Aditya Infotech [1]	3519.4	40.3	87.7	22.2	202606	89.5	32.5	51.8	214.8	-5.0	28.1	0.3	4094.5	1084.7	
Aegis Logistics [1]	1264.9	35.6	35.5	4.2	202606	27.1	26.8	30.4	88.7	-7.9	16.1	0.8	1498.0	576.0	
Aegis Vopak Term [2]	269.3	2.4	110.2	8.8	202606	12.4	-7.0	26.1	42.9	-5.6	8.7	1.9	31.1	158.8	
Aether Industri. [2]	1628.7	18.1	90.1	8.8	202606	27.2	28.0	34.4	20.4	2.4	9.7	0.1	1656.6	723.2	
Afcons Infrastr. [2]	268.8	5.6	48.2	1.8	202606	-20.8	-77.7	-11.9	-41.5	-1.6	10.5	0.6	478.1	259.2	
AHL Egr. Infra [2]	116.6	33.9	29.2	4.2	202606	20.2	17.1	19.8	19.2	1.6	16.6	0.1	218.6	121.9	
AIA Engineering [2]	4491.2	136.0	33.0	5.2	202606	12.4	-1.3	5.5	14.7	-5.4	19.1	0.1	5175.0	3000.6	
Ajanta Pharma [2]	3675.2	90.8	40.5	10.1	202606	24.8	30.9	20.2	22.0	5.4	31.8	0.0	3698.0	2335.0	
Alkem Lab [2]	5399.0	19.0	283.7	4.7	202606	10.9	-20.5	13.4	0.2	-4.1	19.7	0.1	9933.0	5085.0	
Allied Blenders [2]	599.9	8.0	75.2	2.0	202606	6.3	-13.0	8.0	7.1	1.3	18.3	0.6	720.0	38.2	
Allo Industries [2]	11.6	-1.5	-0.2	-0.2	202606	6.5	-178.8	3.9	18.6	-2.8	0.0	10.8	10.1	10.8	61.1
Amara Raja Ener. [2]	1946.4	39.9	32.7	2.1	202606	23.9	15.9	12.7	-6.9	1.5	11.7	0.0	1953.7	171.5	
Amber Enterp. [2]	7222.4	56.1	128.7	5.8	202606	12.7	-3.4	14.6	-28.1	-2.6	13.5	0.8	7097.0	5404.0	
Amara Cement [2]	417.5	19.2	21.8	1.8	202606	-7.7	-29.1	7.1	5.7	-3.8	6.7	0.0	603.1	394.0	
Anand Rath. Wea. [2]	214.4	28.0	77.7	36.2	202606	17.5	73.8	22.7	45.2	3.6	59.8	0.1	2229.9	1335.0	
Anant Raj [2]	629.8	16.1	39.2	3.9	202606	6.6	18.9	17.0	25.7	2.2	12.0	0.1	744.1	403.0	
Angel One [2]	287.0	11.3	25.4	4.3	202606	25.4	102.1	9.1	3.8	-1.8	14.8	1.0	366.1	208.9	
Angel Biotech [2]	249.0	64.9	31.3	4.2	202606	22.6	11.7	14.9	17.6	1.9	16.1	0.6	899.4	576.0	
APAR Inds. [2]	16700.1	300.0	55.7	12.4	202606	29.2	77.8	24.0	36.7	0.6	32.6	0.2	11842.4	6800.4	
APL Apollo Tubes [2]	2094.0	44.3	47.3	11.0	202606	8.7	10.9	10.6	53.4	6.6	22.0	0.2	2300.9	1575.0	
Apollo Hospitals [2]	8925.0	146.3	61.0	13.5	202606	20.6	34.2	17.2	33.7	-0.6	18.7	0.3	9326.8	6680.0	
Apco Tyres [1]	432.4	27.2	15.9	2.2	202606	10.1	11.2	12.5	-0.3	-14.1	11.4	5.2	2194.7	1582.4	
Apus Value Hou. [2]	250.4	19.7	12.5	2.0	202606	15.4	19.0	21.1	23.3	0.0	18.4	0.6	36.4	19.3	
Asahi Inds. Glax [1]	938.9	17.5	53.6	6.1	202606	14.2	16.5	9.3	37.0	4.4	13.1	0.9	1073.0	775.1	
Ashtok Leyland [1]	171.9	6.4	27.0	7.1	202606	11.7	0.8	16.4	17.1	-2.9	13.8	0.3	215.4	119.3	
Ashtok Pumps [1]	621.0	50.9	35.3	2.2	202606	20.6	10.1	11.2	25.5	-0.4	10.2	0.2	2085.5	2116.0	
Aster DM Quality [2]	823.1	184.8	10.5	202606	21.6	-17.0	15.7	8.6	6.4	11.6	0.5	89.1	89.1	8.8	
Astral [1]	1555.0	22.1	70.3	10.3	202606	15.9	48.2	16.8	23.2	7.8	19.4	0.1	1768.0	1269.9	
Ather Energy [1]	1511.1	-9.8	15.4	202606	88.8	-128.5	67.2	52.4	0.0	0.0	158.9	0.4	158.9	0.4	
Ather Energy [1]	621.0	50.9	35.3	2.2	202606	20.6	10.1	11.2	25.5	-0.4	10.2	0.2	2085.5	2116.0	
ATI Small Finance [2]	1087.7	38.1	28.6	1.0	202606	21.1	37.0	21.3	30.8	0.0	0.0	1105.0	682.5		
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	1658.0	65.1	25.5	2.5	202606	16.9	28.1	9.4	11.5	-0.2	12.4	0.2	1682.0	1017.0	
Authum Invest [1]	565.1	24.7	22.9	3.3	202606	20.9	17.8	-34.6	-48.7	-5.2	29.7	0.1	683.5	40.0	
Avenue Super [2]	4054.1	46.5	86.5	10.8	202606	14.9	11.3	15.6	13.0	4.2	17.2	0.1	4916.3	3528.7	
AWA Egr. Busine. [1]	124.2	89.2	1.4	202606	16.7	16.7	16.7	16.7	16.7	0.0	16.7	0.0	16.7	16.7	
Axis Bank [2]	1217.2	88.2	13.6	1.7	202606	9.9	22.2	5.6	-0.3	-1.7	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1041.3	

BHEL [2]	422.1	7.0	60.4	5.6	202606	40.3	-17.3	27.0	739.4	3.7	5.6	0.3	446.8	205.2
BPCL [2]	318.3	35.7	8.9	1.4	202606	34.4	-154.5	12.3	-11.7	-0.1	24.9	0.6	391.9	266.6
Bajaj Auto [2]	11700.0	428.9	27.3	8.3	202606	65.0	45.9	36.3	55.2	0.5	28.4	0.4	11860.0	8199.8
Bajaj Finance [1]	1087.7	32.9	33.1	5.9	202606	19.6	27.4	18.8	17.6	0.5	10.9	3.8	1177.6	784.4
Bajaj Finserv [1]	2030.0	64.9	14.2	1.6	202606	19.4	12.3	12.4	9.3	1.7	11.8	5.2	2194.7	1598.2
Bajaj Housing [1]	1407.1	795.8	14.3	1.7	202606	21.5	32.2	30.2	27.3	0.9	12.6	0.1	10473.5	8597.5
Bajaj Holdings [1]	84.3	3.2	26.0	3.1	202606	17.1	22.6	16.3	19.4	-1.7	8.8	4.4	118.0	72.7
Balkrishna Inds [2]	2366.7	12.7	32.5	4.2	202606	25.2	56.4	9.8	-3.3	-4.1	10.9	0.4	2750.7	1971.5
Banquepar Chini [1]	124.9	17.5	56.5	2.9	202606	6.1	14.4	15.0	-11.3	-1.4	11.1	0.6	664.8	393.4
Bandhan Bank [2]	174.7	5.4	20.8	1.1	202606	2.8	34.9	-0.2	-34.1	-0.7	0.0	0.0	220.7	134.3
Bank of Baroda [2]	248.2	42.9	5.8	0.8	202606	6.8	68.2	4.9	34.1	-0.7	0.0	0.0	325.6	231.0
Bank of India [2]	143.9	25.9	5.6	0.8	202606	8.8	49.8	6.2	19.4	-0.7	0.0	0.0	178.5	109.8
Bank of Maharashtra [2]	145.6	10.7	13.9	3.0	202606	9.9	15.9	19.9	-20.7	4.9	12.0	0.9	128.1	60.6
Bata India [5]	755.5	13.5	55.9	6.1	202606	9.9	15.9	19.9	-20.7	4.9	12.0	0.9	128.1	60.6
Bayer Crop Sci.	4048.2	162.9	24.9	6.1	202606	-4.2	15.4	-2.8	23.6	-3.0	28.0	0.0	5698.5	4030.0
Belrise Industry [5]	255.5	5.3	48.4	3.6	202606	12.6	8.9	11.6	29.1	2.9	14.1	1.1	268.0	133.9
BELM Ltd. [5]	1872.6	21.4	87.1	5.3	202606	29.5	-142.1	12.8	-40.3	4.7	11.7	0.1	276.8	131.6
Bergers Paints [1]	545.7	10.5	50.8	1.2	202606	12.2	10.2	12.2	10.2	0.0	12.2	0.0	594.2	390.5
Bharat Dynamics [5]	1399.4	14.2	98.5	12.1	202606	14.8	-547.4	-18.3	-7.1	8.1	10.2	0.0	155.5	1090.0
Bharat Electron [1]	410.4	8.4	48.8	12.5	202606	24.9	8.7	19.8	11.7	2.1	34.8	0.0	273.3	106.1
Bharat Forge [2]	2075.0	21.2	98.1	10.4	202606	18.7	-57.6	17.5	-1.3	-8.8	11.7	0.7	2933.0	31.1
Bharat Petroleum [2]	165.2	1.7	34.5	1.0	202606	12.2	10.2	12.2	10.2	0.0	12.2	0.0	12.2	10.2
Bharti Airtel [5]	1992.0	51.0	39.0	7.1	202606	18.4	41.6	19.6	9.7	1.7	19.3	1.6	2174.7	1745.0
Bharti Hexacom [5]	1621.1	37.0	43.9	11.3	202606	10.9	23.2	7.9	28.6	5.6	20.5	1.0	1955.0	1431.0
Bikaji Foods [1]	613.3	10.4	58.8	9.6	202606	13.1	0.4	14.6	29.2	-1.6	20.1	0.2	820.9	59.6
Billionsbrn [2]	196.2	3.9	50.4	12.7	202606	66.0	94.3	37.7	30.8	3.0	37.2	0.1	227.0	12.0
Biocon [5]	414.9	4.5	92.7	2.0	202606	9.8	287.2	10.1	103.2	-3.5	3.8	0.6	447.0	337.2
Birlasoft Ltd [2]	31.8	21.3	14.6	2.1	202606	7.4	51.3	1.3	26.1	-2.2	20.0	0.0	37.8	270.2
BLS Internet [2]	218.1	17.1	16.2	4.7	202606	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	0.0	1.0	0.0	1.0	1.0
Blue Star [2]	5145.3	136.6	37.7	6.9	202606	15.0	81.2	9.2	30.8	1.0	17.1	0.7	7030.2	4630.5
Blue Star [2]	1506.7	25.5	58.5	9.0	202606	13.3	-21.0	5.9	0.0	-0.6	19.6	0.2	2050.0	1450.0
Bosch [2]	47061.0	801.2	58.7	9.4	202606	22.0	5.2	13.6	6.5	12.1	21.0	0.0	47370.0	28550.1
Bosch [2]	206.1	20.6	12.0	1.2	202606	2.2	-14.1	-0.2	-14.2	-0.3	14.2	0.0	206.1	12.0
Brigade Entersol. [2]	592.1	20.8	28.4	2.8	202606	-12.9	16.1	4.8	-9.6	1.6	1.0	0.7	10.1	46.3
Britannia Inds [1]	5550.0	108.1	51.3	26.2	202606	9.5	13.6	7.5	18.7	0.6	55.3	0.3	6337.0	5031.8

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

A recovery agent repeatedly calling through the day, threatening a borrower, contacting relatives or colleagues about unpaid dues, or even turning up during a wedding or a medical emergency --- such practices have long made loan recovery particularly distressing for borrowers in default.

From January 1, 2027, lenders and their recovery agents will face a much more detailed rule-book on what they can and cannot do. The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) this month has finalised sweeping new directions (https://tinyurl.com/rbrules2026) governing loan recovery, explicitly barring practices ranging from abusive or threatening calls and public humiliation to misuse of borrowers' personal information. The framework extends across RBI-regulated lenders, including commercial and small finance banks, regional rural and co-operative banks, non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) and housing finance companies. Recovery agents generally come into the picture after a borrower defaults and the lender escalates the account for recovery.

Besides setting rules for how and when borrowers can be contacted, the new RBI rules make lenders accountable for the conduct of recovery agents and introduce safeguards covering recorded calls, grievance redressal and even remote restrictions on financed mobile devices.

Here is what borrowers need to know.

RESPECTING YOUR PRIVACY

Under the new RBI mandate, collection agents cannot disrupt your life at arbitrary hours.

In-person visits and recovery calls are strictly restricted to a daytime window between 08:00 hours and 19:00 hours, unless you have explicitly authorised contact outside these limits.

To protect your dignity, recovery agents must maintain civil decorum at all times. They are strictly barred from discussing your outstanding dues with third parties, such as family, friends or colleagues, and cannot contact you during sensitive personal events like weddings, bereavements, or medical emergencies.

When visiting your premises, recovery agents must display their identity card and carry an authorisation letter and a copy



New RBI rules shield borrowers in default

BORROW SAFE. Sweeping new loan recovery guidelines will protect retail customers from January 2027

of the notice issued by the lender.

Furthermore, banks must document every single call made to you, notify you that the conversation is being recorded, and archive all recovery call recordings for at least six months.

All forms of "harsh methods", such as using abusive language, making anonymous or threatening calls, and posting your personal information on social media, are strictly prohibited.

SMART PROTECTIONS

For borrowers financing smart devices like mobile phones, tablets or laptops, the RBI has introduced cutting-edge protections against aggressive remote lockdowns. Lenders are now subject to strict, graded timelines. No restrictions can be placed on a financed device until the loan is at least 30 days past due. A full set of restrictions, including restricting outgoing calls, can only be initiated after 60 days past due.

RECOVERY CODE

- Calls and visits restricted to daytime
- Agents cannot discuss dues with third parties
- Lenders remain accountable for recovery agents

Importantly, your digital life-line cannot be completely cut off. Lenders are legally barred from disabling essential functionalities, meaning you will always retain access to incoming calls, SMS and emergency SOS features.

Furthermore, restrictions cannot deny you access to applications or services required for your active work or employment. Lenders and third-party software providers are also strictly prohibited from accessing your personal data, such as photos, contacts, location history, or call logs, under any circumstances.

If you default and subsequently clear your dues, the lender must unlock your device within one hour of payment realisation. If they wrongfully lock your device or delay its re-activation, the lender must compensate you at a rate of ₹250 per hour for the duration of the lock. This compensation, designed to protect consumers from bureaucratic delays, is capped only by the total amount of the loan disbursed to you.

YOUR RIGHT TO REDRESS

To guarantee professional conduct on the ground, the RBI has mandated that lenders only employ recovery agencies whose agents hold a professional certification from the Indian Institute of Banking and Finance (IIBF).

For agents currently operating without this credential, the central bank provides a strict one-year transition period ending on January 1, 2028, to obtain the certification for most regulated entities.

If you encounter non-compliant behaviour, you have clear avenues for redressal. Lenders must establish a dedicated grievance redressal mechanism, and the name, email, phone number and physical address of their Grievance Redressal Officer must be featured on all recovery communications and clearly written within your original loan agreement. Lenders can no longer deflect blame onto third-party agencies; they are held directly liable for their agents' actions.

Every lender must also have a board-approved policy incorporating provisions for compensating borrowers or guarantors for losses arising from recovery actions that violate these directions. This makes lenders accountable for misconduct even when recovery has been outsourced to a third-party agency.

INSURANCE QUERY.



SATISHWAR B

I am planning my life insurance, but I have a major worry. My nominee has very little financial experience. I am concerned that receiving a large, lump-sum payout all at once could leave them vulnerable to poor investment advice, family pressure or even outright fraud. How are life insurance products evolving today to provide structured payout options—like combining immediate cash with guaranteed monthly income—to better protect our beneficiaries?

Divya

You are absolutely right to be concerned about this, and I want to commend you for thinking a few steps ahead. True financial protection isn't just about the amount of wealth you leave behind; it is about how safely and effectively that wealth can be managed by the people you love when you are no longer there to guide them.

Sudden, large sums of money can be

incredibly overwhelming, especially for someone who has never managed a major portfolio.

In moments of grief, a lump-sum can make an inexperienced nominee a prime target for misaligned financial advice or predatory schemes.

Fortunately, the life insurance ecosystem has evolved dramatically to solve this exact problem. Today, products are designed not just to pay out, but to protect. Let's look at the primary ways you can structure your insurance to ensure your family receives a steady, secure financial runway.

TERM INSURANCE WITH FLEXIBLE PAYOUT OPTIONS

Term insurance is no longer a rigid, all-or-nothing proposition. Modern term plans have introduced highly customisable payout structures that allow you to dictate exactly how the death benefit is distributed.

When buying a policy, you can choose between three distinct tracks:

The lump-sum option: Best for families with immediate large liabilities, like a home loan.

The pure monthly income option: The total sum assured is converted into a regular, guaranteed monthly payout for a fixed period (for example, 10 or 15



years), effectively replacing your monthly salary.

The staggered hybrid approach: This is often the ideal solution for your specific concern. You can opt for a percentage of the sum assured (say, 25 per cent) to be paid out immediately as a lump-sum to handle sudden costs, medical bills or immediate debts. The remaining 75 per cent is then disbursed as a steady, regular monthly income, giving your nominee a predictable financial safety net without the stress of managing a massive corpus.

Crucially, many modern policies allow the policyholder to suggest this choice at the time of purchase. However, the nominee will also have a say on how they want to be paid. It's therefore important that you talk to your nominee about how they can manage the money.

INCOME PLANS WITH POLICY CONTINUATION BENEFITS

If you are looking for a solution that provides security while you are alive and seamlessly transfers that protection to your nominee later, a traditional Participating (Par) Income Plan is an excellent alternative.

These plans provide an assured, regular income to you during your lifetime.

However, to protect a financially-inexperienced nominee, you should look specifically for features like a Secure Policy Benefit or Policy Continuation Benefit.

Here is how this guardrail operates: If the life assured passes away during the policy term, the income and maturity benefits scheduled under the plan do not stop, nor do they collapse into a confusing lump-sum. Instead, the plan continues intact exactly as scheduled. All future premiums are completely waived, and the guaranteed regular income streams continue to flow directly to your nominee.

This ensures a seamless transition of financial support without requiring your beneficiary to make complex investment decisions.

The writer is MD and CEO, Bandhan Life

Safe Investing • bl • 9

Bank FD interest rates (%)

Bank	<1 year	1 to 2 years	2 to 3 years	3 to 5 years	w.e.f
FOREIGN BANKS					
DBS Bank	6	6.85	6.4	6.4	May 06
Deutsche Bank	5	7	6.25	6.25	Jul 25
HSBC	4.1	5.5	5.35	5.5	Jul 17
Standard Chartered	5.75	6.6	6.5	6.5	Aug 01
INDIAN: PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS					
Bank of Maharashtra	5.25	6.65	5.25	5	Aug 10
Bank of Baroda	6	6.6	6.5	6.4	Jun 12
Bank of India	5.5	6.6	6.7	6.25	May 18
Canara Bank	5.5	6.6	6.25	6.25	Mar 17
Central Bank of India	6.5	6.75	6.25	6	Aug 10
Indian Bank	6.2	6.65	6.6	6.05	Aug 04
Indian Overseas Bank	5.5	6.6	6.4	6.1	May 15
Punjab National Bank	5.6	6.6	6.35	6.35	Jun 01
Punjab & Sind Bank	4.85	6.85	6.1	5.95	Jun 16
State Bank of India	5.9	6.45	6.4	6.3	Dec 15
UCO Bank	5	6.45	6.1	6	Apr 01
Union Bank	5.6	6.55	6.1	6	Aug 04
INDIAN: PRIVATE SECTOR BANKS					
Axis Bank	5.75	6.5	6.5	6.5	Aug 14
Bandhan Bank	4.20	7.45	7.45	7.25	Jun 20
CSB Bank	6.5	7.1	6.5	5.75	Aug 05
City Union Bank	6.25	7.25	6.5	6.25	Jun 16
DCB Bank	6.5	7.5	7.5	7.5	Aug 04
Dhanlaxmi Bank	7	7.1	6.5	7.25	Jul 23
Federal Bank	6	6.6	6.4	6.7	Jul 16
HDFC Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.5	Mar 06
ICI Bank	5.5	6.3	6.45	6.5	Aug 14
IDBI Bank	5.8	6.45	6.5	6.35	Feb 23
IDFC First Bank	6.5	7.25	7.25	6.75	Jul 25
IndusInd Bank	6.25	7	7	6.65	Jul 24
J & K Bank	6	6.75	6.8	6.85	Aug 01
Karnataka Bank	5.75	7	6.15	6.15	Jun 08
Kotak Bank	6	6.8	6.8	6.4	Jun 10
Karur Vysya Bank	7	7.2	6.55	6.55	Jun 08
RBL Bank	6.05	7.2	7.2	7	Sep 24
South Indian Bank	5.9	6.6	6.8	6.2	Jun 19
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.5	7.25	7	6.7	Apr 10
TNSC Bank	6.85	7.6	7.1	6.85	NA
Yes Bank	6.5	7	7	6.75	Jun 02
SMALL FINANCE BANKS					
Equitas Small Finance Bank	6.35	7.1	7.75	8	Jun 16
ESAF Small Finance Bank	6	7.75	7.75	6	Jun 18
Jana Small Finance Bank	7	7.3	8	7.77	Aug 06
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	6.5	7.6	8.1	7.9	Mar 29
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	6	8.1	7.5	7.25	May 05
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	6	7.8	7.25	7.55	Jun 22

Data as on respective banks' website on 14 Aug 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com;

LOYAL TEXTILE MILLS LIMITED

Registered Office : 21/4 Mills Street, Kovilpatti 628 501, Phone : 04632-220001

CIN : L17111TN1946PLC001361

Website : www.loyalttextiles.com/E-mail : investors@loyalttextiles.com

UNAUDITED (STANDALONE & CONSOLIDATED) FINANCIAL RESULTS OF THE COMPANY FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30TH JUNE 2026

In compliance with Regulation 33 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements), Regulation, 2015 (the "Listing Regulations"), the Audit Committee and the Board of Directors of Loyal Textile Mills Limited in its meeting held on Friday, August 14, 2026 approved Unaudited (Standalone & Consolidated) Financial Results of the Company for the quarter ended June 30, 2026.

The Unaudited (Standalone & Consolidated) Financial Results along with Limited Review Report by M/s. Brahmayya & Co., Chartered Accountants, Statutory Auditors are available on the website of the company at www.loyalttextiles.com and also on the website of Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com respectively.

In compliance with Regulation 47 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulation, 2015 we hereby notify you that the same can also be accessed by scanning the following Quick Response (QR) Code:



For Loyal Textile Mills Limited
Valli M Ramaswami
Chairperson and Whole Time Director

Place : Chennai
Date : August 14, 2026

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BUSINESS OFFER

FINANCE

Wanted Financial Partner

We are looking for a financial partner who can fund us upto 3 crores for a Project which is not hitherto developed in India. This is a medical device to save many, many lives & saving enormous foreign exchange. The Project is expected to be accomplished within (max) 3 years including central Govt clearances. This is for validating the samples alone & necessary approvals from Government agencies & Nodal agencies. Interested persons may kindly contact with your views & conditions you may also speak to us on our mobile

98840 07875

between 10.30am & 6.30PM (Monday to Friday) for a call.

admin@horizonhealthcraft.com

BUSINESS OFFER

SHARES / INVESTMENTS

LEGAL NOTICE

IN THE Court Of The Principal District Judge, Chengalpatt I.A. No.05 of 2025 in O.S. No.79 of 2018 Sathya Colours Pvt. Ltd. & Anr. Petitioners/Plaintiffs VS Benign Enterprises & Others Respondents/Defendants Notice By Paper Publication R1 - Benign Enterprises, represented by its partners, No.20, Peter Street, Thiruneermalai Road, Nagelkeni, Chrompet, Chennai - 600044. R3 - R. Babu, S/o. V. Ramalingam, No. 21, Sadasivam Nagar Flat No.2, Kamarajapuram, Chennai - 600073. R4 - U. Venkatasubramanian, No.44, M.C. Road, Ambur - 635802 and No.20, Peter Street, Thiruneermalai Road, Nagelkeni, Chrompet, Chennai - 600044. You are all hereby notified that the Hon'ble Principal District Judge, Chengalpatt, by order dated 27.07.2026, has directed paper publication in I.A. No.05/2025 in the above suit, relating to recovery of Rs.94,00,336/-. You are hereby called upon to appear before the Court on 18.08.2026, @ 10:30 AM either in person or through a pleader. Failing such appearance, the matter will be heard & decided in your absence. P. Senthil Dhandapani, Advocate for Counsel for Petitioners/Plaintiffs

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ALERTS.

NPS same-day investment cut-off extended

PFMDA has extended the cut-off time for same-day investment of National Pension System (NPS) contributions received by the Trustee Bank to 1.30 pm on a Business Settlement Day, from 11 am earlier. Contributions received by 1.30 pm, and subsequently matched and booked successfully, will be invested the same day and allotted units at the applicable closing NAV. The revised cut-off applies across contribution channels, including government nodal offices, Points of Presence, eNPS, D-Remit, BBPS, UPI, STAR NPS and Tatkal NPS. PFMDA has asked subscribers and intermediaries to initiate fund transfers sufficiently early.

VENLON ENTERPRISES LIMITED					
POLYAL					
Regd. Office & Works : 26 (P) & Plot No.2, Belavadi Industrial Area, Hunsur Road, Mysuru - 570 018 Phone : (0821) 2402530. e-mail: gdvenlon@gmail.com CIN : L24231KA1983PLC015089					
STATEMENT OF UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30th JUNE 2026					
Particulars	Quarter Ended		FY ended		(Rs. in Lakhs)
	30-06-2026	31-03-2026	30-06-2025	31-03-2025	
	Unaudited	Unaudited	Unaudited	Audited	
Total Income	152.09	252.52	167.80	829.01	
Net Profit for the period (before Tax, exceptional and for extraordinary items)	(18.66)	(123.10)	(99.34)	(337.91)	
Net Profit for the period before tax (after exceptional and for extraordinary items)	(18.66)	(123.10)	(99.34)	(337.91)	
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Extraordinary items)	(18.66)	(123.10)	(99.34)	(337.91)	
Total Comprehensive Income for the period (Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax))	70.64	(223.15)	(36.17)	(367.49)	
Equity Share Capital	2612.12	2612.12	2612.12	2612.12	
Earnings Per Share (of 5/- each) in Rs.					
Basic:	(0.04)	(0.24)	(0.19)	(0.65)	
Diluted:	(0.04)	(0.24)	(0.19)	(0.65)	
The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchange under Regulation 33 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of Quarterly Financial Results are available on the website of BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com & Company's website www.venlonenterprises.co.in/ and can be accessed by using the QR Code provided below.					
Place: Mysore Date : 14.08.2026		By Order of the Board C D Datwani (DIN:00355181) Chairman & Managing Director			

SIKA INTERPLANT SYSTEMS LIMITED									
Regd. Off.: No.3, Gangadharchetty Road, BANGALORE - 560 042. Ph: 080 49299144									
CIN: L29190KA1985PLC007363 comp.sec@sikaglobal.com, www.sikaglobal.com									
UNAUDITED STANDALONE & CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30 th JUNE 2026									
Rs. In Lakhs, except EPS									
Particulars	Standalone				Consolidation				
	3 months ended			Year ended	3 months ended			Year ended	
	30.06.2026	31.03.2026	30.06.2025	31.03.2026	30.06.2026	31.03.2026	30.06.2025	31.03.2026	
	Unaudited	Audited	Unaudited	Audited	Unaudited	Audited	Unaudited	Audited	
Total Income from Operations (net)	4,536.00	4180.13	6,973.75	21630.75	4,537.29	4132.89	6,974.28	21635.86	
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before tax & Extraordinary items)	1,040.71	1052.10	1,386.76	4881.11	1,033.36	1047.22	1,384.39	4872.92	
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Extraordinary items)	1,040.71	1052.10	1,386.76	4881.11	1,033.36	1047.22	1,384.39	4872.92	
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Extraordinary items)	847.52	788.07	1,037.74	3653.40	840.21	782.60	1,035.27	3644.24	
Equity Share Capital	424.02	424.02	424.02	424.02	424.02	424.02	424.02	424.02	
Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Balance Sheet of previous year				15189.42				15554.67	
Earnings Per Share (of 10/- each)									
Basic & Diluted:	4.00	3.72	4.90	17.36	3.96	3.69	4.88	17.19	
Notes:									
(a). The above unaudited results for the quarter ended 30 th June, 2026 were reviewed by the Audit Committee and then approved by the Board of Directors at their meeting held on 14 th August 2026. (b). The Company has only one business segment "Engineering Products & services", therefore no additional disclosure on segment reporting required. (c). The financials has been prepared in accordance with Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules 2015, IND-AS to the extent applicable. (d). The statutory auditors have carried out limited review of the standalone & consolidated unaudited financials for the quarter ended 30 th June 2026. e. Previous periods figures have been regrouped as necessary (f). The financial performance for the quarter was materially impacted by supply-chain disruptions arising from prevailing geopolitical tensions, resulting in delays in execution and delivery of certain customer orders and the consequent deferral of revenue. The Company continues to take appropriate measures to mitigate these disruptions and facilitate execution and delivery in subsequent periods.									
Place : Bangalore Date : 14/08/2026				 Kunal Sikka (DIN:05240807) Managing Director & CEO					



bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS										
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	109.8	80960	1.1	0.7	0.2	12.5	12.3	13.2	0.41
*****	Invesco India Largecap	73.3	1931	1.8	0.7	7.8	14.4	11.5	12.4	0.33
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	90.6	54225	1.2	0.6	0.6	12.3	14.1	13.8	0.46
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	226.0	2632	1.7	0.7	4.2	12.5	11.2	12.4	0.33
*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	62.7	17136	1.4	0.5	0.4	11.1	9.4	13.0	0.28
*****	JM Large Cap	156.6	402	2.1	0.8	4.2	11.6	11.1	10.8	0.31
*****	SBI Large Cap	94.4	55431	1.2	0.7	3.7	10.3	10.2	11.5	0.32
****	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	527.6	29944	1.4	0.8	1.3	11.1	10.2	11.4	0.30
****	Bandhan Large Cap	79.5	2145	1.7	0.8	4.2	13.3	11.0	12.2	0.32
****	DSP Large Cap	463.0	7228	1.5	0.8	-0.7	11.6	9.9	10.6	0.30
****	Edelweiss Large Cap	84.4	1443	1.8	0.6	2.1	10.4	10.0	12.0	0.29
****	Franklin Ind Large Cap	1037.5	7488	1.5	0.9	2.0	11.0	8.9	10.4	0.24
****	HDFC Large Cap	1145.6	40198	1.3	0.8	2.0	10.7	12.1	12.3	0.38
****	HSBC Large Cap	485.1	1839	1.8	1.0	3.4	11.2	9.9	11.6	0.26
****	Kotak Large Cap	575.2	11028	1.5	0.6	1.9	11.3	9.9	11.9	0.29
****	Mahi Manu Large Cap	22.6	711	2.0	0.7	-0.4	9.5	8.6	-	0.24
****	Tata Large Cap	516.8	2784	1.7	0.8	5.9	11.4	10.3	11.4	0.31
****	Groww Largecap	43.5	136	2.1	0.9	2.5	11.5	9.4	10.6	0.26
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	113.9	38729	1.3	0.5	2.2	9.6	8.8	12.2	0.25
***	Union Largecap	23.5	438	2.1	1.3	1.1	9.0	8.5	-	0.23
***	UTI Large Cap	268.8	12303	1.5	0.8	-0.4	8.7	7.8	11.0	0.21
***	Axis Large Cap	61.2	31632	1.3	0.7	1.9	10.3	6.9	11.8	0.16
***	LIC MF Large Cap	54.6	1387	1.8	0.9	-1.2	8.6	7.2	9.9	0.18
***	PGIM India Large Cap	336.3	547	2.1	0.8	-0.2	7.6	6.8	9.5	0.17
-	Taurus Large Cap	167.2	56	2.1	1.9	7.7	14.2	10.9	10.0	0.30
EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	141.7	19777	1.4	0.4	7.4	18.6	16.5	15.2	0.49
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	1060.8	32706	1.3	0.7	8.6	17.1	17.0	15.2	0.58
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	126.5	3496	1.7	0.6	13.4	16.1	15.8	15.5	0.43
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	35.4	16802	1.4	0.6	9.4	16.3	12.9	-	0.33
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	353.1	30099	1.4	0.8	5.7	14.7	15.5	14.5	0.46
*****	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	111.0	11746	1.5	0.6	10.0	23.5	17.3	16.1	0.46
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	188.0	6407	1.6	0.8	7.0	16.4	14.6	13.8	0.46
*****	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	94.0	514	2.1	0.9	9.9	14.7	12.1	12.5	0.33
****	DSP Large & Mid Cap	625.9	18231	1.4	0.5	3.8	14.9	12.3	13.9	0.36
****	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	91.8	4789	1.6	0.5	7.7	15.1	13.0	14.3	0.37
****	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	30.1	5479	1.6	0.7	13.9	18.9	14.9	-	0.35
****	Kotak Large & Midcap	357.1	32050	1.3	0.5	6.5	15.0	13.9	14.7	0.41
****	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	159.1	45275	1.3	0.5	8.2	13.5	11.4	16.1	0.32
****	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1526.4	7705	1.5	0.9	6.2	16.8	14.4	12.9	0.43
****	SBI Large & Midcap	659.4	42325	1.3	0.6	7.3	14.2	14.0	14.5	0.44
****	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	261.4	26062	1.4	0.5	2.6	13.8	11.3	14.6	0.32
****	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	195.6	3576	1.7	1.1	3.3	13.1	11.0	11.5	0.31
****	LIC MF Large & Midcap	39.8	3133	1.7	0.6	4.9	15.0	11.9	13.9	0.34
****	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	95.3	7222	1.5	0.7	13.5	16.1	13.1	14.7	0.36
****	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	971.5	5827	1.6	0.9	9.9	12.9	9.1	11.1	0.20
****	Navi Large & Midcap	37.2	313	2.1	0.5	7.5	10.2	10.8	12.3	0.29
****	Tata Large & Mid Cap	504.0	7901	1.5	0.6	-2.2	7.8	9.8	12.0	0.29
EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS										
*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	2081.3	110736	1.1	0.6	5.6	17.0	17.9	15.7	0.60
*****	JM Flexicap	101.7	5185	1.6	0.6	6.5	15.7	16.4	15.7	0.46
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	83.6	148429	1.0	0.5	-1.2	13.8	12.5	16.5	0.44
*****	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1978.2	28112	1.4	0.7	12.1	16.3	12.4	13.6	0.36
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	39.6	3613	1.6	0.5	6.0	15.0	12.7	14.3	0.35
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1625.9	19509	1.4	0.8	0.7	12.8	12.9	12.9	0.38
*****	HSBC Flexi Cap	235.8	5718	1.6	0.9	9.1	16.9	13.6	12.7	0.35
****	Axis Flexi Cap	28.6	13478	1.5	0.7	7.7	14.6	9.7	-	0.24
****	Bandhan Flexi Cap	213.2	7575	1.5	0.9	3.1	12.7	10.7	10.8	0.30
****	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	348.2	13615	1.5	0.5	2.7	12.5	10.2	13.7	0.29
****	DSP Flexi Cap	105.0	12422	1.5	0.6	5.3	12.7	10.2	13.4	0.27
****	Kotak Flexicap	86.4	56119	1.2	0.5	3.2	13.1	11.3	12.9	0.32
****	Navi Flexi Cap	25.3	290	2.1	0.5	14.3	11.5	11.1	-	0.31
****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	37.5	5898	1.6	0.5	3.7	10.8	8.0	13.3	0.20
****	Union Flexi Cap	53.4	2404	1.7	0.8	6.3	12.1	10.9	12.8	0.30
****	LIC MF Flexi Cap	109.3	1075	1.9	0.9	13.9	13.4	11.0	10.5	0.29
****	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	63.6	13940	1.4	0.7	4.8	20.0	12.5	12.6	0.32
****	SBI Flexicap	109.5	22897	1.4	0.7	2.4	9.2	8.5	11.4	0.23
****	Tata Flexi Cap	23.9	3705	1.6	0.6	0.3	10.8	9.4	-	0.27
***	Shriram Flexi Cap	20.1	134	2.1	0.8	1.1	8.3	7.6	-	0.17
***	Taurus Flexi Cap	236.8	369	2.1	2.0	7.4	12.7	10.7	9.7	0.30
***	UTI Flexi Cap	333.4	24036	1.4	0.8	4.2	9.7	6.3	11.7	0.12
-	Quant Flexi Cap	110.2	7262	1.5	0.6	17.7	16.6	15.2	18.7	0.38
EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS										
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	301.1	3432	1.7	0.8	7.5	15.5	13.9	14.0	0.37
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	870.7	18769	1.4	0.8	11.3	17.5	15.4	14.4	0.48
-	Invesco India Multicap	132.8	4398	1.6	0.6	3.1	14.0	11.8	13.3	0.29
-	ITI Multi Cap	26.4	1468	1.8	0.5	14.1	17.6	13.5	-	0.33
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	39.6	7184	1.5	0.5	14.3	17.8	15.7	-	0.42
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	306.6	55587	1.2	0.6	3.2	15.0	18.4	15.3	0.56
-	Quant Multi Cap	662.5	7717	1.5	0.6	10.0	10.8	11.6	17.2	0.28
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	397.8	2981	1.7	0.8	5.6	14.4	12.8	14.4	0.35
EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	110.2	18693	1.4	0.4	10.8	22.2	18.4	18.2	0.50
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4583.3	50751	1.2	0.6	11.8	20.8	19.3	18.1	0.54
*****	Quant Mid Cap	222.4	8107	1.5	0.7	6.1	13.0	15.6	17.1	0.41
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	213.2	105143	1.1	0.6	11.5	19.6	20.0	17.3	0.61
*****	Invesco India Midcap	199.0	14721	1.5	0.5	10.9	24.5	19.6	18.4	0.50
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	37.3	5186	1.6	0.5	16.3	20.7	18.1	-	0.48
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	104.1	40036	1.3	0.7	2.4	20.5	22.2	16.8	0.55
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	113.3	2584	1.7	0.5	14.7	18.0	15.3	15.2	0.43
****	HSBC Midcap	469.7	15578	1.4	0.5	21.7	24.9	18.7	17.1	0.46
****	ICICI Pru Midcap	346.3	7954	1.5	0.9	18.2	23.4	17.9	16.6	0.50
****	Kotak Midcap	147.3	69283	1.2	0.3	9.3	18.9	17.0	17.1	0.48
****	PGIM India Midcap	67.0	11071	1.5	0.5	3.3	12.4	11.2	15.3	0.30
****	SBI Midcap	244.1	24354	1.4	0.7	8.7	13.0	14.3	13.6	0.42
****	Sundaram Mid Cap	1528.9	14504	1.5	0.8	11.8	20.9	18.1	14.6	0.51
****	Tata Mid Cap	469.9	6056	1.6	0.5	11.1	16.3	15.3	15.9	0.44
***	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	862.5	6723	1.6	0.9	11.5	17.4	15.0	13.5	0.40
***	Axis Midcap	122.6	34404	1.3	0.5	9.4	17.8	13.8	16.7	0.38
***	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2877.1	12871	1.0	0.8	6.9	17.8	14.9	14.1	0.39
**	UTI Mid Cap	321.0	12379	1.5	0.7	8.4	13.6	13.1	13.8	0.33
***	DSP Midcap	157.4	20523	1.4	0.6	9.2	16.0	12.4	14.0	0.32
***	LIC MF Midcap	31.4	376	2.1	1.2	10.5	17.8	13.7	-	0.33
***	Taurus Mid Cap	128.2	135	2.1	1.7	8.5	11.6	12.8	14.4	0.31
EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS										
*****	Bank of India Small Cap	57.5	2819	1.7	0.4	27.5	22.2	19.4	-	0.44
*****	Quant Small Cap	285.7	34069	1.3	0.6	14.8	17.8	18.5	19.7	0.42
*****	Edelweiss Small Cap	48.3	6818	1.6	0.4	12.3	16.7	17.1	-	0.44
*****	Invesco India Smallcap	48.1	14475	1.5	0.4	16.0	23.2	19.4	-	0.47

Rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
★★★★	Nippon Ind Small Cap	185.2	78957	1.1	0.5	12.0	16.9	19.3	20.8	0.48
★★★★	Union Small Cap	59.9	2402	1.7	0.8	24.8	18.5	17.4	16.5	0.40
★★★★	AXIS Small Cap	117.0	30089	1.4	0.6	11.7	16.5	16.3	18.5	0.45
★★★★	Canara Robeco Small Cap	41.4	14231	1.5	0.4	8.8	13.8	15.6	-	0.39
★★★★	DSP Small Cap	229.2	20221	1.4	0.7	19.9	18.3	17.9	16.6	0.44
★★★★	HSBC Small Cap	89.7	17784	1.4	0.6	13.9	15.9	17.7	18.0	0.40
★★★★	Kotak Small Cap	276.4	18933	1.4	0.5	7.8	13.0	13.2	16.3	0.32
★★★★	LIC MF Small Cap	34.7	758	2.0	0.8	19.2	19.0	18.1	-	0.41
★★★★	Sundaram Small Cap	297.6	3922	1.6	0.7	18.4	18.1	16.9	14.7	0.41
★★	Franklin Ind Small Cap	180.8	14467	1.5	0.8	9.1	14.8	16.9	14.8	0.41
★★	HDFC Small Cap	141.5	41679	1.3	0.6	2.0	12.5	15.2	17.0	0.38
★★	ICICI Pru Smallcap	91.6	9533	1.5	0.7	6.2	12.6	14.3	15.5	0.40
★★	Tata Small Cap	39.0	12696	1.5	0.4	-0.6	11.8	13.7	-	0.34
★	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	100.4	5865	1.6	0.8	20.3	16.5	13.9	13.0	0.31
★	SBI Small Cap	185.7	39955	1.3	0.6	10.0	12.8	14.7	18.3	0.39
EQUITY - FOCUSED FUNDS										
★★★★★	HDFC Focused	236.0	27925	1.4	0.6	3.5	16.3	18.2	14.1	0.63
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Focused Equity	96.1	17764	1.4	0.6	5.9	17.5	15.5	14.5	0.50
★★★★★	360 ONE Focused	49.2	6698	1.5	0.7	7.5	12.9	11.6	14.7	0.32
★★★★★	Quant Focused	94.2	850	2.0	0.7	12.1	13.9	12.4	14.1	0.33
★★★★★	SBI Focused	401.6	50041	1.2	0.6	15.6	16.2	12.7	14.8	0.40
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Focused	149.8	8017	1.5	0.8	8.6	14.0	11.5	12.3	0.36
★★★★	Bandhan Focused	88.4	2086	1.8	0.7	1.6	14.5	11.5	12.3	0.33
★★★★	DSP Focused	56.1	2642	1.7	0.8	6.8	14.2	10.7	11.5	0.30
★★★★	Franklin Ind Focused Equity	103.1	11510	1.5	0.8	-4.2	9.7	10.9	12.7	0.30
★★★★	Nippon Ind Focused	124.5	8530	1.5	1.0	4.4	11.2	11.3	12.9	0.32
★★★★	Sundaram Focused	168.7	1068	1.9	1.1	6.5	11.2	10.2	12.9	0.27
★★	JM Focused	20.9	289	2.1	0.7	9.2	13.6	14.0	11.7	0.36
★★	Mirae Asset Focused	25.4	6635	1.6	0.6	0.0	7.8	6.6	-	0.14
★★	Motilal Oswal Focused	52.9	1693	1.8	0.9	26.0	13.6	10.1	12.2	0.23
★	Axis Focused	57.2	11315	1.5	0.8	4.2	11.4	5.8	11.4	0.10
★	Baroda BNP Paribas Focused	21.6	650	2.1	0.5	0.4	9.3	9.4	-	0.21
-	LIC MF Focused	22.6	173	2.1	1.1	8.7	10.5	9.7	-	0.26
EQUITY - VALUE FUNDS										
★★★★★	HSBC Value	115.4	14988	1.5	0.6	6.2	17.7	16.3	15.5	0.47
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Value	465.9	61102	1.2	0.8	0.1	13.6	15.5	14.2	0.59
★★★★★	Bandhan Value	149.0	10051	1.5	0.6	3.0	11.1	13.1	14.8	0.38
★★★★	Nippon Ind Value	226.4	9098	1.5	0.9	3.1	15.6	14.5	14.9	0.42
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Value	138.0	6739	1.6	0.9	14.7	16.4	14.5	12.0	0.36
★★★★	JM Value	97.1	807	2.0	1.0	2.8	13.5	14.9	14.7	0.40
★★★★	LIC MF Value	29.2	261	2.1	0.9	25.8	18.0	14.2	-	0.35
★★★★	Templeton India Value	696.2	2007	1.8	0.8	-0.4	10.6	13.5	13.3	0.42
★★★★	Union Value	29.2	395	2.1	1.1	5.8	13.3	13.1	-	0.40
★★	HDFC Value	800.4	7934	1.5	0.9	9.5	17.2	14.4	14.0	0.43
★★	Tata Value	354.1	8492	1.5	0.7	4.2	13.6	13.8	13.4	0.43
★	Quantum Value	120.6	1140	1.8	0.9	-2.7	10.9	10.0	10.5	0.32
★	UTI Value	168.2	9659	1.5	0.9	1.4	13.8	11.8	13.0	0.36
-	Groww Value	27.8	74	2.1	0.8	3.3	14.0	11.2	10.0	0.34
-	Sundaram Value	213.9	1303	1.9	1.4	-2.7	7.8	8.9	10.1	0.26
EQUITY - TAX SAVING (ELSS) FUNDS										
★★★★★	Motilal Oswal ELSS Tax Saver	56.9	4784	1.6	0.6	13.2	22.2	16.7	16.4	0.39
★★★★★	Quant ELSS Tax Saver	413.4	13382	1.5	0.7	16.2	16.1	15.0	18.9	0.37
★★★★★	SBI ELSS Tax Saver	463.6	32300	1.3	0.8	1.5	15.7	15.7	13.9	0.50
★★★★	Bandhan ELSS Tax Saver	156.7	7005	1.6	0.6	5.0	10.5	11.8	14.4	0.34
★★★★	Bank of India ELSS Tax Saver	167.1	1395	1.8	0.8	7.8	13.7	11.6	15.4	0.29
★★★★	DSP ELSS Tax Saver	140.2	16738	1.4	0.7	2.8	14.5	12.3	14.2	0.37
★★★★	HDFC ELSS Tax saver	1394.0	16095	1.4	1.0	-0.3	14.7	15.3	13.2	0.52
★★★★	JM ELSS Tax Saver	52.9	242	2.1	0.9	11.6	16.9	14.8	15.4	0.40
★★★★	Mirae Asset ELSS Tax Saver	51.0	26373	1.4	0.6	6.1	13.4	11.5	16.1	0.33
★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas ELSS Tax Saver	102.7	917	2.0	0.9	9.0	16.4	12.2	12.7	0.33
★★★★	Canara Robeco ELSS Tax Saver	181.4	8758	1.5	0.5	4.8	12.5	10.5	14.3	0.31
★★★★	Edelweiss Long Term Equity	117.9	455	2.1	0.7	8.9	14.0	11.8	12.1	0.33
★★★★	Franklin Ind ELSS Tax Saver	1451.1	6239	1.6	0.9	-0.4	12.5	12.4	12.2	0.36
★★★★	HSBC ELSS Tax saver	143.3	4115	1.6	1.0	9.0	17.4	13.4	13.4	0.35
★★★★	ICICI Pru Long Term Equity	947.6	14292	1.5	1.0	2.8	12.6	11.0	12.3	0.34
★★★★	Kotak ELSS Tax Saver	118.6	6342	1.6	0.6	4.4	12.2	11.8	13.6	0.33
★★★★	Nippon Ind ELSS Tax Saver	132.6	14910	1.5	0.9	3.9	13.9	12.8	10.6	0.39
★★★★	Tata ELSS	47.9	4664	1.6	0.7	10.5	13.5	12.8	13.5	0.37
★★★★	Union ELSS Tax Saver	66.9	861	2.0	1.2	4.3	11.8	11.3	12.5	0.25
★★	Invesco India ELSS Tax Saver	127.0	2699	1.7	0.7	3.5	13.0	10.0	12.7	0.32
★★	Mah Manu ELSS Tax Saver	28.1	904	2.0	0.7	0.5	9.2	9.7	-	0.26
★★	PGIM India ELSS Tax Saver	35.1	718	2.0	0.8	1.5	8.9	9.6	12.1	0.27
★★	Quantum ELSS Tax Saver	119.8	213	1.8	0.8	-2.7	10.8	10.0	10.5	0.33
★★	Sundaram ELSS Tax Saver	504.0	1296	1.9	1.4	-1.2	10.0	10.6	12.6	0.31
★★	UTI ELSS Tax Saver	204.9	3524	1.7	0.8	1.9	9.9	8.2	11.4	0.21
★	Aditya Birla SL ELSS Tax Saver	62.7	14660	1.5	0.8	4.3	12.4	8.8	10.3	0.23
★	Axis ELSS Tax Saver	98.8	2592	1.3	0.7	3.6	12.3	7.3	11.6	0.15
★	LIC MF ELSS Tax Saver	149.8	10390	1.9	0.9	-0.7	10.4	9.6	11.5	0.27
-	Groww ELSS Tax Saver	19.3	51	2.1	0.8	-3.4	9.9	8.5	-	0.22
-	Shriram ELSS Tax Saver	21.1	48	2.1	0.7	1.5	8.1	7.5	-	0.17
-	Taurus ELSS Tax Saver	183.5	73	2.1	1.6	-1.0	11.4	11.0	12.2	0.34
EQUITY - CONTRA FUNDS										
-	Invesco India Contra	137.2	20100	1.4	0.5	2.6	15.7	13.3	15.0	0.38
-	Kotak Contra	155.5	5450	1.6	0.6	4.8	16.3	14.4	15.3	0.43
-	SBI Contra	380.9	48266	1.3	0.6	1.5	12.5	15.9	15.0	0.54
EQUITY - THEMATIC - CONSUMPTION FUNDS										
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Consumption	199.1	2514	1.7	0.6	0.8	11.2	13.7	12.8	0.39
★★★★★	Tata India Consumer	48.6	2815	1.7	0.6	9.4	15.6	14.7	16.0	0.39
★★★★	Mirae Asset Great Consumer	95.8	4732	1.6	0.4	3.0	12.4	13.5	15.0	0.35
★★★★	SBI Consumption Opport	292.9	2959	1.7	0.8	-3.3	7.2	13.1	13.1	0.38
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Consumption	217.1	6154	1.6	0.7	-1.2	10.1	10.7	13.1	0.25
★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas India Cons	31.3	1464	1.8	0.6	1.0	10.9	11.3	-	0.29
★★★★	Canara Robeco Consumption	110.1	1998	1.8	0.7	0.7	12.1	12.2	14.6	0.32
★★★★	ICICI Pru Bharat Consumption	25.7	3269	1.7	1.0	2.8	11.9	14.6	-	0.45
★★	Mah Manu Consumption	22.6	502	2.1	0.7	1.4	10.9	11.2	-	0.29
★	UTI India Consumer	59.9	735	2.0	1.3	5.5	12.4	10.5	11.1	0.25
★	Sundaram Consumption	98.1	1495	1.8	1.1	1.3	11.5	12.5	11.6	0.31
EQUITY - THEMATIC - INFRASTRUCTURE FUNDS										
★★★★★	BOI AXA Manufacturing & Infra	67.4	893	2.0	0.6	23.1	23.3	20.7	18.3	0.55
★★★★★	Quant Infrastructure	41.5	3146	1.7	0.7	13.6	18.6	18.4	20.4	0.44
★★★★★	DSP India T.I.G.E.R.	364.7	6325	1.6	0.7	18.1	22.1	21.8	17.4	0.59
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Infrastructure	204.4	8523	1.5	1.0	6.3	19.6	22.6	17.3	0.74
★★★★	Invesco India Infrastructure	69.5	1540	1.8	0.8	10.7	21.8	19.5	17.8	0.49
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Infrastructure	109.3	1231	1.9	1.1	16.4	19.0	18.4	14.8	0.46
★★★★	Bandhan Infrastructure	49.9	1500	1.8	0.8	1.8	16.9	16.5	15.7	0.39
★★★★	Canara Robeco Infrastructure	170.4	989	1.9	0.8	7.2	21.0	20.0	15.7	0.57
★★★★	Franklin Build India	144.5	1499	1.7	0.8	3.4	18.8	19.3	16.4	0.55
★★★★	Kotak Infra & Economic Reform	71.0	2390	1.7	0.6	11.0	16.6	18.9	15.3	0.48
★★★★	LIC MF Infrastructure	55.7	1145	1.9	0.7	15.7	25.7	22.4	16.9	0.57
★★★★	Tata Infrastructure	182.3	2072	1.7	1.0	9.1	14.4	17.0	14.7	0.44
★★	HSBC Infrastructure	51.1	2362	1.7	0.8	11.9	17.3	19.1	15.8	0.46
★★	SBI Infrastructure	51.4	4931	1.6	0.9	7.4	15.8	17.3	15.0	0.51
★★	Sundaram Infra Advantage	103.1	979	1.9	1.5	0.9	18.3	17.1	14.7	0.46
★	HDFC Infrastructure	47.3	2375	1.7	1.0	0.3	16.2	19.6	14.5	0.55
★	UTI Infrastructure	146.9	2158	1.7	1.5	5.9	15.5	14.5	12.8	0.40
-	Taurus Infrastructure	64.1	9	2.1	1.6	-3.2	11.6	11.4	13.1	0.28
EQUITY - THEMATIC - MNC FUNDS										
-	Aditya Birla SL MNC	1348.1	3293	1.7	1.1	0.2	9.3	6.7	8.2	0.15
-	ICICI Pru MNC	31.4	1806	1.8	0.9	4.1	12.4	12.1	-	0.42
-	SBI MNC	415.5	6481	1.6	1.0	18.3	8.4	9.2	11.5	0.25
-	UTI MNC	412.2	2765	1.7	1.0	7.7	10.9	9.5	10.0	0.27
EQUITY - SECTOR - BANKING FUNDS										
★★★★★	Invesco India Fin Serv	146.9	1845	1.8	0.7	7.6	18.3	13.7	14.4	0.36
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Banking & Fin Serv	644.5	7774	1.5	0.8	4.3	12.8	13.2	12.9	0.35
★★★★★	Sundaram Fin Serv Opport	109.1	1679	1.8	0.7	9.1	13.4	13.4	13.4	0.37
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Bank & Fin Serv	63.4	3648	1.6	0.9	5.9	11.0	11.1	11.6	0.27
★★★★	SBI Banking & Fin Serv	43.6	10872	1.5	0.6	2.8	15.9	12.3	14.2	0.32
★★★★	Tata Banking and Fin Serv	44.3	3181	1.7	0.5	5.2	11.6	11.6	13.3	0.30

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month *Ann	3 Month *Ann	6 Month *Ann	1 Year CAGR	

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid	2147.4	573	0.3	0.2	6.3	6.3	6.4	6.1	-
- Aditya Birla SL Liquid	450.7	68800	0.3	0.2	6.5	6.8	6.7	6.4	-
- Axis Liquid	3115.9	56438	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.8	6.8	6.4	-
- Bandhan Liquid	3375.2	19031	0.2	0.1	6.3	6.6	6.6	6.3	-
- Bank of India Liquid	3222.1	1728	0.1	0.1	6.5	6.8	6.7	6.4	1.50
- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3213.2	12206	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.6	6.6	6.3	1.20
- Canara Robeco Liquid	3365.6	6792	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.6	6.7	6.3	-
- DSP Liquidity	3993.9	22962	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.8	6.7	6.4	-
- Edelweiss Liquid	3578.1	13796	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.8	6.8	6.4	-
- Groww Liquid	2704.3	323	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.7	6.7	6.3	-
- HDFC Liquid	5485.8	65870	0.3	0.2	6.4	6.7	6.7	6.3	-
- HSBC Liquid	2787.5	20047	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.7	6.7	6.3	-
- ICICI Pru Liquid	413.8	61558	0.3	0.2	6.4	6.7	6.6	6.3	-
- Invesco India Liquid	3844.3	20723	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.8	6.7	6.4	-
- ITI Liquid	1452.6	48	0.2	0.1	6.1	6.1	6.3	6.0	-
- JM Liquid	76.2	2849	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.7	6.6	6.2	-
- Kotak Liquid	5650.2	51309	0.3	0.2	6.4	6.7	6.7	6.3	-
- LIC MF Liquid	5054.4	16809	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.7	6.7	6.3	-
- Mahi Manu Liquid	1819.7	1280	0.2	0.1	6.7	6.7	6.7	6.4	-
- Mirae Asset Liquid	2930.0	13190	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.6	6.6	6.3	-
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.7	966	0.4	0.2	5.9	6.2	6.1	5.9	-
- Navi Liquid	30.2	76	0.2	0.2	5.6	5.9	5.8	5.7	-
- Nippon Ind Liquid	6824.2	41346	0.3	0.2	6.5	6.8	6.7	6.3	-
- Parag Parikh Liquid	1550.1	7009	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.6	6.6	6.3	-
- PGIM India Liquid	364.2	787	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.8	6.8	6.4	1.90
- Quant Liquid	44.0	1603	0.5	0.3	6.0	6.0	5.8	5.8	-
- Quantum Liquid	37.3	537	0.2	0.1	6.0	6.0	5.9	5.8	-
- SBI Liquid	4369.8	84055	0.3	0.2	6.5	6.8	6.7	6.3	-
- Sundaram Liquid	2465.4	10633	0.3	0.1	7.3	6.9	6.7	6.3	-
- Tata Liquid	4403.8	27603	0.3	0.2	6.5	6.7	6.7	6.3	-
- TRUSTMF Liquid	1357.2	1130	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.6	6.5	6.2	-
- Union Liquid	2690.9	7564	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.7	6.7	6.4	-
- UTI Liquid	458.9	26728	0.2	0.1	6.4	6.7	6.7	6.4	-
- WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1502.3	672	0.2	0.1	6.5	6.6	6.6	6.2	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1471.5	9747	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Axis Overnight	1447.7	10178	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.2	5.2	5.3	-
- Bandhan Overnight	1452.2	1123	0.1	0.0	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Bank of India Overnight	1392.3	63	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.8	5.5	5.5	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1435.1	557	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.2	5.1	5.3	-
- Canara Robeco Overnight	1415.5	444	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.2	5.1	5.3	-
- DSP Overnight	1461.6	3601	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Edelweiss Overnight	1414.5	120	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Franklin Ind Overnight	1427.2	926	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.2	5.2	5.3	-
- Groww Overnight	1404.4	27	0.2	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.0	5.1	-
- HDFC Overnight	4025.8	11145	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.0	5.2	-
- HSBC Overnight	1424.1	4766	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ICICI Pru Overnight	1469.9	13144	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Invesco India Overnight	1381.9	591	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ITI Overnight	1378.7	16	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.8	4.8	5.0	-
- JM Overnight	1383.9	99	0.1	0.1	4.8	4.9	4.9	5.1	-
- Kotak Overnight	1454.6	8818	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- LIC MF Overnight	1411.0	662	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Mahi Manu Overnight	1410.6	281	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Mirae Asset Overnight	1399.2	1562	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Nippon Ind Overnight	146.5	8376	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- PGIM India Overnight	1408.4	167	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- SBI Overnight	4402.5	29876	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Sundaram Overnight	1447.4	1896	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.0	5.2	-
- Tata Overnight	1437.2	5278	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Union Overnight	1434.6	613	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- UTI Overnight	3715.1	5089	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	28.3	26939	0.9	0.3	5.1	6.2	5.7	5.8	-
- Axis Arbitrage	19.9	10339	0.9	0.3	5.4	6.1	5.8	5.8	-
- Bandhan Arbitrage	34.5	8011	0.9	0.3	5.1	5.9	5.5	5.6	-
- Bank of India Arbitrage	14.6	136	0.9	0.4	4.6	5.0	5.2	5.4	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	17.1	1125	1.0	0.3	4.8	5.6	5.3	5.5	-
- DSP Arbitrage	15.9	6646	0.9	0.3	5.2	6.0	5.6	5.7	-
- Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.7	15139	0.9	0.3	5.0	6.2	5.8	5.8	-
- HDFC Arbitrage	32.7	25001	0.8	0.3	5.3	6.3	5.9	5.9	-
- HSBC Arbitrage	20.3	2998	0.8	0.2	5.6	6.1	6.0	5.9	-
- ICICI Pru Arbitrage	36.6	34180	0.8	0.3	5.5	6.3	5.9	5.9	-
- Invesco India Arbitrage	34.1	29629	0.9	0.3	5.2	6.3	5.9	6.0	-
- ITI Arbitrage	13.8	71	0.8	0.2	3.3	4.6	5.0	5.6	-
- JM Arbitrage	34.6	391	0.9	0.4	3.8	5.4	5.3	5.5	-
- Kotak Arbitrage	40.0	74399	0.8	0.3	5.2	6.1	5.9	5.9	-
- LIC MF Arbitrage	14.7	265	0.7	0.2	4.5	6.0	5.8	5.8	-
- Mahi Manu Arbitrage	13.1	132	1.0	0.3	3.4	5.1	5.0	5.3	-
- Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.9	3872	0.8	0.1	4.4	5.9	5.5	5.7	-
- Nippon Ind Arbitrage	28.3	16916	0.9	0.3	5.1	6.1	5.8	5.8	0.30
- PGIM India Arbitrage	19.5	83	0.9	0.3	4.2	5.8	5.8	5.6	-
- SBI Arbitrage Opport	36.1	46803	0.8	0.3	4.9	5.9	5.8	5.9	-
- Sundaram Arbitrage	15.4	553	0.8	0.2	4.2	6.0	5.9	5.9	-
- Tata Arbitrage	15.3	24725	0.9	0.3	5.1	5.9	5.7	5.8	-
- Union Arbitrage	15.0	226	0.9	0.3	5.7	6.2	5.9	5.8	-
- UTI Arbitrage	37.4	11152	0.7	0.2	5.4	6.1	5.8	5.9	-

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS

***** Aditya Birla SL Savings	588.7	18189	0.5	0.3	6.4	7.2	7.3	6.5	9.68
***** Baroda BNP Pari Ultra Short Dur	1654.7	649	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.0	7.1	6.4	-
***** Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1404.9	1916	0.4	0.2	6.5	7.1	7.2	6.4	12.70
***** Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	16.3	4205	0.4	0.2	6.3	6.9	7.0	6.2	-
***** HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1452.7	3322	0.3	0.1	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.3	-
***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.7	15455	0.7	0.3	6.3	6.9	7.0	6.3	7.92
***** Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4313.2	11659	0.9	0.3	6.2	6.7	6.8	6.1	22.83
*** Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.7	5908	1.1	0.3	5.9	6.5	6.6	5.8	8.50
*** DSP Ultra Short	3636.4	4456	0.9	0.3	6.0	6.6	6.7	5.8	6.81
*** HDFC Ultra Short Term	16.2	16678	0.6	0.3	6.1	6.7	6.9	6.2	8.57
*** Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2886.3	1073	0.7	0.2	6.1	6.8	6.9	6.0	4.47
*** Kotak Savings	45.8	15708	0.7	0.3	6.0	6.7	6.8	6.1	6.00
*** Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1473.0	205	0.6	0.3	6.2	6.8	6.9	6.1	1.22
*** SBI Ultra Short Duration	6398.8	11165	0.5	0.3	6.2	6.8	7.0	6.2	11.83
*** Tata Ultra Short Term	15.2	6378	1.0	0.3	6.1	6.6	6.6	5.8	8.62
*** UTI Ultra Short Duration	4527.3	3444	0.9	0.3	6.0	6.6	6.7	6.5	11.75
*** WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1451.6	552	0.7	0.3	5.8	6.4	6.5	5.8	-
** BOI Ultra Short Duration	3375.1	168	0.9	0.4	5.9	6.4	6.4	5.8	6.56
** Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	4053.5	580	0.8	0.3	5.9	6.4	6.5	5.7	-
** LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1408.6	509	1.2	0.2	5.8	6.4	6.4	5.7	1.00
** PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	36.3	176	0.8	0.3	5.6	6.3	6.4	5.8	2.84
* ITI Ultra Short Term	1316.1	163	0.8	0.2	5.7	6.2	6.3	5.5	-
* Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.5	515	1.0	0.2	5.3	5.5	5.7	5.0	-
* Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2847.1	2284	1.3	0.2	5.3	5.9	6.0	5.3	1.36

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS

***** ICICI Pru Savings	584.6	21735	0.5	0.4	6.4	7.3	7.4	6.6	6.69
***** UTI Low Duration	3806.2	2386	0.4	0.3	6.3	7.2	7.2	7.4	8.01
***** Axis Treasury Advantage	3316.1	4637	0.6	0.3	6.1	7.1	7.2	6.3	7.07
***** Bandhan Low Duration	41.3	6583	0.6	0.3	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.1	-
***** HDFC Low Duration	61.7	18420	0.9	0.4	5.8	6.8	6.9	6.1	11.33

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

***** HSBC Low Duration	30.7	994	0.8	0.3	6.1	7.6	7.5	6.4	6.70
***** Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	699.1	9914	1.0	0.4	5.5	6.5	6.6	5.9	11.21
*** Canara Robeco Savings	45.1	1086	0.4	0.2	6.1	6.9	7.0	6.1	-
*** DSP Low Duration	21.2	4478	0.5	0.3	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.1	-
***** Invesco India Low Duration	4045.3	1640	0.5	0.3	5.9	6.9	7.0	6.1	9.52
*** JM Low Duration	39.6	217	0.8	0.3	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.0	3.44
*** Mirae Asset Low Duration	2413.0	2044	0.7	0.2	5.9	6.7	6.9	5.9	7.34
*** Nippon Ind Low Duration	4002.8	7804	0.8	0.3	6.0	6.9	6.9	6.1	7.56
*** Tata Treasury Advantage	4209.9	2240	0.5	0.2	6.1	6.9	7.0	6.1	6.52
*** Kotak Low Duration	3566.3	12083	1.0	0.4	5.7	6.7	6.8	5.9	8.78
** LIC MF Low Duration	42.3	1748	0.4	0.2	6.0	6.7	6.7	5.9	5.95
** Mahi Manu Low Duration	1744.9	541	0.9	0.3	5.8	6.6	6.7	5.8	13.64
** SBI Low Duration	3721.6	13102	0.8	0.4	5.6	6.6	6.7	5.9	4.10
* Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	42.7	391	0.9	0.2	5.7	6.5	6.6	5.8	-
* Sundaram Low Duration	3679.3	433	1.0	0.3	5.4	6.5	6.6	5.8	2.24

DEBT - MONEY MARKET FUNDS

***** Nippon Ind Money Market	4458.3	23227	0.3	0.2	6.3	
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PM Modi targets getting 50 Indian companies into Fortune 500

AIMING HIGH. Sets sights on an Indian bank among global ones; no force can stop resolve of 140 cr Indians

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday changed the scale of India's ambition by setting a target of bringing 50 companies among Fortune 500 companies and an Indian bank among top global banks. As on date, the nine Indian companies in the list of Fortune 500 are Reliance Industries, LIC, Indian Oil, State Bank of India, ONGC, BPCL, Tata Motors, HDFC Bank and ICICI Bank.

In his address to the nation from the ramparts of the Red Fort, Modi called for placing an Indian pharma company among the world's top five; an Indian law or rating agency achieving global leadership, an Indian consulting or accounting firm among the world's top firms, an Indian



Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the 80th Independence Day, in New Delhi **ANI**

technology company among the world's top companies and brands that the world recognises with enthusiasm when it hears the name India. Making a direct appeal to the industry, he said: "Quality is paramount as it builds trust in Indian products."

LOOKING BACK
On the overall economy, the PM said that India has trans-

formed from 'Fragile Five' to the world's fastest-growing major economy in the last 12 years. After Independence in 1947, the Prime Minister said, India had big dreams, but progress often fell short of the pace the country aspired to achieve.

Today, India is moving ahead with unprecedented speed and confidence, and now, no force can stop the re-

solve of 140 crore Indians, he added.

He added that India has a big dream to build a Viksit Bharat or Developed India by 2047, powered by the strength and resolve of 140 crore Indians. "When the world's most populous nation sets its sights on becoming a developed country, it sends a powerful message to the world and is reshaping how

the world sees India," he said, adding that any nation becomes great when it achieves its accomplishments.

Highlighting the achievements of his government in the past 12 years, PM Modi said that the defence production has increased four times, electronic manufacturing seven times, modern railway coach production 21 times, internet users have gone up four times, and digital transactions have expanded 100 times.

MOVING AHEAD
The PM added that the country is moving towards becoming a major player in the semiconductor sector. India has already begun production at three semiconductor plants, and five to eight more plants are expected to come up in the coming years, the Prime Minister said.

Free online coaching, AI training announced for 1 crore youth

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

To help the middle class and improve employability, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday announced free online coaching for aspirants and AI training for youth.

"Coaching classes burden the poor and the middle class. We will provide free online coaching for various exams," PM Modi announced at the Red Fort. "Every parent feels that if they do not send their child to a coaching class, they are not a prestigious family," he added.

The PM said he assures these families that they can save "thousands of crores of rupees" spent on coaching, be close to their children, and care for them.

"And therefore, we have decided to provide free online coaching for various examinations for the youth. We have digital public infra-

structure; we have excellent talent and teachers. By bringing these resources together, we are going to build a complete network to provide free coaching to the youth of the country," he said. For many young people, the cost of coaching, travel and accommodation can become an additional barrier alongside the competition itself.

The proposed network is aimed at using digital platforms to make coaching widely available.

"We have decided that in the coming year, we will train one crore young people in AI (artificial intelligence) skills, so that the youth of our country can develop the capability to lead in the world of AI," he said.

EMERGING TECH
Highlighting the importance of AI in Saptdhara (Seven Streams), the PM said: "Emerging technologies are presenting new challenges, and we must become a global

hub of innovation. We have already demonstrated our strength through UPI and digital public infrastructure. Now, we must take the next leap in next generation communication technology."

Talking about overall changes in the education system, Modi informed that India added 650 new universities in the last decade and more than doubled the number of medical seats since 2014.

"From 2004 to 2014, there were fewer than 350 universities. And today, within 10-12 years, nearly 650 new universities have been added," the Prime Minister said. "Before 2014, there were only 400 medical seats, and today nearly 850 medical seats are available," he added.

The PM said that, India is emerging as an attractive destination for foreign universities.

"For 35 years, there was no education policy. We brought a new education policy," he added.

'India set to remain one of the fastest growing economies'

Our Bureau
Mumbai

With the economy in first track — real GDP growth expected at 8 per cent in Q1 FY27; continuing credit demand, growing by 19.3 per cent for the fortnight ended July 31; deposit growth picking up speed, growing by 15.4 per cent (with the huge inflows of FCNR-B deposits); and a visible reversal in FII flows — India "was", "is", and "will" be one of the fastest growing economies in the world, according to SBI's economic department (ERD). India's macro story continues to remain one of resilience, even as global uncertainties remain elevated. Growth outlook remains strong. SBI's Newcast-ing model projects real GDP growth at 8 per cent in Q1 FY27.

"Record capital inflows under RBI scheme at \$57 billion and counting; credit growth at a scorching 19 per cent, deposit growth at 15 per cent; forex reserves at \$707 billion, buoyant corporate results, monsoon recovery are all holding up," said Soumya Kanti Ghosh, Group Chief Economic Adviser, State Bank of India, in a report "Celebrating Resilience of Indian Economy on India's 80th Independence Day."

CONCESSIONAL SWAP
The report emphasised that till August 13, \$52.3 billion has been mobilised under FCNR (B) under the RBI's concessional swap facility, which is remarkable.

Till August 13, \$52.3 billion has been mobilised under FCNR (B) under the RBI's concessional swap facility

"Even after one month truncation (the concessional swap facility will be offered by RBI on FCNR-B deposits mobilised by banks till August 31 against September 30) overall, we expect \$65-70 billion of FCNR(B) mobilisation by the end of the scheme and, including OFCBs (overseas foreign currency borrowings) and ECBs (external commercial borrowings), total mobilisation could reach \$80-85 billion," per SBI. The report noted that the RBI has already recouped around \$31 billion of foreign currency assets as of August 7, equivalent to nearly 55 per cent of the amount mobilised. The ERD officials opined that the surge in bank deposits and foreign-currency funding should lower the counterfactual level of G-Sec yields through deposit-to-yield transmission gaining credence.

The clearest beneficiary should be the 3-7-year segment due to maturity matching, carry and lower supply pressure followed by the 7-10-year segment, it added. Ghosh underscored that there is also a visible reversal in FII flows — from outflows towards inflows following measures announced by the RBI and the government.

Tata Trusts' governance dispute raises concerns ahead of Tata Sons' AGM

bl.explainer

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

As Tata Sons prepares for its 108th annual general meeting (AGM) on August 18 (Tuesday), an unusual dispute involving one of its principal shareholders, the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), has cast uncertainty over the company's governance processes. The issue stems from regulatory restrictions imposed on the trust and has raised questions not only about the AGM's conduct but also the eventual succession to chairman N Chandrasekaran.

What is the Tata Sons-Tata Trusts issue all about?
Tata Sons, the holding company of the Tata group, is facing a governance challenge after Maharashtra's Charity Commissioner imposed restrictions on the SRTT, one of its two principal shareholders.

Why is the issue significant?
Tata Trusts are the largest shareholders of Tata Sons, collectively owning about two-thirds of the holding company.

Under Tata Sons' Articles of Association, the presence of a representative nominated jointly by the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) and the SRTT is necessary for

the AGM quorum as long as the trusts collectively hold at least 40 per cent of Tata Sons' share capital. Even the selection committee that needs to be appointed to choose the next chairman requires five persons, three of whom are nominated jointly by the two trusts. Thus any restrictions affecting one of the trusts could have implications for governance and decision-making at Tata Sons, including boardroom and succession-related matters.

Why has the issue come into focus now?
The AGM is expected to consider the adoption of FY26 accounts, declaration of dividend and the reappointment of Tata Sons chairman N Chandrasekaran as a director retiring by rotation.

However, questions have arisen over whether the meeting can proceed as planned given the quorum requirements as laid down in Tata Sons' Articles of Association and the restrictions on SRTT.

Why did Maharashtra's Charity Commissioner act against SRTT?
In May, the Charity Commissioner passed an order restricting SRTT from holding meetings.

The action followed complaints alleging violations of the Maharashtra Public Trusts Act. One complaint was filed by advocate Katyayani Agrawal, while an-



Bombay High Court is ruled out at this stage.

What happens if the AGM does not have the required quorum?
The Companies Act and Tata Sons' Articles of Association contain provisions dealing with situations where quorum is not present. If the required quorum is not met, the AGM could be adjourned and reconvened at a later date in accordance with the applicable rules.

Is Chandra's directorship at risk if AGM doesn't take place?
Sonam Chandwani, Managing Partner of KS Legal & Associates says on re-appointment, the law ties a rotational director's retirement to the conclusion of the AGM that takes up the matter. "So if no AGM concludes, the director doesn't automatically fall out of office purely because the meeting got adjourned provided there is no separate disqualification at play," she added. "Section 167 of the Companies Act which governs vacation of director's office does not include failure of AGM to achieve quorum as ground for cessation of director's term of office. Therefore Chandra should continue as a director unless he specifically expresses in writing his unwillingness to hold office," said Harsh Kumar, Founding Partner of Kaizen Law.

At 10.86 b, PhonePe leads UPI transactions in July

Our Bureau
Bengaluru



PhonePe continued to lead India's digital payments market in July, processing 10.86 billion transactions, up from 10.48 billion in June, even as the overall Unified Payments Interface (UPI) ecosystem recorded strong growth during the month, data released by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) showed.

The company accounted for 45.89 per cent of all UPI transactions in July.

It processed payments worth ₹14.44 lakh crore, translating into a 48.33 per cent share of UPI's total transaction value.

Google Pay held on to the second spot, with its transaction count rising to 7.65 billion from 7.41 billion in June.

It accounted for 32.33 per cent of UPI volumes and 33.51 per cent of transaction value, processing ₹10.01 lakh crore worth of payments.

PhonePe and Google Pay together processed more than three-fourths of UPI transactions in July, with a combined volume share of 78.22 per cent.

Paytm remained the third-largest player. Its monthly transaction count increased to 1.90 billion from 1.80 billion in June.

SMALLER PLAYERS
Navi continued to occupy the fourth position, recording 947.08 million transactions in July, compared with 842.51

million in June.

Among the smaller players, Flipkart-backed super.money processed 437.27 million transactions, marginally higher than the 430.24 million recorded in June. BHIM's transaction volumes rose to 242.27 million from 223.54 million.

FamApp by Trio processed 206.19 million transactions, while WhatsApp recorded 167.89 million. CRED, meanwhile, fell to the 10th spot from ninth in June, with 142.10 million transactions.

Despite processing fewer transactions, CRED handled ₹59,279 crore in UPI payments, giving it a 1.98 per cent share of transaction value. WhatsApp processed ₹12,957 crore, accounting for 0.43 per cent.

Axis Bank's apps together processed 143.77 million transactions across customer-initiated, B2C and B2B payments, with a combined value of ₹13,940 crore.

Overall, UPI processed 23.66 billion transactions worth ₹29.88 lakh crore in July. The three largest players — PhonePe, Google Pay and Paytm — accounted for 86.28 per cent of transaction volumes and 88.68 per cent of the total value.

1,000 days on, Red Sea crisis continues to squeeze trade

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

The Red Sea shipping crisis today entered its 1,000th day, with the disruption to one of the world's most important maritime trade corridors continuing to weigh on global shipping and trade.

The crisis began on November 19, 2023, when Yemen-based Houthi rebels seized the cargo ship Galaxy Leader in the Red Sea near the Yemeni port of Hodeidah. The incident marked the beginning of disruption to shipping through the Red Sea and the Suez Canal, forcing carriers to divert vessels around the Cape of Good Hope.

Although shipping lines, including Maersk and Hapag-Lloyd, have in recent days begun testing the waters by restarting some services through the Red Sea, security concerns continue to keep carriers cautious.

The prolonged Red Sea crisis has shown that military action can intercept missiles but cannot restore commercial confidence, said Ajay Srivastava, Founder, Global Trade Research Initiative.



SYSTEMIC DISRUPTION. The Red Sea crisis has demonstrated how closely geopolitics, logistics, consumer behaviour and industry performance are interconnected **REUTERS**

At the worst of times, freight rates on some India-Europe and India-US routes increased by 200-400 per cent. Longer voyages raised fuel, freight, insurance and inventory costs. They also delayed payments and blocked exporters' working capital for additional weeks.

EXPORTERS HIT
MSME exporters suffered the most. Vulnerable products include textiles, garments, engineering goods, chemicals, leather, carpets, rice, spices, grapes and marine products.

These goods often have low profit margins and cannot easily absorb higher freight costs. Imports of European machinery, chemicals, auto components, metals and medical equipment also became more expensive and took longer to arrive, he said.

"The Covid pandemic shook the world but its intensity started waning within 18 months. However, world trade is facing a pandemic that continues well over 1,000 days in the form of the disruption of safe passage through the Red Sea

Extended routes around the Cape of Good Hope have become persistent challenges for Indian merchandise exporters

lane," said J Krishnan of Chennai-based S Natesa Iyer Logistics LLP.

Extended routes around the Cape of Good Hope have become persistent challenges for Indian merchandise exporters.

The crisis has also exposed a structural weakness in India's shipping ecosystem — its dependence on foreign shipping lines. The lack of adequate national tonnage to support domestic exporters has exposed India's trade to the pricing decisions and capacity constraints of foreign carriers, said Krishnan.

Kumar Duraisamy, Managing Director of Tiruppur-based Eastern Global Clothing, said the additional logistics costs are being passed through the supply chain and, in many instances,

translate into higher prices for the consumer. When merchandise takes longer to reach the market and becomes more expensive to transport, inflationary pressures intensify. At the same time, with limited scope for a corresponding increase in household incomes, consumers naturally become more cautious, prioritising essential expenditure and reducing discretionary spending, he said.

POSITIVE OUTLOOK
The Red Sea crisis has demonstrated how closely geopolitics, logistics, consumer behaviour and industry performance are interconnected.

For export-oriented sectors such as apparel, stability in global trade routes is not merely a shipping concern — it is a fundamental requirement for competitiveness and growth.

"We have endured the disruption. We have adapted to the uncertainty. And we continue to hope for better days ahead — with stronger trade, more stable logistics, greater market opportunities and sustainable growth for Indian industry," he said.

7.7 magnitude earthquake kills at least 38 in Indonesia's Flores region

Asian News International
Jakarta (Indonesia)



At least 38 people were killed after a powerful 7.7-magnitude earthquake struck eastern Indonesia on Saturday, triggering a tsunami warning that was later lifted, CBS News reported.

"Thirty-eight people have been confirmed dead, two were seriously injured, 11 sustained minor injuries, and approximately 2,000 people have evacuated on their own," Indonesian National Disaster Mitigation Agency chief Suharyanto said at a news conference, according to CBS News.

The US Geological Survey said that the earthquake struck Indonesia's Flores region at 5.58 am (local time), with its epicentre located roughly 68 km north-northwest of Ende city in East Nusa Tenggara province.

AFTER EFFECTS
Several aftershocks followed the initial quake. Authorities initially issued a tsunami warning and urged

coastal residents to move to higher ground. The warning was later lifted after Indonesia's Meteorology, Climatology and Geophysics Agency found no significant sea-level changes posing a threat to coastal communities.

The head of the Maumere Search and Rescue Agency, Fathur Rahman, said rescuers continued searching for two villagers believed to be buried under mud following a landslide triggered by the earthquake. East Nusa Tenggara Police Chief Rudi Darmoko said the earthquake caused severe damage and collapsed buildings.

Power outages in cities and villages disrupted communication and hampered

search and rescue operations. According to CBS News, Darmoko said, "We are continuing to collect reports of damage and casualties, but there are communication disruptions." Landslides in Ende regency also cut off the Trans-Flores Highway, a roughly 700 km paved mountain road spanning Flores Island from Labuan Bajo to Larantuka. Hospital staff moved equipment, including beds, IV stands, and oxygen cylinders, outdoors and established temporary treatment areas. The Indonesian National Disaster Management Agency deployed a helicopter to assist with logistics and emergency response operations.

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